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Editor's letter

INDIAN OCEAN COLLECTION 2026



A friend of mine recently returned from her honeymoon in the Maldives and, by all accounts, it was the once-in-a-lifetime fantasy you'd expect: cocktails on powder-white sand, lazy afternoons by the infinity pool, a night on a private beach beneath an impossibly starry sky. But when I asked about her favourite moment, it wasn't the overwater villa or the candlelit dinner, it was a morning aboard a traditional dhow with two of the resort's boat crew, sharing sweet tea and stories as the sun slipped behind the atoll. That's the memory that has her poring over flights, working out when she can return.

It's easy to see why so many Indian Ocean destinations are sold as once-in-a-lifetime escapes — the sort of places you tick off for a honeymoon and never revisit. But venture beyond the postcard views and spend time with locals, and, like my friend, you'll soon be planning your next trip.

That's the spirit behind this collection. Turn to page 16 to descend beneath the Maldives' waves with marine biologists using AI to map coral, or to page 28 to see how the archipelago's wellness scene is trading treatment menus for something wilder. On Zanzibar's east coast, we spend time with women farming seaweed by hand (page 22), and on page 34, follow the ancient spice routes that once made the Indian Ocean the most valuable stretch of water on Earth.

Then we go further still, to islands you may never have heard of — exploring the reef breaks of Indonesia's Mentawai Islands, the wildlife-rich shores of Comoros and the castaway calm of Mozambique's Bazaruto Archipelago (page 6). Because the deeper you look, the more there is to discover. And finally, there's our roundup of the best hotels and experiences, brought to you by our advertising partners, to help plan your next escape (page 38).

Charlotte

Charlotte Wigram-Evans, editor



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National Geographic Traveller (UK) — The Collection is published by APL Media Limited, Unit 310, Highgate Studios, 53-79 Highgate Road, London NW5 1TL.
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IMAGE: GETTY

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INDIAN OCEAN COLLECTION

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On the cover



The white sand on Maldivian beaches is partly made from crushed coral and the shells of tiny marine organisms
Image: Merr Watson/
Villa Park, Maldives

A full-page background image showing a person surfing on a wave at sunset. The sun is low on the horizon, creating a bright, golden glow that illuminates the clouds and the water. The surfer is in the center of the frame, riding a wave that is breaking. The water is dark blue, and the sky is filled with orange and yellow clouds.

New horizons

The Indian Ocean's headline destinations have earned their reputations, but they're only part of the story. Venture beyond the familiar and you'll find remote archipelagos, remarkable wildlife and cultures that reward a second look

WORDS: ALICIA MILLER



For surfer cool

LOVE BALI?

WHY NOT TRY **MENTAWAI, INDONESIA**

Bali may have helped put surfing on the map, but those craving the laid-back atmosphere that first made the island famous should set their sights on the Mentawai Islands.

Around 90 miles west of Sumatra, this remote Indonesian archipelago is made up of around 70 islands. They're best known for their long, reef-break waves, but inland the islands offer a different kind of draw: Indigenous Mentawai communities, many of whom still practise traditional tattooing and live off the rainforest much as their ancestors did.

Consistent swells and warm tropical waters have made the Mentawais one of the world's most celebrated surf destinations, attracting everyone from seasoned professionals to adventurous intermediates. Yet despite its reputation, the islands retain a

wonderfully remote feel. Direct charter flights from Kuala Lumpur are expected to launch in 2027, but for now, a journey of around 10 hours including a flight to Padang followed by a ferry, helps to keep visitor numbers low.

Days are spent chasing legendary reef breaks such as Lance's Right, snorkelling coral reefs or exploring jungle-fringed shores, before gathering for sunset drinks and fire-cooked seafood with fellow surfers.

The Mentawais remain largely low-key. Accommodation is centred around relaxed surf camps and intimate beachfront resorts rather than large-scale developments, preserving the easygoing spirit that has long defined the islands.

HOW TO DO IT: Stays at Hollow Tree's Resort start from \$275 (£206) per night, with a minimum four-night stay. [htsresort.com](https://www.htsresort.com)

For wildlife

LOVE MADAGASCAR?

WHY NOT TRY **COMOROS**

Madagascar is rightly celebrated for its wildlife, but neighbouring Comoros offers remarkable biodiversity in a far more intimate setting. Set between Madagascar and mainland Africa, the volcanic archipelago is one of the Indian Ocean's least-visited destinations, and its pristine reefs, lush forests and marine reserves shelter an impressive array of wildlife.

A guided tour is the best way to explore responsibly. Highlights include the Mwali Unesco Biosphere Reserve, where humpback whales, spinner dolphins, manta rays and tropical fish thrive alongside one of the world's most important green turtle nesting beaches. Inland, forests shelter Livingstone's fruit bats and mongoose lemurs.

HOW TO DO IT: Intrepid has a nine-day Comoros trip from £2,880 per person. [intrepidtravel.com](https://www.intrepidtravel.com)

From left: The Mentawai Islands are home to more than 70 named surf breaks; many of the Mentawai Islands' beaches remain completely undeveloped



For historic wonder

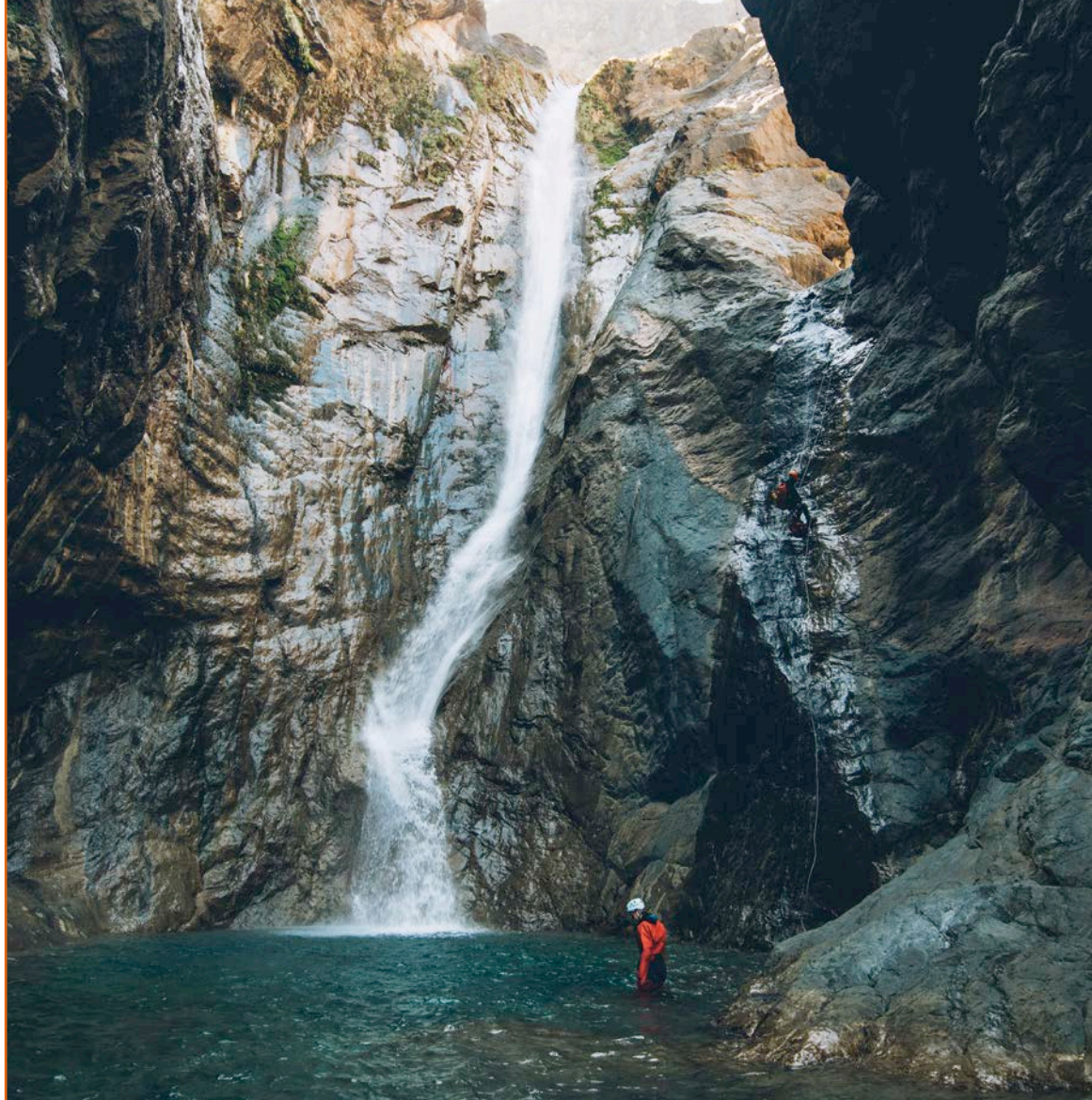
LOVE ZANZIBAR?
WHY NOT TRY LAMU, KENYA

If it's the winding streets, carved wooden doors and rich Swahili history of Zanzibar that appeal, Kenya's Lamu Archipelago offers a quieter but equally captivating alternative. At its heart lies Unesco-listed Lamu Old Town, a settlement continuously inhabited for more than 700 years and once East Africa's most important trading centre. Built from coral stone and mangrove timber, its elegant houses reveal Arabic, Persian, Indian and European influences, while labyrinthine alleyways lead past mosques, bustling markets, craft workshops and restaurants serving freshly grilled fish and fragrant coconut curries.

Spend a few days wandering its atmospheric streets, watching traditional dhows drift across the harbour, browsing artisan workshops or taking a boat to seven-mile-long Shela Beach.

Subira House, set behind the carved facade of a 200-year-old Arab-style building, is an ideal base. Meals showcase produce from the property's own farm, and guests can take part in activities including Arabic calligraphy, woodcarving and Swahili poetry.

HOW TO DO IT: Doubles at Subira House start from £33 per night (B&B). subirahouse.com



For outdoor adventure

LOVE MAURITIUS?
WHY NOT TRY RÉUNION, FRANCE

With its lush mountains, rainforest hiking trails and wealth of outdoor activities on offer, Mauritius has long appealed to travellers who prefer to stay active between beach days. Some 140 miles to the south west of Mauritius, its Mascarene archipelago neighbour Réunion offers a similarly adventurous spirit, but perhaps on an even grander scale.

Rising dramatically from the Indian Ocean, the volcanically active island is a landscape of soaring peaks, lava-formed valleys and deep forest, with nearly half its territory protected as a Unesco-listed national park. Hikers are spoiled for choice, whether tackling Piton des Neiges — a 9.5-mile round-trip climb that's either a challenging one-day excursion or a two-day outing — or exploring the island's three cirques, vast natural amphitheatres carved

by ancient volcanic collapse. Cirque de Salazie, with its waterfalls, cloud forest and rare orchids, is among the most accessible.

The islands also share a rich cultural heritage, shaped by French, African, Indian and Chinese influences. Réunion's cuisine reflects this diversity, with everything from fragrant *cari* (curry) and samosas to baguettes and stir-fried noodles. Refuel with traditional *rougail* (sausage stewed in a spiced tomato sauce) or chicken *cari* at Chez Maillot in Cilaos or sample vanilla-infused duck at the farm-to-table Ferme Auberge Annibal.

HOW TO DO IT: Réunion is easily reached via direct flights from Paris and regional connections from Mauritius. Base yourself in towns such as Cilaos or Salazie to explore hiking trails, national parks and volcanic landscapes. reunion.fr

From left: Lamu's carved wooden doors are a hallmark of Swahili architecture; Réunion's dramatic canyons offer natural slides and plunge pools; Kisawa's thatched-roof bungalows are made with local timber; the strawberry hermit crab gets its name from its bright red body

IMAGES: ALAMY; IRT-MAX COQUARD; ANDBEYOND; SHUTTERSTOCK

For castaway luxury

LOVE THE MALDIVES?

WHY NOT TRY **BAZARUTO ARCHIPELAGO, MOZAMBIQUE**

Honeymooners and families have long been drawn to the Maldives for its private-island resorts, turquoise lagoons and barefoot luxury. But travellers seeking a more remote castaway experience should look to Mozambique's Bazaruto Archipelago, a protected national park set around 10 miles off the mainland's south coast. Its five main islands — Bazaruto, Benguerra, Magaruque, Santa Carolina and Bangué — offer the same dreamlike combination of low-lying white sands, turquoise shallows and lush greenery, while adding a wilder sense of adventure.

Days here can be spent snorkelling coral reefs, sailing traditional dhows between islands, spotting marine life on boat safaris, diving in clear waters or heading inland to discover towering sand dunes, freshwater lakes and remote communities.

The waters surrounding the islands are also home to one of the Indian Ocean's richest marine ecosystems, with nesting turtles, whale sharks, dolphins and dugongs.

For those who want to combine wilderness with comfort, there are a handful of standout lodges. The flagship is Kisawa, a 740-acre retreat in the south of Benguerra Island, whose thatched-roof bungalows blend into the landscape. On the island's west coast, and Beyond Benguerra Island Lodge offers beachside accommodation plus experiences including dhow sailing and horse-riding.

HOW TO DO IT: All-inclusive stays at Kisawa start from €5,570 (£4,777) per night, minimum two-night stay, and at and Beyond Benguerra Island Lodge from \$1,080 (£804) per night. kisawasanctuary.com and andbeyond.com



For island-hopping

LOVE SEYCHELLES?

WHY NOT TRY

LAKSHADWEEP, INDIA

Island-hopping is one of the great pleasures of the Indian Ocean, and while the Seychelles has long been the region's classic multi-island escape, India's little-visited Lakshadweep archipelago offers a quieter alternative. Scattered across the Arabian Sea, off Kerala's coast, its 36 coral islands are fringed by dazzling lagoons, powder-soft beaches and vibrant reefs, yet receive only a fraction of the visitors.

Travelling between inhabited islands such as Agatti, Kavaratti and Kadmat by ferry or high-speed boat is all part of the experience. Along the way, you'll encounter deserted sandbanks, crystal-clear waters and some of India's finest diving and snorkelling, alongside a distinctive Muslim culture shaped by centuries of maritime trade.

Tourism is carefully managed, with all visitors requiring permits to enter the islands. Travelling with a specialist operator such as State Express makes exploring straightforward, with itineraries taking in Kochi, Agatti and Bangaram.

Accommodation is low-key, with simple cottages and thatched stays beneath coconut palms. For added comfort, Bangaram Island Resort offers spacious sea-facing suites.

HOW TO DO IT: State Express offers a six-day Lakshadweep Bangaram Island Tour (price on request). stateexpressindia.com □



An aerial photograph of a tropical coastline. The top half of the image shows clear, turquoise water with visible coral reefs and sandy patches. The bottom half shows a wide, white sandy beach. Several small figures of people are scattered across the beach and in the shallow water, providing a sense of scale. The overall color palette is dominated by blues, greens, and whites.

SACRED SHORES

UNCOVER THE SPIRITUAL SIDE OF KENYA'S COASTLINE — FROM ANCIENT FORESTS AND CORAL REEFS TO ONE OF EAST AFRICA'S OLDEST SWAHILI SETTLEMENTS

WORDS: EMMA GREGG



'GOD'S REIGN'. 'BE HUMBLE'. 'FIND THE DIVINE'.

These are just some of the messages emblazoned across the windscreens of the tuk-tuks weaving through the traffic in Diani. The road is fringed with little shops selling household necessities and the smell of salt in the air hints at the ocean beyond. For now, it remains tantalisingly out of sight, but other tuk-tuks, packed with holidaymakers, are a sure sign we're nearing the coast.

I'm tracing Kenya's Indian Ocean shoreline, following a single ribbon of tarmac from Diani to Watamu and finally out to the remote Lamu Archipelago. Diani is Kenya's best-known stretch of Indian Ocean coastline, drawing travellers with its palm-fringed sands, dramatic tides and turquoise waters — whether they're rounding off a safari in Tsavo or the Maasai Mara, or simply coming for a week by the sea. Yet just a few miles inland, another side of Diani awaits.

Hidden within these tropical lowlands are the kaya forests: sacred groves of pod mahogany, strangler fig and combretum, treasured by the coastal Mijikenda people as places of prayer and reflection. They contain the remains of long-abandoned fortified villages dating back to around the 16th century. Most are closed to visitors, but a community ecotourism project run by members of the local Digo community has opened Kaya Kinondo to travellers willing to experience it respectfully.

Before we enter, my guide Mohammed Danda hands me a midnight-blue sarong to knot around my waist and explains the rules: don't disturb the flora and fauna, and to keep our voices low. This, he tells me, is a deeply spiritual place. "It's the home of my ancestors," he says. "It's important to preserve their peace."

Barefoot, Mohammed leads me along a leaf-strewn path, stepping over sinuous roots and jagged coral stones that hint at the former settlement beneath the trees. The canopy all but shuts out the light, and the air is rich with the scent of earth and bark. As we approach, a dissenting baboon bellows from somewhere deep inside the forest.

To the Mijikenda people, Mohammed explains, the forest is as well stocked as a pharmacy: plants here are used to treat everything from coughs to erectile dysfunction. "Like us, every tree has

a spirit inside, and when one dies, it's a sign," he says, pausing beside a fallen giant. "We honour it with a ritual, then leave it to decompose, so that its surroundings may regenerate one day."

A different kind of sanctuary

Continuing north along the coast, I find that this reverence for nature takes a different form. By the time I reach the fishing town of Watamu. Offshore, coral reefs teem with life — and for Guido Paap, master scuba diver trainer at Reefo Divers, they hold an almost spiritual significance of their own.

Kenya was the first country in Africa to establish a Marine Protected Area, and this stretch of coast now encompasses marine national parks at Kisite-Mpunguti, Mombasa, Watamu and Malindi, as well as six additional marine reserves. Years spent diving these waters have given Guido a profound respect for the reefs' fragility.

While climate-driven bleaching has taken its toll over the years, remedial work is underway. "Here, travellers can be so much more than just a diver," says Guido. "We've created a PADI Coral Reef Restoration Diver course so that visitors can learn how to harvest broken corals and plant fragments onto artificial reefs that act as nurseries. Together, they'll give this reef a second life."

The same waters that shelter Watamu's coral gardens also provide a haven for green, olive ridley and hawksbill turtles. Between April and September, females haul themselves onto the gently sloping beaches to nest, with their hatchlings emerging in the New Year.

That evening, I join a night patrol along the shore. The beach is lit only by a thin wash of moonlight and the volunteers' red-filtered torches. White light disorients the turtles, I'm told, so we move in near-darkness, our voices lowered to whispers.

Somewhere ahead, a female green turtle is already digging, her flippers throwing up small showers of sand as she works. We keep our distance and wait.

"It feels divine, watching her like this," whispers Teresiah Njeri, a volunteer for the not-for-profit Local Ocean, who has walked this beach on patrol more nights than she can count. "In the nesting

Clockwise from top: Lamu was an important trading centre for centuries, thanks to its deep, sheltered waters; tuk-tuks are one of the most popular ways to get around; greater flamingos feed in the shallow, nutrient-rich waters of Watamu Marine National Park & Reserve





season, we're out here every night, making sure each of these mothers gets the peace she needs and deserves." There's something incredibly moving about watching a creature go about an ancient ritual so precisely, entirely undisturbed.

Spiritual strolling

My final stop lies to the north, in the Lamu Archipelago. Here, reverence isn't hidden in a forest canopy or moonlit sands, but carried on the call to prayer that echoes across the town five times a day.

In the old town of Lamu, residents anticipate the end of Ramadan with a quiet excitement. By day, the alleyways are hushed, shopkeepers conserving their energy through the long hours without food or water; by late afternoon, the voices of the muezzins drift out from a dozen minarets at once, unhurried and overlapping. It's as though the whole town seems to exhale. In anticipation of the evening's iftar feast, lively Islamic music gushes from loudspeakers in the main square, while market vendors sell treats such as *kaimati* and *visheti* — nuggets of buttery, cardamom-flavoured dough with a crisp, sugary coating.

Mahmoud Mahmoud, my guide, reveals that I'm standing in the oldest and best-preserved Swahili settlement in East Africa, and that Swahili means 'of the coast' in Arabic. It was here that East Africans, Arabs, Persians and Asians first coalesced, bringing a new language and culture into being. An important trading centre from the 14th to the 19th centuries, thanks to its deep, sheltered waters, Lamu once welcomed dhows laden with spices and gold, but also carrying the shamed trades of ivory and enslaved people. Today it's Unesco World Heritage-listed for its medina-like maze of coral-rag and mangrove-wood houses, standing side-by-side along shaded alleyways.

The grandest houses have *barazas* (stone benches) outside, where guests are invited to sit and chat when coming to call. Their most remarkable features, however, are the elaborately carved wooden front doors and lintels, embellished with botanical motifs and verses from the Koran. While many original doors have been sold for export over the years, they've been replaced with skilfully-made replicas, which are helping to keep the art of woodcarving alive.

As we wander, we pass several sawdust-scented workshops, abuzz with activity. We step beneath the ylang-ylang tree that perfumes the courtyard of the Swahili House Museum and then into the house

itself. It's a modest space, its simplicity offset by a whitewashed wall of decorative niches displaying ceramics. "Our houses keep cool, because we use natural materials such as timber, coral and lime," says Mahmoud. "Which is just as well, because in the 18th century, when this was built, the women of the household spent all their time indoors. It's different now, of course."

Mahmoud walks me south, past the fort, to where the Riyadhha Mosque rises above a wide, dusty square, its roofline ringed in yellow and a single green dome catching the last of the light. It's here, he tells me, that the heart of Lamu's spiritual life can be found.

Built in 1892 by the Comorian scholar Habib Swaleh, the mosque became a centre of learning unlike anywhere else on the coast. At a time when religious education was often restricted by status and lineage, Habib Swaleh had scandalised the town's conservative establishment by bringing Islamic teachings to the descendants of enslaved people and the island's poorest families, insisting that devotion belonged to everyone, not just the well-born. His reforms still shape the town. During Maulidi, the annual celebration of the Prophet Muhammad's birth, thousands of pilgrims arrive from across East Africa and beyond, sleeping in their hundreds inside the mosque and the surrounding alleyways.

Habib Swaleh is buried just outside, in a modest tomb visited by pilgrims year-round. Mahmoud lowers his voice as we pass it, out of habit more than instruction. "People come from everywhere to sit here," he says. "Not just to pray but to be near him."

I sit on a low wall across the square as the light softens. A few minutes later the call to prayer begins, first from the Riyadhha Mosque itself, then answered by minarets further off, rolling across the rooftops until the whole town seems to vibrate. Mahmoud closes his eyes, listening, and I realise that I've spent this trip seeking out the sacred. Here, however, it doesn't need to be searched for: it simply arrives on the evening air, exactly on time. ▣

HOW TO DO IT: Expert Africa has a bespoke 10-night trip to Diani Beach, Watamu and Lamu, staying at Kinondo Kwetu, Lonno Lodge and The Cabanas Lamu. Prices start from £3,680 per person and includes half-board accommodation at Lonno Lodge and The Cabanas Lamu and all-inclusive accommodation at Kinondo Kwetu. All local road, boat and transfers are also included. expertafrica.com

Clockwise from top: The ruins of Gedi are among East Africa's best-preserved medieval Swahili towns; Lamu's market sells many of the spices that define Swahili cooking; many women in Lamu wear colourful buibuis and hijabs

TOP FIVE

SWAHILI COAST HERITAGE SITES

Ruins of Gedi, Kenya

Gedi flourished between the 13th and 17th centuries, and today its surviving structures still offer glimpses into life in the ancient Swahili settlement. The ruins are easily reached from the coastal towns of Watamu and Malindi.

Fort Jesus, Kenya

Founded around 900 CE, Mombasa has been an important East African port ever since. It was protected by a Portuguese-built 16th-century fortress, Fort Jesus, which now houses a museum of Swahili culture.

Stone Town, Zanzibar

Zanzibar was a powerhouse of intercontinental trade, and its historic architecture blends Arab and Asian influences. Many of the finest buildings, with coral-rag walls and carved hardwood doors, arose under Omani rule.

Ruins of Kilwa Kisiwani, Tanzania

This medieval city-state had a strategic location on an island in southern Tanzania. Remains of its Great Mosque and palace can still be seen. Its decline began when the Portuguese arrived in the 16th century.

Island of Mozambique, Mozambique

Originally an Arab trading post, the island-town served as the capital of Portuguese East Africa for almost four centuries. When the capital moved to Maputo, the town faded, though its historic charm remains.

An aerial photograph of a tropical coastline. The water is a vibrant turquoise, revealing a complex coral reef system with various shades of brown and green. A narrow strip of white sand beach runs along the right side of the frame, bordered by lush green vegetation and several tall palm trees. In the distance, the ocean transitions to a deeper blue, and a small white boat is visible on the horizon under a bright blue sky with scattered white clouds.

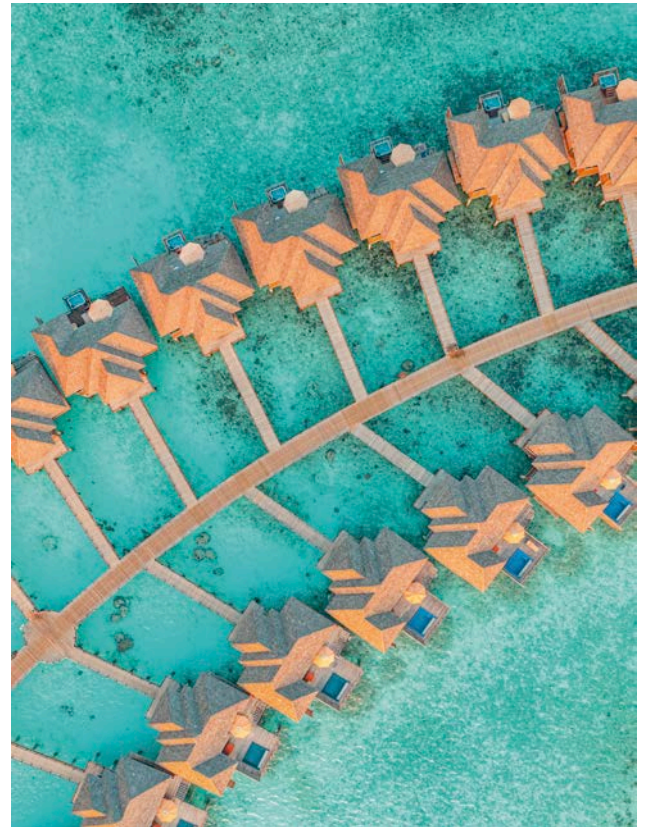
Reading the reef

How can you protect what you don't understand? In the Maldives, a pioneering coral-monitoring project is combining AI, 3D mapping and marine science to reveal the hidden lives of reefs and show travellers a new way to experience conservation

WORDS: JESSICA VINCENT



IMAGES: GETTY



I should be watching my dive buddy, but I'm distracted by a giant clam. It's electric blue mottled with black swirls, like ink dispersing in water. A pink-striped parrot fish is munching on a piece of coral nearby; a cobalt-blue starfish clings to the reef. I exhale, letting bubbles escape, and the giant clam slams shut.

It's my first glimpse of the underwater world surrounding Six Senses Kanuhura in the Maldives' Lhaviyani Atoll, a place that looks, from above, like the very definition of a tropical escape. The only way to reach this island resort is by seaplane. The day before, I'd boarded the 12-seater from the capital, Malé, feeling a little apprehensive. A tropical storm had rolled in, wrapping the airport's lagoon in sea mist so thick it swallowed the aircraft as it bobbed beside the jetty.

But the weather changed as quickly as it had arrived. Within minutes of take-off, the clouds peeled back to reveal the Maldives from above: more than a thousand islands scattered across the Indian Ocean like emeralds, each ringed by dazzling halos of white sand and turquoise water. Resorts appeared one after another — neat rows of thatched-roof overwater villas stretching into lagoons so clear they barely looked real.

Now, six metres below the surface with a tank strapped to my back, I realise that what I saw from the air was only the start. The water is so clear I can see every fold and contour of the reef below. Giant dome-shaped corals rise from the seabed, their weathered surfaces carved into intricate whorls like enormous brains. Between them, delicate branching corals in muted shades of lemon and



lilac teem with tiny reef fish darting in and out with the swell, creating the illusion that the corals themselves are breathing.

A few metres ahead of me, marine biologist James Cordery is doing what he calls ‘the lawnmower’. Both arms stretched out in front of him, he grips a metal pole fitted with three GoPro cameras as he swims methodically back and forth across a 10-by-10-metre patch of reef. Every half a second, the three GoPros click into action, capturing thousands of overlapping photographs that will later be stitched together into a 3D model of the reef. In three months, he’ll return to this exact patch of reef to do it all over again.

“The whole point is consistency,” he tells me later. “We’re trying to photograph the reef from exactly the same perspective each time.”

I hover just outside the survey plot, trying not to drift into his path. It feels strangely meditative. While James works, I begin noticing things I’d have otherwise swum straight past: tiny fish no bigger than my fingernail darting in and out of coral crevices; a lionfish peeking its striped head out to inspect me before slipping back into the shadows.

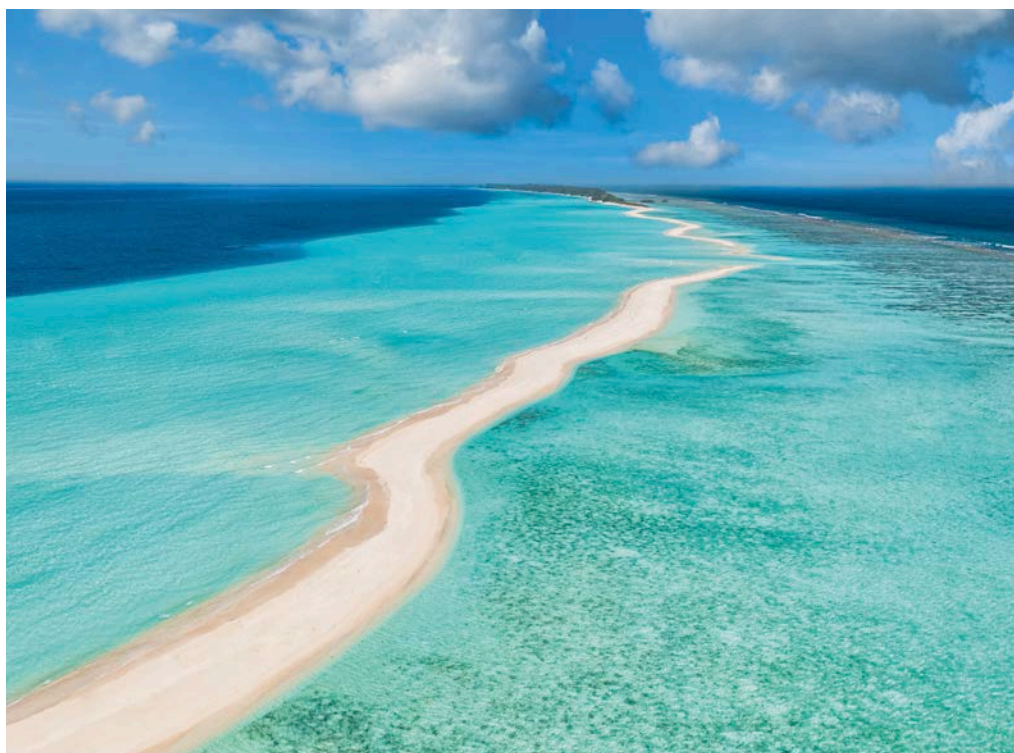
About 20 minutes into the dive, James makes a circle with his fingers — the diver’s sign for ‘OK’ and signal that he’s finished surveying the site. With plenty of air still in our tanks, we swim towards the reef wall.

I kick my fins over the 30-metre drop-off and my stomach lurches. For a split second, it feels as though I’m stepping off a precipice, but instead of falling, I hang weightless in the water, millions of tiny plankton drifting past and into the darkness below. As they disappear into the blue, James points ahead. At first, I can make out only a shadow, but as it glides closer, the shape becomes unmistakable: a reef shark, at least two metres long. Moments later, two large tuna emerge from behind it, their silvery flanks catching the light and flashing like scattered tinsel.

By the time we reach the surface, James is elated — but not because we saw a shark. “Today we surveyed 1,027 coral colonies,” he says, barely taking his regulator out. “That would normally take around seven hours and several divers. We did it in about 20 minutes.”

We’re diving Kanuhura Beru, a reef around 15 minutes by boat from Six Senses Kanuhura. It’s one of four sites around the island taking part in the Kanuhura Coral Census, a pioneering reef-monitoring project developed with researchers from Newcastle University and University College London (UCL). Using underwater photogrammetry (combining thousands of overlapping photographs into a precisely measured digital model of the reef), AI and 3D modelling, it allows the resort’s marine biologists to monitor their reefs with the same scientific precision as leading marine institutions.

“Before, I’d have to survey the reef using a tape measure and underwater slate, and then input the data by hand,” says James as we clamber back onto the boat and peel off our fins. Originally from the UK, James recently left a DPhil (PhD) in fish



behaviour at Oxford University to pursue hands-on coral reef research in the Maldives. Today, he heads up the Coral Census project as Six Senses Kanuhura’s lead resident marine biologist. “Not only are traditional reef surveys extremely time-consuming, but they also allow for a lot of human error and bias.”

A new way of seeing

Back at the resort, James plugs the cameras into his laptop and pulls up a remarkably detailed 3D model of the reef we just explored. He’s giddy with excitement. Zooming into one corner of the model, he points to a coral colony no bigger than my thumbnail and suddenly stops. “That wasn’t there three months ago,” he says, leaning closer to the screen with one hand on his chin.

Out on the reef, neither of us had noticed the speck of baby coral. Yet here, James can compare it with images captured three months earlier, measuring not just whether it has survived, but exactly how much it has grown, down to the millimetre. In a rapidly warming ocean, James hopes that understanding exactly which corals survive — and why — will help better inform future conservation efforts.

“How do you protect what you don’t understand?” he says. “We’re not just looking at how the reef is doing as a whole anymore — we’re telling the stories of thousands of corals.”

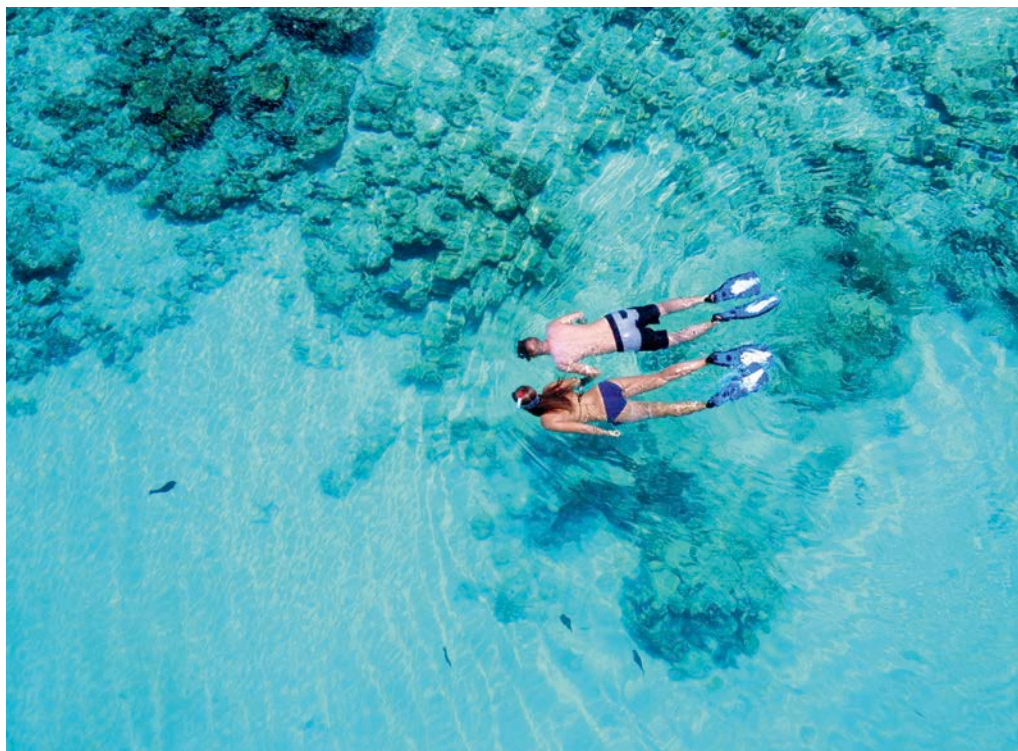
As we finish uploading the images from today’s dive, coral researcher John Stratford joins us on a video call from UCL, where he’s helping develop the technology behind the Coral Census. Together, he and James adapted it for use at Six Senses Kanuhura, allowing the resort’s marine biologists

“We’re not just looking at how the reef is doing as a whole anymore — we’re telling the stories of thousands of corals”

From left: The Maldives is home to around 1,200 coral islands built on ancient reef systems; James Cordery is helping transform coral conservation by turning resort dive sites into research hubs. Previous pages from left: The Maldives’ waters are among the clearest in the world; Six Senses Kanuhura combines island luxury with marine conservation.







“The goal is to understand these ecosystems well enough to make better decisions about how to protect them”

From left: The coral reefs in the Maldives are among the most biodiverse in the Indian Ocean, sheltering more than 1,000 species of fish, including clownfish; using 3D mapping and AI, scientists can now track coral colonies over time, revealing changes invisible to the human eye

IMAGES: GETTY

to monitor their reefs using the same technological standard as leading marine research institutions.

“I’d have been very sceptical of putting my name to clipboard data collected at a tourist resort,” John tells me. “Whereas this 3D model gives us a highly accurate record of exactly what was there at that moment in time.” That confidence, he says, is what made the partnership with Six Senses possible. “Before, I spent all of my research budget travelling to reefs around the world,” he says. “Then I thought: resorts are already in these incredible locations. They’ve got dive boats, dive access and people like James who are out there every day. It was an opportunity to dramatically expand the reach of coral research without the cost of mounting dedicated expeditions.”

Everything is connected

The next morning, I’m kayaking through the island’s seagrass meadows with Athif Mohamed, Six Senses Kanuhura’s resident turtle biologist and part of the first cohort to graduate from Maldives National University with a marine science degree.

From the kayak, the dark water filled with long ribbons of seagrass looks far less inviting than the coral reefs and turquoise lagoons I’d dived the day before. When Athif hands me my snorkel gear, I hesitate, but slip in anyway.

Below the waves, the seagrass dances in the current, catching the light and flickering through different shades of green. Hundreds of tiny oxygen bubbles cling to the blades before drifting towards the surface. Small fish weave between the swaying grass like they’re slipping through curtains. A baby blacktip reef shark, no longer than a ruler, glides

past. Then a pair of eagle rays skim low over the meadow, their wing-like fins brushing the seagrass as they chase one another through the shallows.

“They’re mating, which is rare to see,” Athif states. At just 23, he talks about the ocean with an infectious enthusiasm, breaking into a broad smile whenever he points out another species.

As we snorkel on, I notice ragged strips of white plastic snagged beneath the seagrass. “That was used to kill it,” Athif says. Before Six Senses took over the resort, plastic sheeting was laid across the seabed to smother the meadows in favour of the postcard turquoise lagoons visitors expected — something some Maldivian resorts continue to do, Athif tells me. Since then, Six Senses has removed around four tonnes of it in the hopes of reviving its seagrass meadows.

“Seagrass isn’t what tourists expect to see in the Maldives; they think it’s ugly. But it’s one of the most important ecosystems we have. Green turtles eat around two kilograms of it every day before returning to the reef to rest. Everything’s connected.”

While guiding guests through the lagoon, Athif and James record seagrass species and the animals that depend on it. This is still done by hand, but James has already begun applying the same AI tools used in the Coral Census to speed up the analysis — and hopes one day to map the meadows using photogrammetry, too. “I’d like to have the same level of understanding of the seagrass as we do of the reef,” says James. “The goal is to understand these ecosystems well enough to make better decisions about how to protect them.”

On my final morning, I snorkel out to a reef just beyond my overwater villa. Schools of surgeonfish and butterflyfish flicker around me, while tiny six-line wrasse dart between the coral. I linger over a large, ancient-looking boulder coral for a little longer than I usually would, wondering how much of its story remains invisible to the naked eye. Nearby, a handful of empty metal coral frames lie half-buried in the sand. Once considered one of the best tools for reef restoration, they now feel like a reminder of how much we still have to learn.

That afternoon, my seaplane lifts off for Malé. From above, the Maldives is every bit as breathtaking as it was when I arrived. But its future may depend less on the turquoise water that first captures visitors’ attention than on what lies hidden beneath it: a tiny new coral colony, a meadow of seagrass once dismissed as an eyesore, and the biologists returning day after day to understand them a little better. ■

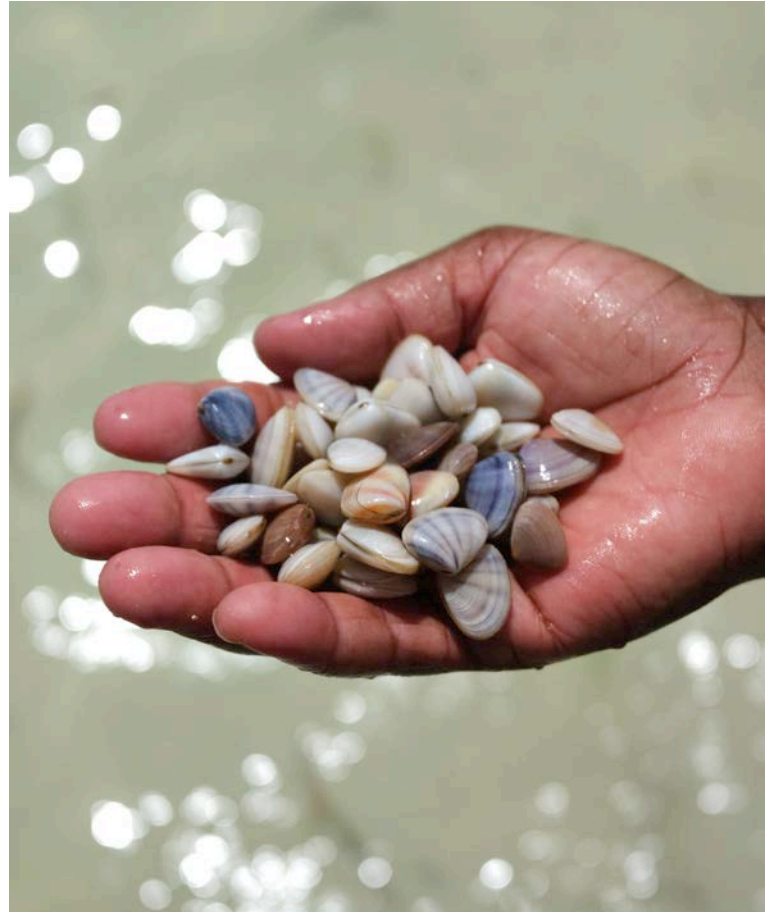
HOW TO DO IT: British Airways and Virgin Atlantic fly direct from Heathrow to Velana International Airport in Malé. Average flight time is 10-and-a-half hours. Six Senses Kanuhura is then reached by a 40-minute seaplane transfer. Rooms start from £757 per night, B&B. Return seaplane transfers from Malé cost US\$695 (£523) per adult. Marine conservation experiences can be arranged through the resort. ba.com virginatlantic.com sixsenses.com



THE MWANI MAMAS

On Zanzibar's east coast, a community of women harvests seaweed with the tides, preserving generations of knowledge while helping to shape a more sustainable future

WORDS & PHOTOGRAPHY: LEE-ANN OLWAGE



Off the coast of Tanzania, Zanzibar is famed for Stone Town's alleyways, fragrant spice plantations and blinding white beaches. But on the island's east coast, life follows a different beat, set not by the clock, but by the tides. At sunrise in the village of Paje, local women wade out into warm, shallow water to tend to seaweed farms that have sustained coastal communities for generations. Known as the Mwani Zanzibar Mamas, the collective was founded to give women a sustainable livelihood while safeguarding the marine world they depend on. Indigenous seaweed is trained along ropes beneath the surface, and left to drink in nutrients for around six weeks before it's harvested by hand. Timed to the ebbing tide, this daily ritual has become one of Zanzibar's most iconic coastal scenes, with women gathering armfuls of glistening seaweed as dawn light spreads across the bay.







For generations, Zanzibar's communities have understood the restorative qualities of seaweed, long before it became a sought-after ingredient in skincare. After harvesting, the crop is carefully cleaned and processed, traditional knowledge paired with scientific expertise to shape it into a range of soaps and skincare products. Founded by Klaartje Schade and Andrew Anthony, Mwani Zanzibar aims to build a regenerative blue economy that benefits people and ocean alike. Every bar of soap supports employment for local women while showcasing the value of sustainably farmed seaweed. By turning an abundant marine resource into high-quality skincare, the collective shows how conservation, cultural heritage and economic opportunity can thrive together, offering visitors a deeper connection to one of Zanzibar's most enduring coastal traditions. ▣

HOW TO DO IT: Tours to see the seaweed farm, plus a visit to the factory cost \$10 (£7) per person. zanizanzibar.com



THE NEXT

wellness frontier

WORDS: ELIZABETH BENNETT

Moonlit sandbank rituals, volcanic hikes to hidden beaches, treatments built around your own biology — across the Indian Ocean, islands are ditching the standardised spa menu for something wilder and far more personal

In the Indian Ocean, wellness is shedding its old skin. The Maldives, Seychelles, Mauritius and Sri Lanka have always drawn travellers chasing restorative breaks, but the era of the treatment menu and beachside lounge is giving way to something far wilder. Across these islands, properties are dreaming up wellness programmes that feel less like a spa day and more like a carefully curated encounter — with the landscape, the culture and, occasionally, your own biology.

Some properties are leaning into the raw drama of their surroundings, building rituals around full moons, ocean tides and misty hiking trails. Others are turning inward, drawing on centuries-old healing traditions like ayurveda, or on cutting-edge diagnostics that map guests' own biology. And some are stripping things back entirely, designing stays around the radical simplicity of switching off and staying present.





Clockwise from top right: At Niva Labriz Seychelles, Lime Wellbeing stands for Lifestyle, Intelligence, Mindfulness and Energy; the Waldorf Astoria Spa has six treatment suites; Gili Lankanfushi has just 45 overwater villas, making it one of the Maldives' most intimate luxury resorts. Previous pages: At Niva Velassaru, guests can paddleboard directly from the beach to the resort's reef restoration project

1 Hike from reef to ridge

NIVA LABRIZ, SEYCHELLES

Silhouette Island rises straight out of the water in steep, forested slopes — nearly 5,000 acres of protected rainforest cloaking the weathered remains of a 63-million-year-old volcano. Shaped by ancient eruptions, it feels almost prehistoric; a place where rare carnivorous pitcher plants, giant tortoises and endemic birds thrive. There are no roads threading through the interior, only hiking trails that wind across volcanic ridges, over granite outcrops and into valleys filled with hardwoods and cinnamon trees. Niva Labriz is the only resort here, a 45-minute boat ride from Mahé, and its new Lime wellbeing programme takes that landscape as its whole philosophy: reef to ridge, guided by a wellbeing team who know the island's quieter corners. The Anse Mondon Hike is the centrepiece — a two-and-a-half-hour trek through the jungle of endemic palms, an ascent of the volcano's flank for sweeping views over the Indian Ocean before descending to a beach that can only be reached on foot. No spa can manufacture that kind of arrival. **HOW TO DO IT:** Five nights at Niva Labriz Seychelles start from £1,223 per person, including breakfast and ferry transfers. nivalabriz.com

2 Chase the full moon

THE NAUTILUS, MALDIVES

No clocks. No schedules. No fixed hour for breakfast or check-out. On this speck of an island in the Baa Atoll Unesco Biosphere Reserve, time's set by the sky instead — and once a month, when the moon rises full over the palms, guests gather barefoot on the sand to greet it. The group Moonlit Renewal session unfolds as a sound bath under open stars: the resonant hum of a Tibetan singing bowl layered over the rhythm of the waves, aromatherapy drifting through both. For something more private, a yacht carries guests to a moonlit sandbank for the 60-minute Celestial Sandbank Escape — crystal bowls, dinner under the stars — while the 120-minute Lunar Serenity Spa Ritual pairs a warm oil massage with Shirodhara, the ancient ayurvedic practice of pouring warm oil steadily across the forehead as the moon does its work overhead.

HOW TO DO IT: Rates at The Nautilus Maldives start from \$19,390 (£14,500) in an Ocean House with Private Pool for seven nights between May and September, inclusive of return standard seaplane transfers for two people on a B&B basis. thenautilusmaldives.com

3 Let your biomarkers lead

WALDORF ASTORIA, SEYCHELLES

The first thing that happens here isn't a massage — it's a diagnosis. On this private island 80 miles south of Mahé, which has just 50 beachfront pool villas, every wellness journey begins with a 60-minute Medical Screening: non-invasive technology reads at least 30 biomarkers, from cardio fitness and oxygen distribution to stress and immune response. Rather than prescribing the same menu of treatments to every guest, therapists use the findings to create a programme shaped around individual needs. Guests on the Purify programme might move from a Detox Massage into an Ocean Essence Body Wrap; those on Restore combine Ayur-Abhyanga, a traditional full-body ayurvedic massage, with guided meditation and breathwork. It's wellness as bespoke prescription. **HOW TO DO IT:** Three nights at the Waldorf Astoria Hilton Seychelles Platte Island start from €3,720 (£3,190) for two adults sharing a One Bedroom Hawksbill Garden Pool Villa, including breakfast and transfers. The Medical Screening starts from €260 (£222) per person for 60 minutes; the Wellness programmes start from €2,200 (£1,885) per person for 60 minutes. hilton.com



4

Surrender to the sea

SUGAR BEACH, MAURITIUS

At Sugar Beach, the sea itself is the therapist. The new 90-minute Ocean Healing ritual takes place on the shoreline, where sound healing guides guests to synchronise their brainwaves with the rhythm of the waves. Morning Shalom, held at the water's edge, combines breathwork, body mapping and gentle coaching, encouraging guests to match each conscious breath to the pulse of the surf.

HOW TO DO IT: Book five nights at Sugar Beach from £414 per night. yoursunlife.com

5

Experience authentic ayurveda

SHANGRI-LA HAMBANTOTA, SRI LANKA

On Sri Lanka's southeast coast, Chi, The Spa, has partnered with Siddhalepa — a name synonymous with Sri Lankan ayurveda for more than 90 years. It begins with Prakruthi: a consultation with an ayurvedic doctor to assess underlying imbalances. Guests then follow programmes combining tailored meals, yoga, herbal therapies and treatments. Rings of dough filled with medicated oil rest on the lower back to ease pain, while heated herbal compresses induce sweat and release tension.

HOW TO DO IT: Programmes start from \$275 (£205) per day. shangri-la.com

6

Disconnect and reconnect

GILI LANKANFUSHI, MALDIVES

On arrival at Gili Lankanfushi, phones are swapped for a camera, with printed photographs available at the end of the stay, while each morning, Mr Friday — the resort's villa butler — delivers a personalised digest of the day's headlines over breakfast. A carefully chosen book awaits in every villa, encouraging guests to swap scrolling for reading.

HOW TO DO IT: Turquoise Holidays offers seven nights in a Villa Suite from £5,899. turquoiseholidays.co.uk □





IMAGES: SUGAR BEACH/NIVA LABRIZ



Sugar Beach's Sunlife Kids Club welcomes youngsters from the ages of two up to 11. From left to right: Set within 12 acres of tropical gardens, Sugar Beach is inspired by grand colonial estates; Mauritius's dramatic red-and-ochre cliffs are actually the exposed remains of ancient lava flow.

Greater than gold



Once among the world's most valuable commodities, spices transformed the Indian Ocean, enriching empires while weaving together the cultures, cuisines and communities of distant shores. Today, travellers can still follow those ancient routes through fragrant plantation visits, cooking classes and market tours

WORDS: DANIEL STABLES



1 Browse the spice souks of Muscat, Oman

Located on the Arabian Sea between Saudi Arabia, Yemen and the UAE, the seafaring nation of Oman has long been a link between East Africa, India and Southeast Asia. That story is told in the spice section of Muttrah Souk, the Omani capital's historic covered market, where technicolour cones of powdered ginger, turmeric and cumin sit alongside piles of frankincense rocks, bundled strands of saffron, and less familiar items like *loomi* — black, sun-dried limes.

The air hangs particularly heavy with the scent of frankincense, which Omanis use to perfume their homes, cars and traditional robes. Grown in the southern Omani region of Dhofar, as well as in the Horn of Africa, frankincense has long played a crucial role in Oman's spice trade networks, alongside cinnamon, cardamom and cloves. You can learn all about Oman's spice-route history — and sample the delicious ways in which it influences modern Omani cuisine — on a food tour with 365 Adventures. Visiting the home of a local family in Muscat, you'll sip cardamom coffee and learn the time-honoured techniques behind a variety of traditional dishes.

HOW TO DO IT: Food tours include visits to Muttrah Souk and a local family home, with prices on request. 365adventures.me/oman-food-tour

Clockwise from far left: Cinnamon, cloves, nutmeg and pepper fuelled the great trading voyages; Sri Lanka's coastline stretches for more than 1,000 miles; Muttrah Souk has traded spices for centuries

2 Peel cinnamon in southern Sri Lanka

Although cinnamon comes from several related tree species, Sri Lanka is home to *Cinnamomum verum* — known as true cinnamon and long considered the finest. Harvested from the delicate inner bark of the tree, its sweet, warming flavour and intoxicating aroma have made it one of the world's most prized spices for centuries. From ancient Egypt through the Roman era, cinnamon was valued as a luxury spice, used in rituals and embalming, while traders kept its origins secret to protect their lucrative monopoly.

Thankfully, the secret is now out. At Gradely Estate, 45 minutes outside Galle, you can wander through cinnamon groves, learning how the tree's slender stems are harvested and carefully peeled, and even try the process yourself. A visit to the working factory reveals how the bark is sun-dried, rolled into delicate quills and graded before being shipped around the world or ground into powder. Nearby, Cinnamon Walawwa offers the chance to experience cinnamon in another form: in the kitchen. Over spiced tea, you can learn to prepare cinnamon-infused curries in a lush garden setting.

HOW TO DO IT: In-depth plantation tours and factory visits at Gradely Estate start from 22,400 RS per person (£50). gradelyestate.com cinnamonwalawwa.com



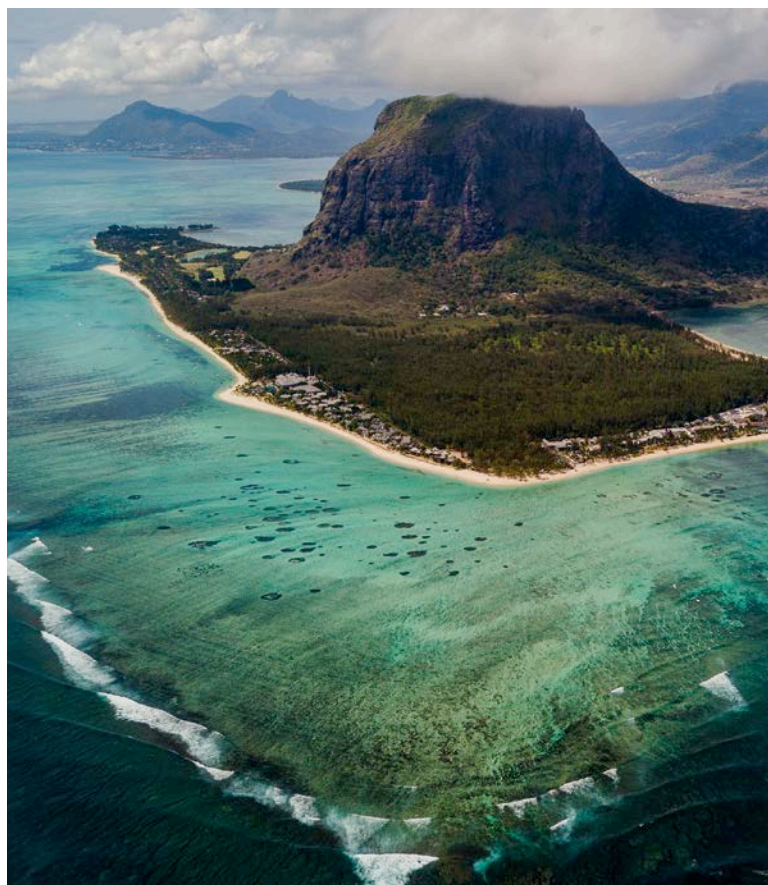
3 Cook with vanilla in Mauritius

Sweet, floral and instantly recognisable, vanilla is one of the world's most treasured flavours, and its story is one of ambition and botanical ingenuity. The plant is native to Mexico, where it's pollinated by specific bee species, but after many failed attempts to grow it elsewhere, a method of pollinating the delicate blooms by hand was discovered by a slave, Edmond Albius, in Mauritius's neighbour Réunion in 1841. Within decades, the two islands were supplying most of the world's vanilla.

Today, traditional farms such as Vanill'Art in southern Mauritius continue to use methods that have changed little since then. The vanilla orchid grows on filao wood, taking five years to flower. The pods spend nine months maturing on the vine before harvest, filling the surrounding orchards with their distinctive creamy, spicy fragrance.

Tours of Vanill'Art reveal the painstaking process behind this prized ingredient. You're also able to take part in a vanilla-infused rum workshop and enjoy a fragrant lunch featuring samosas and curries subtly flavoured with vanilla.

HOW TO DO IT: Vanill'Art is 50 minutes from Sir Seewoosagur Ramgoolam International Airport. Tours cost 3,500 MUR (£56) per person. vanillart.mu



Clockwise from left: The furry fruits of the lipstick tree are one of the many fascinating discoveries on a Zanzibar spice farm tour; Mauritius's position in the Indian Ocean made it a crossroads for spice traders; pickers climb and gather pepper berries by hand

4 Take a spice farm tour in Zanzibar

Not for nothing is Zanzibar known as the Spice Island. Nutmeg, cinnamon, cloves and cardamom are among the crops which fill the island's groves with a heady aroma, best experienced on a spice farm tour. Zanzibar Spice Co will lead you through traditional plantations in the village of Kisongoni, introducing you to local farmers who will demonstrate how they cultivate the island's rich bounty, from the expensive and labour-intensive vanilla to sweet, earthy turmeric. The plant thrives in the Zanzibari soil and is used as a cooking ingredient as well as a medicine for digestive complaints in Swahili culture.

After tasting some of the raw spices in the gardens in which they grow, you'll take a cooking class, where you'll learn to whip up fragrant, richly spiced dishes like *urojo* soup, flavoured with mango and turmeric; octopus curry with cardamom and cinnamon; and coconut-stewed beans flavoured with plenty of coriander and cumin. Be sure to leave room for the local coffee, spiced with nutmeg, cardamom, cinnamon and pepper. It promises to put a spring in your step after even the heaviest meal.

HOW TO DO IT: The village and farm tours cost \$10 (£7.50) per person, while the cooking class costs \$25 (£19) per person. zanzibarspice.com



5 Explore pepper plantations in Kerala, India

Indian cuisine is famous for its rich combinations of spices, with endemic flavours including turmeric, cardamom, cumin and curry leaf. Nowadays, hot chilli peppers are a crucial element of many fiery Indian dishes, but the ingredient didn't arrive in the country until the 16th century, when Portuguese explorers carried them along the spice routes from the Americas. Prior to this, it was black pepper which gave Indian dishes their heat, a native spice particularly associated with Kerala's Malabar Coast.

At Pepper Trail in the forested Wayanad district, you can discover the origins of the pepper trade while staying in a 140-year-old colonial-era bungalow surrounded by 200 acres of pepper and spice groves. Learn how pepper vines are trained to climb towering silver oak and mango trees before helping to harvest the just-ripe green fruits, which are then sun-dried into the black peppercorns we're all familiar with. A handful of fresh pepper berries makes for a fiery snack, while the hotel restaurant showcases the spice in dishes such as Kerala beef pepper fry, a piquant dry-roasted speciality.

HOW TO DO IT: A night at Pepper Trail, including farm tours, starts at 15,900 INR (£125) per night.

peppertail.in □





IMAGE: AWL IMAGES

Sri Lanka is one of the few places in the world where you can surf year-round, providing you switch coasts to avoid monsoon season

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DIRECTORY

AFRICA & THE INDIAN OCEAN

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- 42** | CHALE ISLAND RESORT
- 43** | LION IN THE SUN BOUTIQUE HOTEL & SPA
- 45** | THE ROCK & SEA
- 46** | CARDAMOM HOUSE
- 47** | TEMPLE POINT
- 48** | ANJAJAVY LE LODGE
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- 60** | HIDEAWAY BEACH RESORT & SPA
- 61** | HOTELS OF THE MALDIVES
- 63** | KANDIMA MALDIVES
- 64** | NOKU MALDIVES, VIGNETTE COLLECTION
- 65** | RAH GILI MALDIVES
- 66** | V VILLAS MALDIVES AT MIRIHI – MGALLERY COLLECTION
- 67** | SECRET PARADISE MALDIVES TOURS
- 68** | SUMMER ISLAND MALDIVES
- 69** | VAKKARU MALDIVES
- 70** | VILLA NAUTICA
- 71** | VILLA PARK
- 72** | LA PETITE FERME
- 73** | OBOË GARDENSTË
- 74** | ROYAL PALM BEACHCOMBER LUXURY

- 75** | LA MARIPOSA
- 76** | VILLA HARMONIE – ÎLOT FORTIER
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- 99** | HALCYON MAWELLA
- 100** | HILTON YALA RESORT
- 101** | KODDU KALPITIYA
- 102** | MOSVOLD VILLA
- 103** | ROMAN HOTELS
- 104** | SAMA RETREATS
- 105** | COASTAL ESCAPE NATAI
- 106** | KEEMALA



Mohéli Laka Lodge, Beach and Diving Resort

MOHÉLI, COMOROS

The smallest of the islands in the Comoros archipelago, Mohéli is recognised for its pristine reefs, forested hills, traditional villages and fragrant ylang-ylang, vanilla and clove plantations. It offers travellers a rare sense of wilderness, shaped by communities that live in close connection with the forest and the sea.

The island is home to Mohéli National Park and the Mwali Biosphere Reserve, recognised by Unesco for their exceptional marine and terrestrial biodiversity. Conservation efforts focus on protecting coral reefs, coastal habitats, rivers and remaining primary forests, while supporting sustainable development for local communities.

Set within the marine park at Nioumachoua, Mohéli Laka Lodge, Beach and Diving Resort occupies a beachside peninsula facing six uninhabited islets surrounded by coral reefs and marine life. The lodge offers full-board accommodation in a lush garden setting, with a large private beach and direct access to the ocean. Air-conditioned and ventilated rooms feature private terraces and bathrooms, with

ocean views and easy access to the shoreline. The Lagoon Lounge, located at the tip of the peninsula, provides panoramic views across the islets and is a memorable spot for watching the sunset.

Mohéli is an exceptional destination for diving. Still largely undiscovered by the wider diving community, its reefs are considered among the richest marine environments in the Mozambique Channel. Dive sites such as Mchaco Islet are recognised by specialists for their biodiversity. Divers may encounter coral gardens, dramatic drop-offs and hundreds of tropical reef species.

Beyond diving, the lodge organises a wide range of marine and forest excursions. Guests can observe the endemic Livingstone's fruit bat, one of the largest bat species in the world; witness green turtles nesting on the island's beaches; hike through subtropical forest and primary rainforest; discover hidden waterfalls; kayak or paddleboard through mangroves; and visit traditional villages. From August to late October, humpback whales return to Mohéli's waters, while dolphins and manta rays can also be spotted during the season.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Beachfront eco-bungalows
- Diving, snorkelling, whale-watching & guided nature activities
- Open-air restaurant serving local & international cuisine
- Air-conditioned rooms & free wi-fi in communal areas

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Excursions to spot manta rays, whales & dolphins
- Snorkelling over pristine coral reefs
- Guided hikes, wildlife encounters & waterfall excursions
- Scuba diving across more than 20 identified dive sites

GET IN TOUCH

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- info@lakalodge.com
- instagram.com/mohelilakalodge

DON'T MISS Look out for humpback whales, dolphins and manta rays in Mohéli's protected waters



Amkia Villas Diani

DIANI BEACH, KENYA

Set in a peaceful corner of Kenya's celebrated Diani Beach, Amkia Villas Diani offers an intimate coastal retreat where privacy, comfort and personalised service take centre stage. Just 15 minutes from Diani Airport and a 10-minute drive from the Indian Ocean's white-sand beaches, the boutique property is an ideal base.

With three villas and two apartment suites, the property has been designed to create a tranquil atmosphere away from the crowds. At its heart is a crystal-clear swimming pool surrounded by tropical gardens, with generous outdoor spaces inviting guests to unwind beneath the Kenyan sun.

The spacious two-bedroom villas combine contemporary style with practical comforts. Each features an open-plan living area leading to the pool, a fully equipped kitchen and a furnished rooftop deck that's perfect for sunset drinks or stargazing. A private chef can also be arranged on request, allowing guests to enjoy freshly prepared meals without leaving the comfort of their villa.

For couples or solo travellers, the one-bedroom apartment suites provide a stylish and private

escape. Occupying their own floor, each suite offers modern interiors, premium amenities and a fully equipped kitchen, creating a comfortable home-from-home.

Each accommodation option is fully air conditioned and fitted with ceiling fans to ensure a cool, comfortable stay throughout the year. Daily housekeeping, complimentary wi-fi and free parking add to the effortless experience.

Sustainability is woven into the property's design. Amkia Villas makes use of abundant natural light and generates around 80% of its electricity through a solar-roofed car park, helping to minimise its environmental impact without compromising on comfort.

Guests can spend lazy afternoons by the pool, enjoy peaceful garden views from their private balcony or terrace, or venture out to discover Diani's spectacular coastline. Optional excursions include snorkelling trips, glass-bottom boat tours, beach walks and swimming in the warm waters of the Indian Ocean. Private wellness experiences can also be arranged on request.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Swimming pool
- Furnished rooftop deck (villas)
- Garden barbecue grill
- Mature tropical gardens
- Chef on request
- Daily housekeeping
- Complimentary wi-fi
- Free parking

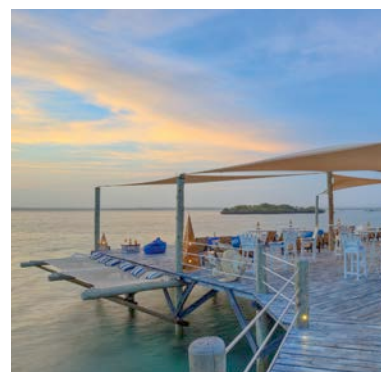
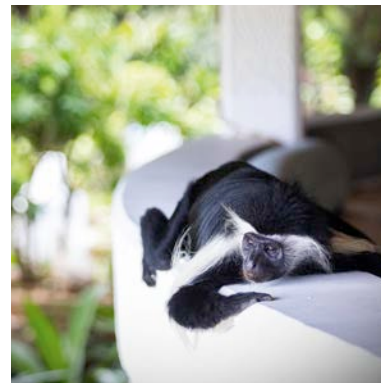
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Snorkelling excursions
- Glass-bottom boat trips
- Beach walks
- Swimming
- Private wellness experiences available on request

GET IN TOUCH

- amkiadiani.com
- +254 745 568939
- reservations@amkia.villas
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DON'T MISS Spend an evening stargazing from the rooftop deck before taking a peaceful midnight swim beneath the stars



Chale Island Resort

SOUTH COAST, KENYA

A wave of tranquillity embraces everyone who steps foot on this magical private island retreat, just a few minutes off Kenya's south coast. Forged by nature and rich in folklore, Chale Island has been capturing hearts for centuries. A single, recently refurbished resort on the island offers guests — many of whom are coming to stay at the end of a wildlife-fuelled safari in the Maasai Mara or beyond — the chance to relax and rejuvenate with modern comforts, inspired by traditional Swahili design.

Time slows at Chale Island — there are no schedules to keep and guests are invited to choose their own itineraries. There are no better ambassadors of the slow life at Chale Island than the indigenous troops of colobus monkeys that blend into day-to-day life. Whether they're relaxing on the walls of the Tamu Tamu Cafeteria, sitting in the trees snacking on leaves or simply catching the cooling Indian Ocean breeze, their embrace of this laid-back way of life is mesmerising and infectious, epitomising a stay at Chale Island. One of nature's oldest survivors and another advocate of the slow life, the green sea turtle

can also be seen around Chale Island, which is a nesting site for these magnificent creatures.

Discover a feast of flavours spanning cuisines and cultures at the resort's seven restaurants, offering everything from al fresco dining under a star-studded sky to an intimate private beach dinner with the sand beneath your toes. Fresh seafood is served seated overlooking the ocean, while the finest locally sourced sashimi and freshly made sushi are just part of the extensive offering for lunch and dinner.

For those wanting to push relaxation levels further, Maisha Poa Spa is perched around a mangrove lake in the heart of the resort and provides the perfect ambience in which to disconnect and immerse yourself in indigenous-influenced treatments and products.

Guests wanting to dive deeper into the abundance of nature and wildlife around Chale Island can set off snorkelling and scuba diving or try kayaking and standup paddleboarding amid the mangroves. A marine biologist is on site and the resort has close ties to local conservation groups such as the Colobus Conservation Centre and Diani Turtle Watch.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 7 a la carte dining experiences
- Organic juice & ice cream parlour
- Curated wine cellar
- Meeting room
- Boutique
- Games room
- CrossFit gym
- Extensive wellness spa with organic beauty products
- Marine Center with on-site marine biologist
- PADI dive school
- & watersports centre
- 3 swimming pools

GET IN TOUCH

- chaleislandresort.com
- +254 709 538 880
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DON'T MISS Keep an eye out for the mesmerising indigenous colobus monkeys frolicking around the resort



Lion in the Sun Boutique Hotel & Spa

MALINDI, KENYA

Set along Kenya's Indian Ocean coastline, Malindi remains one of East Africa's most captivating luxury destinations. Surrounded by tropical gardens within the protected marine park area, Lion in the Sun Boutique Hotel & Spa offers a refined retreat where privacy, authentic design and immersive local experiences come together.

Inspired by traditional Swahili architecture, the property blends handcrafted wooden details, *makuti* roofs, African art and natural materials to create an atmosphere that feels both elegant and connected to its surroundings. Rooms, suites and private villas are thoughtfully positioned throughout lush gardens, offering generous spaces designed for relaxation and seclusion.

Beyond the accommodation, the property invites guests to embrace the Kenyan coast. Days unfold between peaceful pools, tranquil gardens, direct beach access and a wellness sanctuary dedicated to restoration through seawater hydrotherapy, thalassotherapy, massages and personalised wellness programmes. Treatments draw inspiration from the healing qualities of the ocean,

combining marine minerals, restorative rituals and carefully selected skincare.

Malindi itself offers far more than idyllic beaches. Offshore, the protected coral reef and crystal-clear lagoons reveal exceptional snorkelling opportunities, while traditional dhow cruises glide through the mangroves of nearby Mida Creek, where kingfishers, fish eagles and migratory birds inhabit one of Kenya's richest coastal ecosystems. Depending on the tides, guests can enjoy breakfast or sunset aperitifs on secluded sandbanks surrounded by the Indian Ocean.

The region also rewards curious travellers with remarkable cultural discoveries. The UNESCO-listed Gede Ruins, once a thriving Swahili trading town hidden beneath an ancient forest, provide a fascinating glimpse into East Africa's medieval history. Local markets showcase handcrafted wood carvings, colourful fabrics, woven baskets and jewellery that reflect generations of coastal craftsmanship, while nearby Marafa Canyon, often called 'Hell's Kitchen', reveals dramatic sandstone formations sculpted by wind and time.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Boutique rooms, suites & private villas
- Spa & thalassotherapy centre
- Swimming pool & gardens
- Beach access & signature dining

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Traditional dhow & sandbank cruises
- Snorkelling in the marine park
- Tsavo East National Park safari
- Wellness & spa rituals

GET IN TOUCH

- lioninthesun.com
- +254 705 437307
- malindi.reservations@billionairesociety.com
- instagram.com/lioninthesunmalindi

DON'T MISS Take a sunset dhow cruise with aperitifs among Malindi's secluded sandbanks and turquoise waters



— THE —
ROCK & SEA

Bubble Ecolodge & Panoramic Restaurant

There are destinations.
And then there are discoveries.

BUBBLE LODGES • PANORAMIC RESTAURANT • JUA SPA • POOL & WHIRLPOOL BATH
Dhow Experiences • Horse Haven • Jungle Gym • SUP - *Paddle into serenity.*

WATAMU - KENYA

www.therockandsea.com



The Rock & Sea

WATAMU, KENYA

Before sunrise, Mida Creek rests in silence. As the tide ebbs, the intricate roots of the mangroves emerge from the water, revealing a landscape in constant transformation. African fish eagles begin their morning flight while, beyond the winding channels, the Indian Ocean catches the first light of dawn and the distant hills of Tsavo National Park appear on the horizon.

Perched more than 30 metres above sea level in Watamu, few places reveal so many contrasting landscapes in a single view. The Indian Ocean, the ever-changing waters of Mida Creek — one of East Africa's largest mangrove ecosystems — and the vast Arabuko Sokoke Forest unfold. It was this extraordinary place that inspired the vision behind The Rock & Sea.

The vision was never to compete with nature, but to become part of it. Rather than asking what could be built on the land, the question became: 'how little was needed to ensure that nature remained the true protagonist?'

Finding accommodation that reflected those values proved as important as choosing the

location itself. Bubble Lodges were selected not simply because they were distinctive, but because their transparent design dissolves the boundary between shelter and wilderness. Here, sleeping beneath a canopy of stars, waking as dawn breaks and remaining immersed in the surrounding landscape become part of the experience itself.

Life at The Rock & Sea is measured less by the clock than by nature's rhythms. Mornings begin with birdsong drifting through the mangroves as the first light spreads across the creek. There's no fixed itinerary — only the freedom to explore Mida Creek by paddleboard, sail aboard *Pepo Huru* — a traditional Swahili dhow — learn the traditional art of Maasai archery, unwind at Jua Spa, explore the surrounding landscape on horseback, experience the forest-canopy Jungle Gym or simply linger on the restaurant terrace, where authentic Italian and Mediterranean cuisine celebrates the finest seafood from the Indian Ocean.

With only five individually designed lodges, The Rock & Sea has deliberately remained intimate, allowing the landscape to define every stay.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Bubble Lodges
- Restaurant
- Saltwater pool & whirlpool bath
- Jua spa

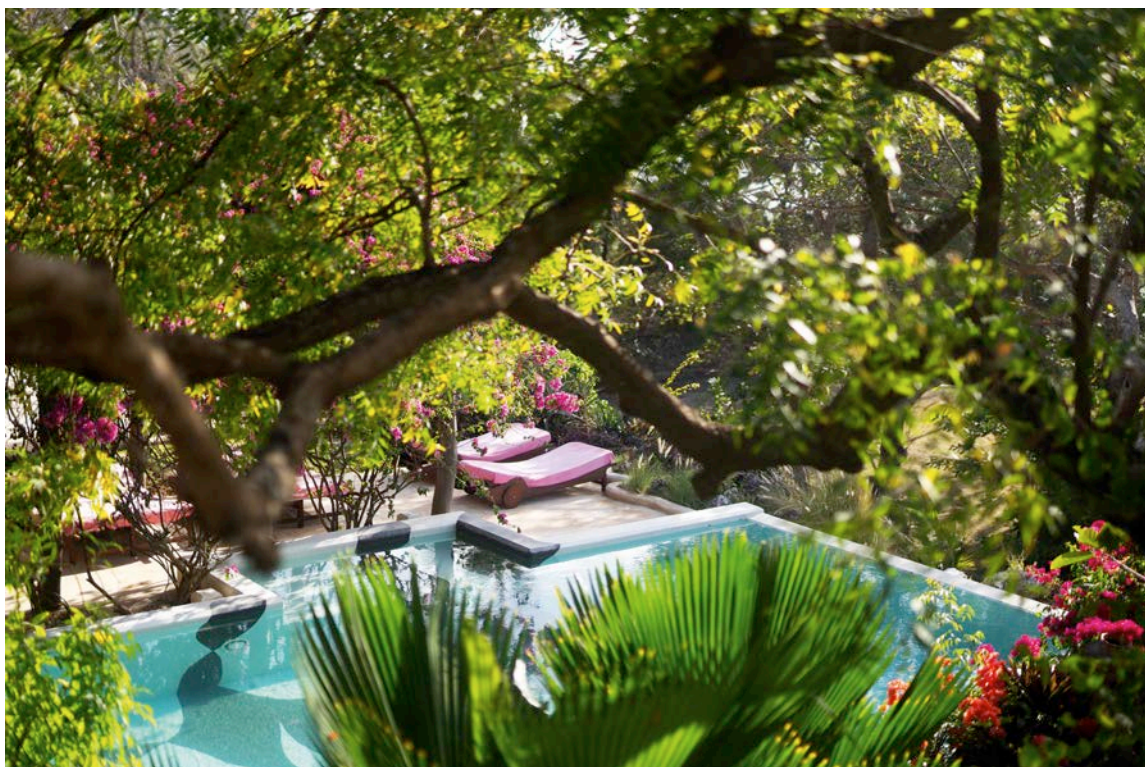
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Paddleboarding on Mida Creek
- Traditional Swahili dhow cruises
- Horse-riding
- Forest-canopy jungle gym

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Watch the sun set over Mida Creek before dining beneath a sky filled with stars



Cardamom House

MOMBASA, KENYA

Hidden along a secluded stretch of Kenya's coastline, Cardamom House is an intimate beach retreat where barefoot luxury, privacy and nature come together. Once a historic Swahili home, it has been reimagined into an elegant beach lodge where minimalist Swahili architecture blends with contemporary Afro-chic design. Natural textures, handcrafted details and interiors inspired by the turquoise waters of the Indian Ocean create a sanctuary that enhances the landscape.

Far from the busy beaches and resorts north of Mombasa, Cardamom House enjoys a privileged setting on one of Kenya's unspoiled stretches of coastline. Here, guests experience a slower side of the Indian Ocean, where tranquillity, nature and exclusivity take centre stage.

Nestled within lush tropical gardens, the property offers tranquillity and privacy. Spacious suites, secluded lounges and hidden pathways invite guests to slow down and reconnect with nature. Whether relaxing by the infinity pool, unwinding on the empty beach or enjoying a private beach banda, every moment feels wonderfully personal.

One of the highlights is the rooftop lounge in the property's iconic tower, where handcrafted cocktails and gourmet canapes are served as the sun sets. Dining at Cardamom House is entirely personalised. There are no fixed meal times or set menus. Instead, you're invited to your own personal culinary journey, served wherever you choose. Savour the freshest catch of the day, exquisite seafood, locally sourced ingredients and fine wines in a variety of unforgettable settings, from the elegant main house and pool terrace to the beach, tropical gardens, the firepit or the private terrace of your suite.

Every stay is curated by a personal concierge, allowing guests to tailor each day to their wishes. Relax with an in-suite massage, enjoy private yoga overlooking the ocean, explore the coastline by kayak or paddleboard, sail the turquoise waters or discover nearby villages on a guided cultural walk.

At Cardamom House, luxury is defined by space, serenity and authenticity. With intuitive service, complete privacy and a deep connection to nature, it offers travellers an exclusive retreat and reveals the timeless beauty of Kenya's Indian Ocean coastline.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 2 penthouses & 8 suites
- Tropical gardens with beach access
- Infinity swimming pool
- More than 12 unique dining locations
- Rooftop sunset lounge
- Show kitchen, wine cellar and firepit

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Swimming, snorkelling & diving
- Paddleboarding & kayaking
- Guided snorkelling tours & reef walks
- Private boat trips
- Seasonal whale- & dolphin-watching
- Yoga & workouts with personal trainer
- In-suite & outdoor massages

GET IN TOUCH

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- bookings@secludedafrica.com
- [instagram.com/@secludedafricalodges](https://www.instagram.com/secludedafricalodges)

DON'T MISS Watch the sunset from the rooftop tower with handcrafted cocktails and gourmet canapes overlooking the Indian Ocean



Temple Point

WATAMU, KENYA

Temple Point sits on a headland where Mida Creek meets the Indian Ocean, its tropical gardens appearing as though nature designed them itself. Barefoot paths connect bungalows and quiet corners throughout the grounds, creating an effortless sense of arrival. Vegetables served on the property are grown in its own greenhouses, cared for with the same attention guests receive throughout their stay.

The resident monkeys have never read the guest handbook — they move through the gardens on their own mysterious missions, adding to the feeling that Temple Point is a place to observe rather than control. A secluded mini beach, set within the Unesco-recognised Watamu Marine Park, offers some of the coast's best snorkelling, while the on-site dive school opens up the underwater world.

One of the property's most memorable experiences takes place at Musafir, a floating dining and bar setting on Mida Creek, reached by boat from LichtHaus. Guests arrive at dusk as the mangroves begin to darken, with dinner shaped around the natural surroundings. LichtHaus itself sits above the water on netted decking, known for

its sunsets, daily barbecues and occasional jazz evenings. Elsewhere, CreekHaus Spa, Gym & Tonic fitness studio, a yoga deck beneath a majestic baobab tree, KunstHaus Boutique and A Liddell's coffeeshop complete the experience.

Beyond the property, Watamu offers remarkable history and wilderness. Arabuko Sokoke Forest, one of East Africa's last significant coastal forest reserves, lies nearby, while the Gede Ruins reveal the remains of a Swahili town that flourished between the 13th and 17th centuries. Temple Point carries its own link to this past, with ancient ruins, believed to date back centuries, standing within its gardens. For those looking further afield, Tsavo East National Park is around 90 minutes away, offering the chance to encounter red-soil elephants, lions and cheetahs beneath evening skies.

Watamu remains wonderfully unhurried, around two-and-a-half hours by road from Mombasa, with properties spaced along the coast rather than crowded together. July to March offers the best conditions, although warm waters make the distinction less important.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Secluded mini beach & on-site dive school
- LichtHaus restaurant & bar
- CreekHaus Spa & Gym & Tonic fitness studio
- Musafir floating dining (Mida Creek)

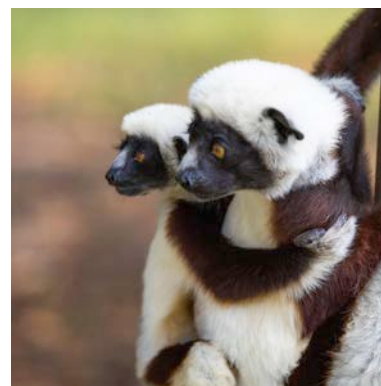
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Dusk dining aboard the Musafir dhow
- Snorkelling & diving
- Day trips to Arabuko Sokoke Forest, Gede Ruins & Tsavo East
- Yoga deck sessions beneath a baobab tree

GET IN TOUCH

- templepoint.com
- +254 707 634 098
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DON'T MISS Watch endangered turtles feed on seagrass just off LichtHaus's over-the-water hammocks



Anjajavy Le Lodge

ANJAJAVY PENINSULA, MADAGASCAR

Set on a remote peninsula along Madagascar's northwest coast, Anjajavy Le Lodge lies within a protected area and reserve spanning more than 24,700 acres of dry forest, mangroves, pristine beaches and striking limestone formations.

Accessible exclusively by private aircraft, the property offers rare access to one of the Indian Ocean's most untouched natural environments.

The lodge's rosewood villas are carefully integrated into the landscape, overlooking the Mozambique Channel while maintaining a strong sense of privacy and immersion in nature. Wildlife encounters form a central part of the experience, with lemurs moving freely through the forest and a remarkable diversity of birdlife marking the rhythm of each day. The surrounding reserve represents one of Madagascar's most significant biodiversity hotspots, with a high concentration of endemic species found nowhere else on Earth.

A defining feature of the property is its role in conservation. The reserve provides refuge for rare wildlife, including Coquerel's sifaka, a distinctive lemur known for its sideways movement across the

forest floor. The presence of Aldabra giant tortoises, successfully reintroduced and now thriving, highlights the lodge's long-term environmental commitment. Together, these efforts make the reserve one of Madagascar's most successful examples of private conservation.

Gastronomy at the lodge reflects both place and philosophy. Inspired by the Relais & Châteaux approach, cuisine showcases locally sourced ingredients, including freshly caught seafood, seasonal produce from the lodge's gardens and traditional Malagasy spices. Dining settings range from oceanfront terraces to secluded beach locations, creating memorable culinary experiences shaped by the natural surroundings.

Beyond the lodge is a rich cultural and ecological landscape. Nearby Sakalava villages provide an insight into regional traditions, while there are guided excursions to mangrove ecosystems, dramatic *tsingy* (limestone karst rock) formations and iconic baobab trees. The combination of coastal, forest and limestone environments within a single reserve creates a remarkable diversity of experiences.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Private rosewood villas with direct beach access
- Ocean-view swimming pool
- Fine-dining restaurant showcasing local ingredients
- Private protected nature reserve

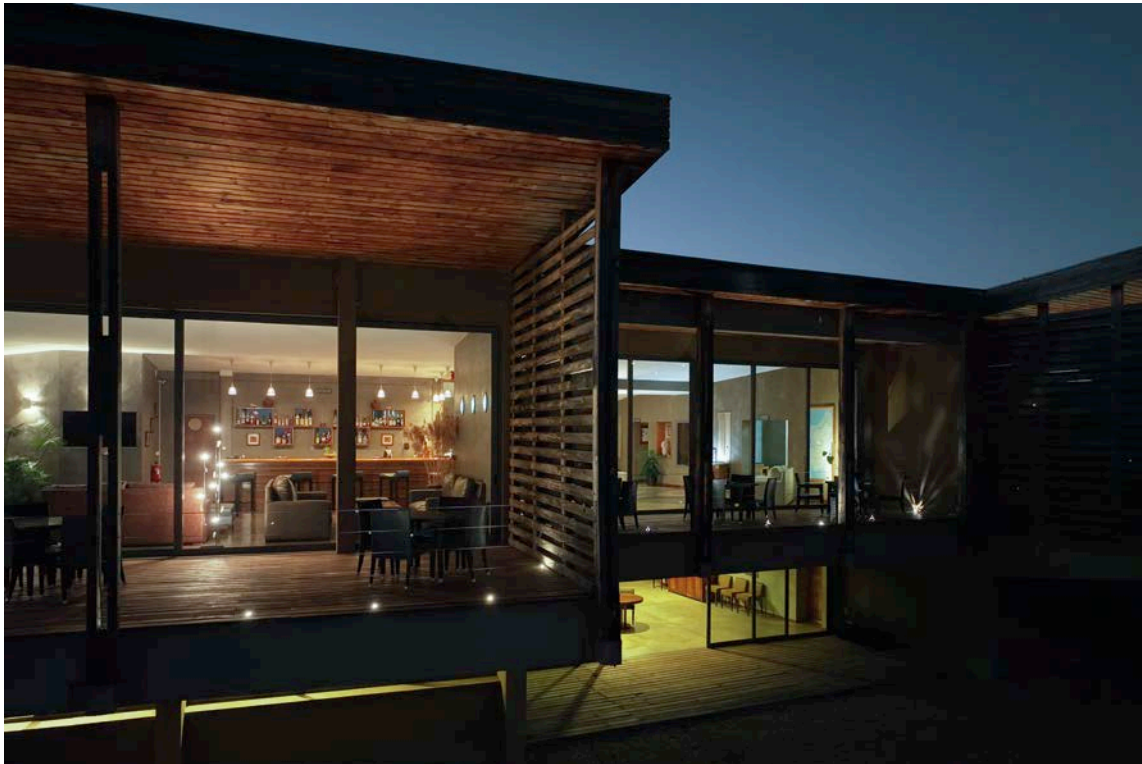
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Spot lemurs & giant tortoises in the reserve
- Guided forest & nature hikes
- Boat excursions through Moramba Bay
- Explore mangroves, *tsingy* formations & baobab forests

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Witness Coquerel's sifakas leap through the forest, before dining barefoot on the beach at sunset



Isalo Rock Lodge

ISALO NATIONAL PARK, MADAGASCAR

Set amid the extraordinary sandstone landscapes of southern Madagascar, Isalo Rock Lodge offers a stylish base from which to explore one of the island's most spectacular natural regions. Spanning around 50 acres in the Ihorombe region, the four-star lodge blends contemporary comfort with an authentic sense of place, framed by sweeping views of the iconic rock formations and canyons of Isalo National Park.

Designed to sit naturally within its surroundings, the lodge is built using eco-sustainable materials and generates more than half of its electricity through an environmentally responsible photovoltaic system, helping to minimise its impact in this remote corner of Madagascar.

The property offers 60 spacious guest rooms across three categories. Superior Rooms enjoy uninterrupted views of the sandstone massifs, while Standard and Economy Rooms provide the same generous layouts and modern amenities in a more secluded setting. Warm Malagasy hospitality begins on arrival, with refreshing scented towels and fragrances inspired by the island's native plants.

Nature takes centre stage here. Guests can follow the lodge's own Pachypodium Trail through rolling hills dotted with the unusual succulent plants for which it is named, passing a natural swimming pool before reaching a panoramic viewpoint that offers one of the region's finest sunset vistas. Beyond the estate lies Isalo National Park, renowned for its dramatic canyons, sculpted sandstone formations, natural pools and remarkable biodiversity. Guided hikes reveal a landscape home to ring-tailed lemurs, sifakas, endemic birds and unique plant life found nowhere else on Earth.

After a day of exploration, guests can unwind beside the infinity pool overlooking the mountains or indulge in a relaxing massage at the wellness centre. Aloalo Restaurant celebrates Madagascar's rich culinary heritage with dishes prepared from fresh local ingredients alongside international favourites, while the terrace provides spectacular views across the surrounding landscape. As evening falls, Papango Bar is the perfect place to enjoy a cocktail as the sandstone cliffs glow in the warm light of sunset.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 60 guest rooms across 3 accommodation categories
- Infinity swimming pool with panoramic mountain views
- Aloalo Restaurant serving Malagasy and international cuisine
- Papango Bar with sunset terrace
- Fitness room
- 50-acre estate

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Guided hikes in Isalo National Park
- Wildlife-spotting, including lemurs and endemic birdlife
- Cycling and outdoor exploration
- Spa and wellness treatments
- Cultural experiences

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Watch the sun set over Isalo's sandstone formations, when the landscape is transformed into shades of crimson



Komba Cabana Beach & Forest Lodge

NOSY KOMBA, MADAGASCAR

Komba Cabana Lodge, on Nosy Komba in Madagascar, offers travellers a peaceful escape. Often referred to as ‘Lemur Island’, Nosy Komba is known for its lush landscapes, pristine beaches and rich biodiversity.

One of the main advantages of staying at Komba Cabana Lodge is its location, providing direct access to tranquil beaches and crystal-clear waters. The property features charming bungalows built in harmony with the natural surroundings, offering guests an eco-friendly and authentic experience. The bungalows are constructed from local materials, such as granite and palm leaves.

Komba Cabana Lodge places a strong emphasis on sustainability and preserving the local environment. In addition to sourcing fresh seafood and local fruit, the lodge uses solar energy to meet its energy needs. Komba Cabana Lodge also contributes to the preservation of traditional Malagasy culture, offering guests the chance to experience local customs such as visiting a nearby fishing village, where they can observe the daily catch or watch skilled artisans create handmade clay pots.

Nosy Komba Island is also home to a variety of wildlife, including its famous lemurs. Travellers can enjoy guided walks through verdant forests, where they may encounter black lemurs, chameleons and numerous bird species. Lemurs on Nosy Komba are particularly friendly — it’s claimed that they’re protected by spiritual taboos (known as ‘fady’), said to help ensure their safety and preservation.

Guests can also enjoy strolling through the gardens, which focus on preserving Madagascar’s biodiversity. The gardens are designed with sustainability in mind and offer a peaceful haven for nature- and plant-lovers. Snorkelling adventures in the crystal-clear waters surrounding the island and the nearby Nosy Tanikely marine reserve unveil vibrant coral reefs and a diverse array of marine life.

The dining experience at Komba Cabana restaurant is another highlight, focusing on fresh seafood and a blend of traditional Malagasy cuisine with international flavours. Guests can enjoy their meals outdoors, surrounded by the sounds and sights of nature, adding to the relaxing island atmosphere.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Beachfront bungalows
- Jungle ‘glamps’
- Restaurant
- Botanical gardens
- Standup paddleboards

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Snorkelling
- Hiking
- Boat excursion
- Wildlife-watching

GET IN TOUCH

- kombacabana.com
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DON'T MISS Take a guided hike to explore the lush interior of the island and view its friendly, famous residents — black lemurs



Miremby

MADAGASCAR

Stretching for more than 3,100 miles, Madagascar's coastline is remarkably diverse. In the south, secluded white-sand beaches meet the turquoise waters of the Mozambique Channel, while colourful *pirogues* (traditional outrigger canoes) set out each morning from fishing villages. Coral reefs, mangrove forests and sheltered lagoons provide the backdrop for slow, immersive travel, where every experience is rooted in local knowledge.

Each of Miremby's itineraries is created in partnership with the communities visited, opening the door to experiences that go far beyond the guidebooks. Share freshly caught seafood grilled over charcoal on an untouched beach, paddle through mangrove channels with local fishermen, discover traditional coastal livelihoods or spend an evening listening to Malagasy music.

The Indian Ocean is also home to extraordinary wildlife. Between July and September, humpback whales migrate through Madagascar's coastal waters to breed and calve, offering unforgettable opportunities to observe them respectfully from traditional *pirogues*. Sea turtles nest on remote

beaches, dolphins are frequently spotted offshore and vibrant coral reefs teem with tropical fish.

Beyond the shoreline, southern Madagascar offers landscapes where the coast and wilderness meet. Encounter ring-tailed lemurs and sifaka in unique dry forests before ending the day beside the Indian Ocean, or explore the dramatic sandstone formations of Isalo National Park before continuing to the beaches of Ifaty or the remote coastline around Fort Dauphin.

Every journey at Miremby is tailored to guests' style of travel, with accommodation options ranging from intimate beachfront lodges and boutique hotels to welcoming community-run guesthouses offering an authentic insight into coastal life.

Miremby's close partnerships with conservation organisations and local communities give travellers a deeper understanding of Madagascar's fragile coastal environments and the challenges they face. Every journey also supports The Miremby Foundation, helping to co-create projects in conservation, education and community development across southern Madagascar.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Bespoke itineraries with a dedicated private driver & guide
- Handpicked beachfront lodges & boutique accommodation
- Community-led coastal experiences
- Seamless end-to-end travel planning

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Whale-watching from traditional Malagasy *pirogues*
- Snorkelling & diving
- Mangrove & lagoon excursions with local guides
- Fresh seafood dining & Malagasy culinary experiences
- Community visits, crafts & conservation experiences

GET IN TOUCH

- mirembby.com
- 07457 402703
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DON'T MISS Set out by traditional *pirogue* to watch humpback whales along Madagascar's wild and untouched southern coastline



Tribes Travel Collection

NOSY BE, MADAGASCAR

Tribes Travel Collection brings together a curated portfolio of distinctive island stays on Nosy Be, off the northern coast of Madagascar. Combining refined hospitality with a deep sense of place, the collection offers a range of experiences that reflect the island's cultural richness, biodiversity and natural beauty.

At the heart of the collection is the four-star Palm Beach Resort & Spa, a beachfront property known for its elegant atmosphere and uninterrupted ocean views. Spacious rooms and suites overlook tropical gardens, while the restaurant serves a buffet of Malagasy and international cuisine, featuring locally sourced ingredients such as vanilla and cacao.

The spa incorporates these native botanicals into its treatments, creating a wellness experience inspired by the island's natural resources. Its beachfront setting also provides easy access to daily private cruises, diving excursions, marine adventures and guided treks inland.

Closer to the island's lively centre, the three-star Izil Hotel offers a more informal and convivial

alternative. Designed with flexibility in mind, it's particularly well suited to travellers on shorter stays. Guests can experience the warmth of Malagasy hospitality through vibrant menus showcasing local produce, fresh seafood and zebu. Excursions introduce visitors to the island's endemic wildlife, including lemurs and rare chameleons, while daily speedboat trips explore the surrounding archipelago.

Looking ahead, MilaMina, opening in 2027, will introduce an intimate five-star retreat. Designed to balance comfort and luxury, it will blend contemporary style with traditional Malagasy and Indian Ocean influences. Experiences will combine spa treatments, fine dining and the simple pleasure of relaxing beside a unique beachfront swimming pool. At all properties, Tribes Fitness will offer guests a fully equipped gym, tennis, padel, basketball and football courts.

Beyond its properties, Tribes Travel Collection encourages guests to discover the island of Madagascar more deeply, from cacao plantations in Ambanja to the vibrant Hell-Ville Market.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Palm Beach Resort & Spa – beachfront luxury, dining & wellness
- Izil Hotel – family-friendly, flexible accommodation
- MilaMina (opening 2027) wellness retreat
- Tribes Travel Collection DMC – curated travel & destination services

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Wellness experiences & spa rituals
- Packages for families, couples & groups
- Sea & land adventure excursions
- Cultural discovery tours & local immersion

GET IN TOUCH

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- booking@tribes-collection.com

DON'T MISS Enjoy a private candlelit dinner on the panoramic rooftop with a menu showcasing fresh seafood and locally caught lobster



Adaaran Select Meedhupparu

RAA ATOLL, MALDIVES

Set amid the crystal-clear waters of the Raa Atoll, Adaaran Select Meedhupparu invites guests to discover the Maldives at its most authentic, a harmonious blend of natural beauty, adventure and island hospitality. Reached via a seaplane journey from Malé, this tropical island, framed by towering banyan trees, powder-soft beaches and turquoise lagoons, is the perfect place to unwind.

Whether travelling as a couple or with family, the resort's accommodation has been thoughtfully designed to embrace the beauty of its surroundings. Beach Villas open directly onto pristine white sands, while spacious Family Beach Villas provide the ideal setting for quality time together. Inspired by the colours of the Indian Ocean, each villa combines contemporary comfort with relaxed island charm, featuring modern amenities, complimentary wi-fi and breathtaking views just moments from the shore.

At Adaaran Select Meedhupparu, the Premium All-Inclusive experience extends far beyond exceptional dining and premium beverages to create a truly effortless island holiday.

Guests can savour a diverse culinary journey across four restaurants, four bars and Café Mass, each offering its own distinctive atmosphere and flavours. From international buffets at Jaafaay Restaurant and authentic Indian specialities at Sufura to Mediterranean-inspired cuisine at Thavaa, every meal celebrates fresh ingredients and global influences. The resort's lively bars, including the renowned Albino Bar with its impressive selection of 101 cocktails, ensure memorable evenings from sunset until late.

Surrounded by vibrant coral reefs and abundant marine life, the resort is a paradise for ocean enthusiasts. Guests can snorkel directly from the shore, explore world-class dive sites or embark on dolphin and sunset cruises across the Indian Ocean. For those seeking a more active escape, there are complimentary non-motorised watersports, including standup paddleboarding, canoeing, windsurfing and catamaran sailing. On land, tennis, badminton, beach volleyball and a fully equipped fitness centre ensure there's something for every traveller.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Premium all-inclusive resort with a range of accommodation options
- 4 restaurants, 4 bars & Café Mass
- Koamas Kids' Club, evening entertainment & beach parties
- Shopping arcade, laundry service & resident doctor

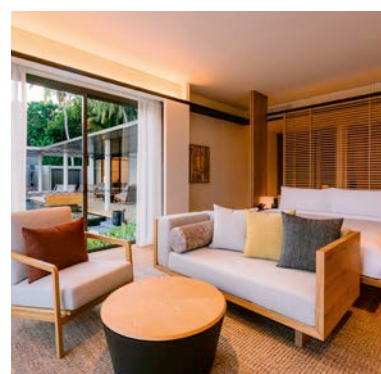
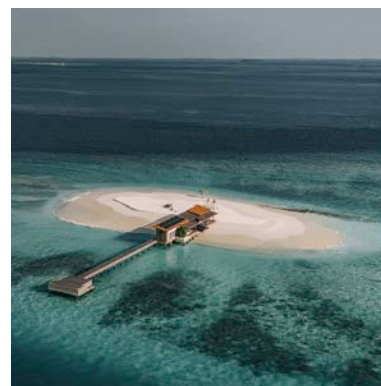
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Snorkelling, scuba diving & SSI diving courses on the vibrant house reef
- Free watersports including paddleboarding, canoeing & sailing
- Dolphin safaris, sunset cruises, sandbank picnics & fishing excursions

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Snorkel directly from the shore, explore world-class dive sites or embark on unforgettable dolphin and sunset cruises



Alila Kothaifaru Maldives, A Hyatt Resort

RAA ATOLL, MALDIVES

Set on a 28-acre private island in Raa Atoll at the northern edge of the Maldives, Alila Kothaifaru Maldives is a Hyatt resort offering a serene escape defined by space, privacy and a close connection to nature. The resort is accessible via a 45-minute seaplane journey from Velana International Airport, and is surrounded by turquoise waters, a vibrant house reef and the untouched beauty of one of the archipelago's most tranquil destinations.

Alila Kothaifaru Maldives comprises 41 beachfront villas, 36 overwater villas, three two-bedroom beach villas and the exclusive Boduge residence, with every accommodation featuring a private pool. The newly introduced two-bedroom beach villas provide the ideal setting for shared holidays, while the Boduge residence represents the pinnacle of island living. This exclusive retreat features a fully equipped kitchenette, elegant dining and living areas, a private pool and outdoor barbecue space. For larger gatherings, the residence can seamlessly connect to a neighbouring villa, creating an expansive three-bedroom sanctuary for milestone celebrations or extended family escapes.

Dining is equally immersive, with a collection of restaurants and bars celebrating global flavours in spectacular island settings. Guests can savour Mediterranean-inspired cuisine at Seasalt, Japanese fusion cuisine and live teppanyaki at Umami, handcrafted cocktails at Mirus Bar, grilled specialties at Yakitori Bar and Italian favourites at Pibati Sul Mare. For a truly memorable occasion, The Shack — the resort's exclusive private sandbank — offers bespoke castaway dining surrounded by uninterrupted ocean views.

The resort embraces wellness and adventure in equal measure. Spa Alila is a treetop sanctuary with restorative treatments, while Play Alila offers younger guests engaging, nature-inspired activities. Underwater adventures are led by the on-site Euro-Divers team, offering diving, snorkelling and non-motorised watersports. Guests can encounter Raa Atoll's Big Five — manta rays, dolphins, sharks, rays and sea turtles — while exploring 28 uncrowded dive sites within 15 minutes of the resort. The Unesco Biosphere Reserve of Hanifaru Bay, famous for its seasonal manta ray gatherings, is also nearby.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Large villas & a residence
- 5 restaurants & bars
- Euro-Divers dive & watersports centre
- Spa Alila (treetop wellness spa)
- Play Alila kids' club

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Scuba diving & snorkelling
- Castaway picnic & sundowners at The Shack private sandbank
- Dolphin & manta ray excursions
- Yoga & wellness experiences

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Watch the sunset at The Shack private sandbank with sundowners, live flair bartending and unforgettable Indian Ocean views



COLOURS OF OBLU Resorts

MALDIVES

Set across four distinct private islands in the Maldives, COLOURS OF OBLU is a collection of lifestyle resorts celebrating the natural beauty and warm hospitality of the Indian Ocean. Each resort pairs contemporary villas with thoughtfully curated holiday plans that seamlessly combine dining, beverages, daily activities, entertainment, and island experiences.

OBLU NATURE Helengeli by SENTIDO is renowned for its exceptional house reef, shaped by two deep ocean channels that attract a remarkable diversity of marine species, making it a favourite among diving enthusiasts. The island combines lush vegetation with contemporary villas and elevated dining concepts, including a progressive Indian restaurant inspired by regional flavours.

At OBLU SELECT Sangeli, refined island living meets curated experiences. The resort's adults-only One Banyan Island offers a secluded retreat complete with exclusive villas, a spa and private leisure spaces. Beyond, the calm lagoon provides ideal conditions for snorkelling, paddleboarding and swimming in crystal-clear waters.

Designed as a romantic sanctuary, OBLU SELECT Lobigili — meaning 'Island of Love' in the local Dhivehi language — offers an intimate adults-only setting just a short speedboat journey from Malé. A highlight is the Maldives' largest under-ocean restaurant, Only BLU, where guests dine surrounded by panoramic views of marine life. A connecting jetty to neighbouring OBLU XPERIENCE Ailafushi offers easy access to a contrasting social atmosphere.

OBLU XPERIENCE Ailafushi brings a playful spirit to the collection, combining contemporary accommodation with lively communal spaces, including La Promenade — a hub of boutique shopping, dining and entertainment. The resort caters to families and groups with activity programmes and spaces for children and teens.

Across all four resorts, ELE NA Ayur Spa offers holistic treatments inspired by the five natural elements. Sustainability remains central to operations: initiatives include coral conservation, energy efficiency and marine protection, with all resorts holding Green Globe certification.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- All-inclusive dining concepts
- Overwater & beach villas
- Kids' clubs & family spaces
- ELE NA Ayur Spa wellness centres

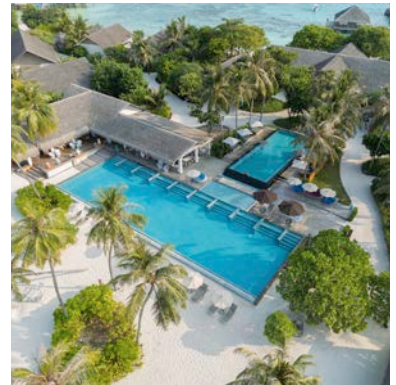
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Snorkelling & diving
- Sunset fishing excursions
- Yoga & wellness sessions
- Moonlight cruise
- Dolphin-watching
- Discover marine conservation
- Renewal of vows

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Dine beneath the ocean at Only BLU as reef fish, rays and sharks glide past your table



Cora Cora Maldives

RAA ATOLL, MALDIVES

Cora Cora Maldives, a five-star resort in the Raa Atoll, is an idyllic destination where luxury meets affordability. It's taken the concept of all-inclusive to a new level through its extraordinary Premium All-Inclusive Gourmet Meal Plan, meaning guests need not worry about hidden costs.

For an unforgettable gastronomic adventure, the all-inclusive offering is in place at each of the four restaurants and two bars. Guests can enjoy the flavours of the Spice Route from Lebanon to the Maldives at Tazāa, with themed buffet nights, sizzling bowls of Asian street market food at the open cooking station at Ginger Moon and delectable Japanese cuisine at Teien. There's also fresh pasta, stone-baked pizza and relaxed Italian dining at Acquapazza, as well as coffee, quick bites and artisanal homemade gelato at MYCOFFEE.

The all-inclusive offering in place across the island also includes the use of MOKSHA Spa & Wellbeing Centre — a sanctuary of rejuvenation and relaxation, including complimentary yoga lessons, daily wellness sessions and sound healing. For a small additional cost, guests can partake in

workshops to achieve a new sense of wellbeing, such as Couples Massages and Partner Yoga.

For a journey through the centuries, guests can discover the rich history of the destination at The Dutch Onion Museum. The museum — which has more than 400 local artefacts, two 12th-century temple tanks and a 1900s traditional Maldivian house — was the second museum to open in the whole of the Maldives.

From the moment guests step foot on the island, they receive a warm Maldivian welcome and are whisked away to their private villa, 55 of which are over the lagoon, and 45 of which are situated on the white-sand beaches that the Maldives are so famous for. Spacious, airy and emulating the relaxed Maldivian way of life, each villa boasts panoramic ocean views.

As part of their welcome, guests are given complimentary snorkelling equipment. There's also free access to the CoRa kids Club, a yoga pavilion, over-the-water treatment rooms and a PADI five-star dive centre offering complimentary non-motorised watersports activities.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- The Dutch Onion Museum
- Premium all-inclusive gourmet meal plan
- Lush tropical landscaping with a 100-acre lagoon
- Natural island with a house reef accessible directly from the beach

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Dine under a blanket of stars at the top of the Cora Tower, while enjoying incredible views of the Milky Way



The Halcyon Private Isles Maldives

GAAFU ALIFU ATOLL, MALDIVES

In the southern reaches of the Maldives, The Halcyon Private Isles is one of the country's most remote sanctuaries. It spans two private isles — one naturally formed of ancient coral sand, the other crafted over a tranquil lagoon, joined by a dedicated boat that runs day and night. There are 38 villas and they're some of the most spacious in the Maldives, ranging from beachfront and overwater retreats to The Halcyon Grand Estate — the crown jewel reserved for weddings and milestone celebrations. Each villa offers direct access to a living reef, where around 40 resident sea turtles glide through the shallows.

The property draws its quiet intellect from H C P Bell, the British archaeologist who charted these waters aboard the royal schooner *Fath-ul-Majid* in the early 20th century, documenting hidden Maldivian artefacts and calling these seas 'restorative'. His curiosity is the resort's spiritual ancestor, woven through the architecture and the Bell Bar, where sunset cocktails carry his name.

Dining is a key part of the experience. Yuzu offers refined pan-Asian plates, Thari spans

Mediterranean and multi-cuisine fare, and Yapa, an overwater sunset bar, offers guests a considered sake programme. There's also The Firepit, where the local catch of the day is hauled in at dawn by local fishermen in creaking wooden boats and then grilled slowly over smoky coconut husks.

Service at The Halcyon Private Isles moves on intuition. The Halcyon Butler anticipates guests' unspoken needs, while the diving-trained Marine Butler guides guests through coral gardens Bell once described in vivid detail. For families, there's the Faru kids' club and the young oceanographers programme, where children learn to anchor coral fragments and read the reef.

Beyond the villas, guests can embark on signature experiences including the equator crossing, big-game fishing in the deep southern waters, and the Huvadhoo expedition through one of the world's largest natural atolls. Back at the resort, the overwater spa draws on the elements of earth, water, air and fire, with restorative treatments that provide a fitting finale to a journey through the Maldives.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Two thriving house reefs
- Overwater spa suspended above a lagoon
- Faru kids' club
- The Halcyon Grand Estate

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Equator crossing
- Big-game fishing
- Huvadhoo expedition
- The Halcyon crossing

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Enjoy a sandbank dinner with no other footprints, served beneath the southern stars

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Drift Thelu Veliga Retreat

SOUTH ARI ATOLL, MALDIVES

Set within the crystalline waters of South Ari Atoll, Drift Thelu Veliga Retreat occupies a private island spanning two-and-a-half acres, offering a rare sense of seclusion in one of the Maldives' most celebrated marine regions.

Accessible via a scenic 30-minute seaplane journey from Malé International Airport, the retreat immediately immerses guests in a slower pace of life. With just 30 villas in total, the property maintains an intimate atmosphere. Just 10 Beach Villas are tucked along the shoreline amid lush vegetation, while 20 Water Villas extend gracefully over the lagoon on traditional stilts, offering uninterrupted ocean views.

The surrounding house reef is a standout feature, teeming with vibrant coral formations and diverse marine life. South Ari Atoll is globally recognised as one of the best locations to encounter whale sharks year-round, offering a unique opportunity for close yet respectful observation of these gentle giants. The atoll is also known for its manta ray cleaning stations, particularly active during seasonal plankton blooms.

Culinary experiences celebrate regional flavours infused with Asian influences. Fresh seafood plays a central role, often sourced from nearby fishing communities, alongside tropical ingredients such as coconut, breadfruit and pandan. The open-air restaurant provides both buffet and a la carte dining in a relaxed setting that frames uninterrupted ocean views. Meanwhile, the beachfront bar serves light meals and refreshments throughout the day, becoming a focal point at sunset when the sky transforms into vivid hues of orange and pink.

Wellbeing is thoughtfully integrated into the island experience. At one end of the island, an overwater spa offers a curated selection of treatments inspired by Indonesian, Thai and Indian traditions. The tranquil setting enhances therapies designed to restore balance and relaxation.

Beyond relaxation, curated experiences allow guests to explore the area. Options include guided snorkelling excursions, big-game fishing and private sandbank picnics. The surrounding waters also hold historical intrigue, with shipwreck sites accessible to experienced divers.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Open-air restaurant
- Beachfront bar
- Overwater spa
- House reef access

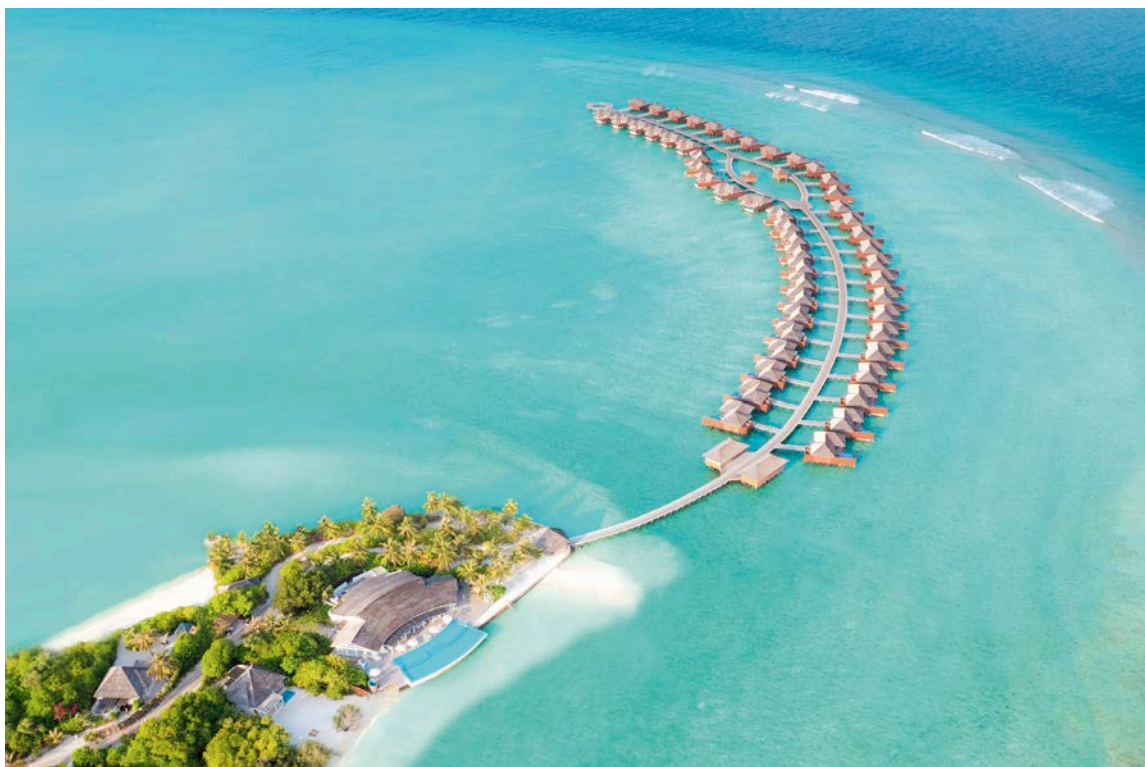
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Snorkelling & diving
- Whale shark excursions
- Big game fishing
- Sandbank picnics

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Enjoy sunset drinks at the beachfront bar overlooking the Indian Ocean's glowing horizon



Hideaway Beach Resort & Spa

HAA ALIFU ATOLL, MALDIVES

Set in the northern reaches of the Maldives, Hideaway Beach Resort & Spa is a sanctuary where space, privacy and immersive island experiences come together. It's located on Dhonakulhi Island in Haa Alifu Atoll — one of the country's most pristine regions. The journey itself sets the tone. A scenic seaplane transfer experience reveals an island wrapped in lush vegetation, powder-soft beaches and a lagoon that shifts from turquoise to deep sapphire. Hideaway's defining natural feature is its double house reef, a rarity in the Maldives. This formation allows snorkellers and divers to explore two distinct reef systems directly from the shore. Vibrant coral gardens, reef sharks, turtles, rays and schools of tropical fish are all part of life beneath the surface.

Water-based recreation is central to the Hideaway experience. The resort's fully equipped watersports centre offers everything from kayaking, paddleboarding and jet-skiing to parasailing and catamaran sailing. For certified divers and beginners alike, guided excursions provide access to dive sites in the northern atolls

that remain less frequented, and rich in marine biodiversity. Sunset cruises, dolphin-spotting excursions and private sandbank experiences further enhance the sense of exploration.

On land, the resort offers one of the Maldives' most extensive selections of sporting facilities, including tennis courts, a putting green, golf simulators, padel, pickleball, badminton, a fully equipped fitness centre and cycling paths that circle the island. Families are equally well catered for, with spacious villas, a dedicated kids' club and activities designed for all ages.

At the heart of the resort lies Hideaway Spa. Here, wellness rituals draw on both Asian and Western traditions, offering everything from signature massages and body treatments to beauty therapies and personalised wellness programmes.

Dining is equally varied. The restaurants and bars take guests on a culinary journey, from fresh seafood at Meeru Bar & Grill to Thai, Indian, Chinese and Japanese cuisine including teppanyaki at Samsara. Private dining experiences offer a memorable setting for special occasions.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Sports complex
- Hideaway Spa
- Watersports & Dive centre
- Tender Hearts Kids' Club

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Diving & snorkelling
- Tennis
- Pickleball
- Padel

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Explore the tropical resort's rare double house reef directly from the shore



Hotels of the Maldives

MALDIVES

Scattered across the turquoise waters of the Indian Ocean, the Maldives is home to more than 150 private island resorts, each offering its own interpretation of paradise. From vibrant coral reefs teeming with marine life to overwater villas perched above crystal-clear lagoons, every island has its own distinct character. Some are renowned for world-class diving and snorkelling, while others specialise in exceptional gastronomy, transformative wellness retreats or unforgettable family escapes. With such remarkable diversity, choosing the right island is often the most important decision travellers make.

This is where Hotels of the Maldives comes in, an independent luxury travel advisory dedicated exclusively to the Maldives. Founded by Maldives specialist Ceyda Aksehirlioglu, the consultancy is built on extensive first-hand knowledge rather than brochures or marketing material. Having personally visited more than 30 resorts, Ceyda offers honest insight into each property's atmosphere, accommodation, service, dining, house reef and overall experience.

Rather than offering a one-size-fits-all itinerary, Hotels of the Maldives carefully matches each guest to the island that best suits their interests and travel style. Whether planning a honeymoon, multi-generational family holiday, milestone celebration or luxury escape, every detail is considered, from selecting the ideal villa category to arranging seaplane or speedboat transfers and securing honeymoon benefits or experiences.

Long-standing relationships with many of the Maldives' leading resorts also allow guests to enjoy exclusive privileges whenever available, including room upgrades and personalised amenities. Every itinerary is designed to remove the guesswork from planning while ensuring travellers experience the best the destination has to offer.

Beyond the resorts themselves, the Maldives delivers extraordinary moments that remain long after the journey ends. Snorkel vibrant house reefs just steps from your villa, swim alongside manta rays and sea turtles, dine beneath the stars on a deserted sandbank or simply watch the sun melt into the Indian Ocean from your private deck.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Independent luxury travel guide specialising in the Maldives
- Led by Maldives specialist Ceyda Aksehirlioglu
- First-hand knowledge of more than 30 luxury resorts
- Bespoke resort & villa recommendations tailored to every traveller
- Honest, independent advice based on personal experience
- Access to exclusive resort benefits & added-value extras where available
- End-to-end itinerary planning & ongoing travel support

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Discover the best of the Maldives by snorkelling house reefs, swimming alongside manta rays or escaping to a private sandbank

Kandima

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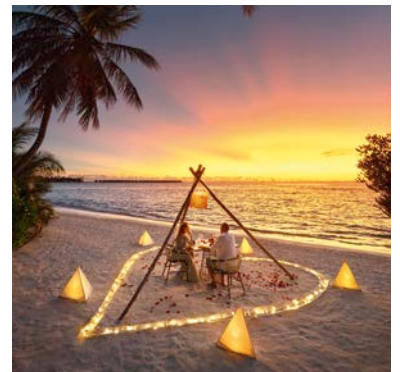
A vibrant 3km island playground where turquoise lagoons meet poolside dining, ocean adventures, sports, wellness and art. By night, the energy shifts with racing, bowling, VR and beachside beats.

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www.kandima.com

mykindofplace@kandima.com

[@kandima_maldives](https://www.instagram.com/kandima_maldives)



Kandima Maldives

DHAALU ATOLL, MALDIVES

Set in the pristine Dhaalu Atoll, Kandima Maldives offers a contemporary island escape that balances relaxation with activity. With 270 studios, villas and suites, the resort caters to a wide range of travellers, from couples seeking a romantic break to families and groups looking for a more energetic getaway. Its overall style is modern and relaxed, with a focus on comfort and flexibility.

Accommodation is bright and spacious, with all rooms positioned to take in views of the lagoon or beach. Guests can choose from 10 different room categories, each designed with a calm, understated aesthetic. Standard features include complimentary wi-fi, smart in-room entertainment, a mini-bar, coffee facilities and, in villas, walk-in rain showers. The emphasis is on convenience and ease, with thoughtful touches.

Reaching the island is straightforward despite its remote feel. Guests typically take a short domestic flight from Malé followed by a boat transfer, though seaplane arrivals are also possible. Once there, the setting feels secluded, surrounded by a large natural lagoon and lush greenery.

Kandima offers a wide range of facilities, making it easy to shape guests' stay around their interests. Families are well looked after, with the Kandiland kids' club providing supervised activities in a safe and engaging environment. For those focused on health and fitness, the resort includes a well-equipped gym, sports courts and wellness facilities, alongside a fully staffed medical centre.

The Aquaholics watersports centre is a highlight, offering everything from snorkelling and diving to parasailing and windsurfing. Guests can explore the surrounding marine life or simply enjoy time on the water at their own pace. For a slower rhythm, the esKape Spa provides a range of treatments, including massages and holistic therapies.

Dining is another strong point, with options ranging from casual cafes and bars to more refined restaurants. Meal plans are flexible, from bed and breakfast through to all-inclusive packages that cover dining, drinks and selected activities. Overall, Kandima Maldives delivers a well-rounded island experience, combining natural beauty with modern comforts and a broad choice of activities.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 10 room categories
- Wellness centre
- 10 dining options
- Kandiland kids' club

KEY ACTIVITIES

- esKape Spa
- E-go Kart Track
- Sports Arena
- Jet-skiing

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Unwind with a cocktail by the pool, soaking up the music and watching the sun sink below the horizon



Noku Maldives, Vignette Collection

NOONU ATOLL, MALDIVES

Noku Maldives, Vignette Collection lies in the quiet heart of the Indian Ocean, where the horizon softens and time drifts with the tides. This is a secluded sanctuary where understated elegance meets the soul of island life. As the first Vignette Collection resort in the Maldives by IHG Hotels & Resorts, Noku offers a refined expression of barefoot luxury.

Set within the untouched beauty of Noonu Atoll, the island is reached by a scenic 45-minute seaplane journey from Malé. Palm-fringed shores embrace just 50 contemporary villas, floating above the lagoon or resting on powder-soft sands. Designed with warm teak, woven textures and natural stone, each villa mirrors the calm rhythm of its surroundings — private and serene.

Dining at Noku is guided by land, sea and shared memory. At Palms, flame-grilled specialities celebrate the catch of the day and selected cuts, while Thari offers Asian fusion cuisine. Moonlit dinners unfold on the sand beneath a canopy of stars, floating breakfasts drift on private pools at sunrise, and golden-hour aperitifs turn each moment into a quiet celebration of place.

Days unfold in harmony with the island. Sunrise yoga, coral-garden snorkelling, paddleboarding and sunset cruises are balanced by deep restoration at Noku Spa, where ancient healing traditions meet botanical blends inspired by the tropics. Beneath the surface, Noonu Atoll's renowned dive sites reveal manta rays, reef sharks and vibrant coral gardens, while the house reef is home to graceful turtles gliding through crystalline waters.

In true Vignette spirit, Noku embraces meaningful experiences through its Island Echoes ritual. As dusk settles, guests gather around a bonfire to hear Maldivian legends retold; tales of seafarers, spirits and the ocean's enduring magic. With stars overhead, strangers become companions and time seems to pause.

As the resort grows, so does its sense of responsibility. Through its Means for Good initiative, Noku weaves community and conservation into every stay — from supporting local schools and women's committees to partnering with the Atoll Marine Conservation Centre on turtle rescue and coral conservation initiatives.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 50 beachfront & overwater villas
- 2 signature restaurants
- Poolside bar
- Garden spa
- Dive centre
- Gym
- Boutique
- Yoga pavilion

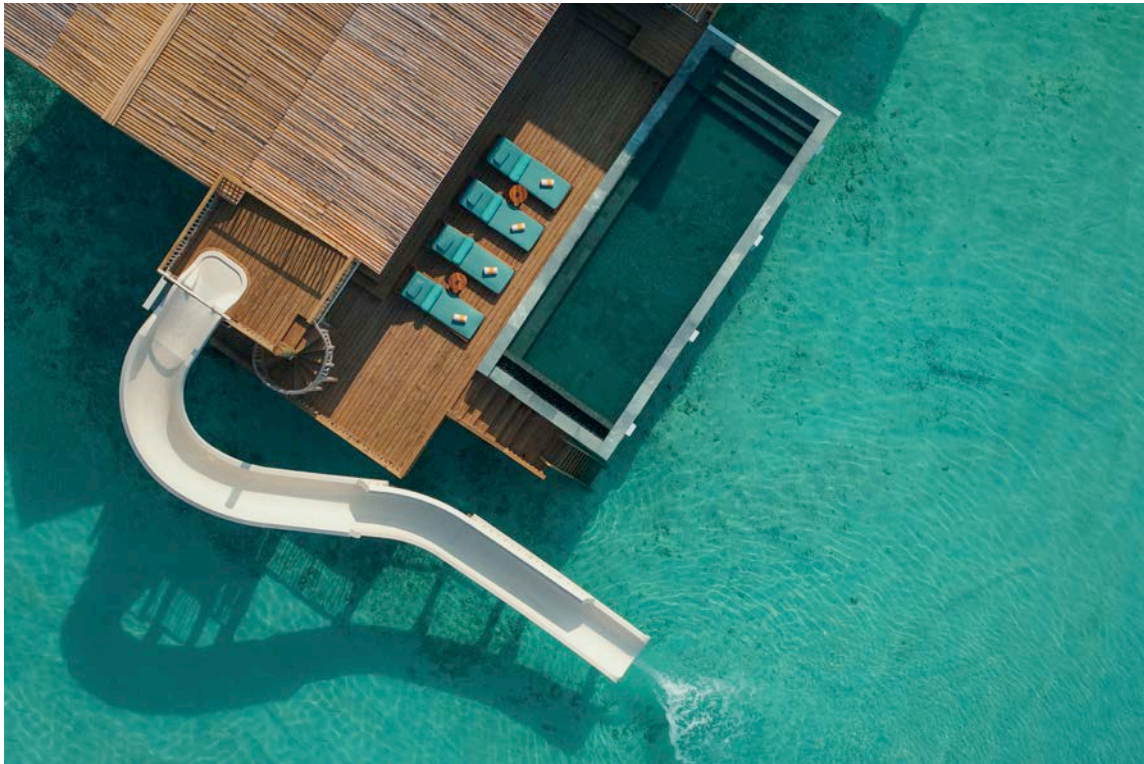
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Snorkelling
- Sunset cruises
- Dolphin cruises
- Motorised & non-motorised watersports
- Diving

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Cruise across Noonu Atoll's sapphire waters, where dolphins often follow in your wake



Rah Gili Maldives

SOUTH MALÉ ATOLL, MALDIVES

Situated on the edge of South Malé Atoll, where turquoise lagoons meet open ocean, Rah Gili Maldives offers a fresh perspective on island life. Set beside a protected dolphin sanctuary, the resort occupies one of the most distinctive locations in the Maldives.

Designed for travellers seeking both freedom and authenticity, the island blends contemporary design with a relaxed, bohemian spirit. Its 74 private pool villas, including beachfront and overwater options, are positioned to maximise privacy while embracing uninterrupted views of the Indian Ocean.

The waters surrounding the island are home to vibrant coral reefs and sea turtles and a resident dolphin population. Snorkelling and diving excursions reveal the rich biodiversity of the atoll, while sunset cruises provide opportunities to witness dolphins in their natural habitat. Beyond the lagoon, guests can explore traditional fishing communities, uninhabited sandbanks and the cultural heritage that's shaped Maldivian island life for centuries.

Stewardship of the natural environment is woven into the island experience. The resort's location offers a daily reminder of the importance of preserving the ecosystems that make the Maldives unique. Through marine-focused experiences and educational encounters, travellers can gain a deeper understanding of the delicate relationship between island communities and the ocean.

Equally important is the celebration of local culture. From regional flavours and locally influenced dining experiences to activities rooted in the heritage of the archipelago, the destination encourages a meaningful connection with place.

Dining reflects the abundance of the surrounding waters, with fresh seafood, tropical produce and international influences brought together across a collection of restaurants and bars. Signature dishes highlight Maldivian tuna.

Few destinations offer the chance to stay beside a protected dolphin sanctuary while experiencing the culture, traditions and marine ecosystems of the Maldives in such an immersive way.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Overwater Pool Villas with Slide
- Beach club
- Restaurants & bars
- The Nest kids' club

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Dolphin-watching
- Snorkelling & diving
- Watersports
- Cultural experiences

GET IN TOUCH

- rahgili.com
- +960 401 4001
- reservations@rahgili.com
- [instagram.com/rahgilimaldives](https://www.instagram.com/rahgilimaldives)

DON'T MISS Experience one of South Malé Atoll's most distinctive settings, where sheltered lagoons meet the open Indian Ocean



V Villas Maldives at Mirihi – MGallery Collection

SOUTH ARI ATOLL, MALDIVES

V Villas Maldives at Mirihi – MGallery Collection offers a return to simplicity and connection. Named after the native mirihi flower, the resort is a contemporary sanctuary that blends quiet luxury with Maldivian heritage. The experience centres on presence rather than excess, where every detail is intentional and every moment unfolds at its own natural rhythm.

Surrounded by a lagoon of crystalline blue, the island feels like a secret shaped by the sea. Coral gardens shimmer beneath the surface, attracting manta rays and turtles that drift through the atoll's warm currents. The resort's 42 villas, positioned either over water or along a white-sand shoreline, are designed to flow with the landscape rather than sit upon it. Designed by Studio Gronda, the architecture draws inspiration from sails, coral formations and traditional craftsmanship. Natural timbers, local motifs and grounding tones create interiors that feel thoughtful and rooted in place.

Hospitality here is quietly attentive. Each villa is supported by a personal butler whose presence feels discreet yet considerate. Days are shaped

by experiences that encourage a slower rhythm: sunrise yoga overlooking the lagoon, stargazing beneath vast night skies or drifting through calm water as marine life glides past.

Culinary experiences celebrate the island's relationship with the ocean. Muraka, the signature restaurant, highlights local seafood through global technique, while Dhonveli offers relaxed dining on sand floors with ocean views. Akoya I Sea Lounge brings crafted cocktails and an exceptional rum collection to the water's edge, and The Tasting Room hosts intimate pairing journeys that explore provenance and flavour. There's also private destination dining, from candlelit sandbank dinners to secluded feasts within the lagoon.

Wellness is both grounding and transformative. Located among the trees, the spa combines Maldivian botanicals with contemporary healing rituals, while an infrared sauna, ice bath and outdoor gym invite guests into sensory awakening. Yoga and meditation practices reconnect body and mind, and visiting practitioners lead personalised wellness pathways that honour individual needs.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 42 private villas with personal butlers
- Overwater & beachfront dining venues & bar
- Spa with infrared sauna & ice bath
- Outdoor gym & yoga pavilion
- Dive centre

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Coral reef snorkelling & diving
- Mirihi Thari Whale Shark Expedition
- Private destination dining
- Wellness & meditation

GET IN TOUCH

- villasmaldivesatmirihi.com
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- instagram.com/villasmaldivesatmirihi

DON'T MISS Embark on the Mirihi Thari Whale Shark Expedition, an exclusive full-day journey aboard a traditional-style luxury yacht



Secret Paradise Maldives Tours

HULHUMALE, MALDIVES

The Maldives is often celebrated for its crystal-clear lagoons and luxurious resorts, but travellers who choose to explore with Secret Paradise Maldives discover that their holiday can also create lasting benefits. This award-winning positive impact tour company has built its reputation on ensuring every guest contribution counts. Every booking supports initiatives that wouldn't be possible without guest participation. Revenue generated from tours helps fund a wide range of projects that protect fragile ecosystems and invest in Maldivian communities. When students take part in marine education activities or young islanders are trained to become qualified guides, it's supported directly by those who have joined a snorkel safari, city walking tour or island-hopping cruise.

Travellers aren't just observers, they're contributors. Snorkelling over coral reefs or cruising between islands provides unforgettable experiences while supporting ongoing investment in local conservation and local people. Guests who join Secret Paradise Maldives conservation cruises swim in waters frequented by whale sharks, turtles and

manta rays, while also supporting data collection, megafauna monitoring and environmental awareness initiatives led by local NGOs.

Ocean encounters extend beyond the reefs, too. Kayaking or snorkelling through mangroves and seagrass meadows reveals ecosystems vital for carbon storage and marine biodiversity, and guest visits build awareness and help support their protection. Island-hopping tours also bring the story of the Maldives to life. Guided by experienced Maldivian tour leaders, guests travel across a range of atolls, gaining insight into island life. Secret Paradise Maldives guides share not only their knowledge but also personal stories and experiences, bringing the history, culture and environmental challenges of the Maldives into sharper focus. Guests gain a deeper understanding of how island communities adapt to climate change, preserve traditions and depend on healthy oceans for their livelihoods. This results in guests leaving knowing that their visit has supported local communities, conservation initiatives and the future of these incredible islands.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Responsible Travel Pledge
- Local Maldivian tour leaders
- Locally owned guest house stays
- Community-supported tourism initiatives

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Island-hopping tours
- Conservation cruises
- Positive impact experiences
- Educational travel

GET IN TOUCH

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- instagram.com/secretparadisemaldives

DON'T MISS Join a cruise to encounter whale sharks, turtles and manta rays while supporting marine research and conservation initiatives



Summer Island Maldives

NORTH MALÉ ATOLL, MALDIVES

Located in the heart of North Malé Atoll, Summer Island Maldives is just a 45-minute speedboat ride from Velana International Airport. The island's location offers guests uninterrupted views of turquoise lagoons and spectacular sunsets, with warm days year-round.

Home to 156 thoughtfully designed villas, Summer Island balances contemporary comfort with a distinctly Maldivian sense of place. Beachfront villas open directly onto powder-soft shores fringed with palm trees, while overwater villas stretch gracefully across the lagoon, offering direct access to the crystal-clear waters below. Interiors are light and airy, featuring natural textures and understated tones that mirror the island's surroundings.

Dining at Summer Island Maldives highlights both local flavours and international favourites, with each venue offering a distinct setting and atmosphere. Samuga, the main restaurant, serves a generous selection of international and regional cuisine in a relaxed, open-air setting. Hiya, the resort's overwater restaurant, offers

semi-buffet dining with picturesque views of the horizon. Beachfront barbecues and special dining experiences beneath the stars further enhance the resort's culinary offering.

Beyond the shoreline, a variety of facilities and experiences invite guests to explore the island and its surrounding waters. The overwater spa offers restorative treatments inspired by nature, while a fully equipped fitness centre provides space to stay active. Nearby reefs reveal vibrant marine life ideal for snorkelling and diving, and guided excursions introduce guests to the underwater world of North Malé Atoll, home to reef sharks, eagle rays, turtles and colourful schools of fish. Sunset cruises aboard a traditional Maldivian *dhoni* offer a peaceful way to experience the open ocean.

Insider experiences include visits to renowned nearby dive sites such as Banana Reef and Lankan Manta Point, known for their rich biodiversity and seasonal manta ray sightings. On land, native birdlife, including herons, can often be spotted along the shoreline, while sea turtles glide through the lagoon's shallows.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Infinity pool
- Dive centre
- Watersports centre
- Overwater spa

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Sunset *dhoni* cruises
- Scuba diving
- Watersports
- Spa treatments
- Adam & Eve Serenity Massage
- Marma Body, Mind & Spirit Ayurveda Massage
- Serenity Full Body Massage
- Sun Lovers' Package

GET IN TOUCH

- summerislandmaldives.com
- +960 664 1949
- reservations@summerislandmaldives.com
- [instagram.com/summerisland.maldives](https://www.instagram.com/summerisland.maldives)

DON'T MISS Sail aboard a traditional Maldivian *dhoni* as the sun sets over the Indian Ocean



Vakkaru Maldives

BAA ATOLL, MALDIVES

Set within the Unesco Biosphere Reserve of Baa Atoll, Vakkaru Maldives offers an immersive escape for travellers seeking tranquillity, privacy and a meaningful connection with the Maldives' marine environment. Reached by a scenic 30-minute seaplane journey from Malé, the secluded island resort feels remarkably private, surrounded as it is by uninterrupted ocean views. Beneath a canopy of more than 2,300 mature coconut trees, shaded pathways reflect the island's heritage as a former coconut plantation.

The surrounding waters of Baa Atoll are among the Maldives' most biologically rich. Between June and November, nearby Hanifaru Bay becomes one of the world's most remarkable natural spectacles, attracting large congregations of manta rays and whale sharks. Guided snorkelling excursions allow guests to witness these gentle giants gliding through nutrient-rich waters, while the island's house reef offers year-round opportunities to explore coral gardens teeming with marine life.

Vakkaru Maldives is also home to two naturally formed blue holes, including one directly accessible

from the overwater jetty. Guests can drift above the entrances of these enigmatic formations, exploring dramatic coral blocks surrounded by schooling fish and diverse marine life.

Accommodation ranges from elegant beach villas concealed within tropical foliage to an expansive residence suspended above the Indian Ocean. Designed with earthy textures, contemporary lines and subtle Maldivian influences, the resort's 111 villas and residences balance privacy with uninterrupted ocean views. The award-winning four-bedroom Vakkaru Over Water Residence — among the largest overwater residences in the Maldives — offers a dedicated butler service, private spa facilities and sunset views.

Dining is central to the experience. Onu presents refined Southeast Asian cuisine within a bamboo-crafted setting, while Vakku specialises in premium meats and seafood grilled over open flames. Vakkaru Reserve houses a collection of more than 680 wine labels and has earned Wine Spectator's Award of Excellence, making it one of the Maldives' leading wine destinations.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Merana Spa
- Vakkaru Reserve wine cellar
- Splash watersports & dive centre
- Parrotfish Kids' Club

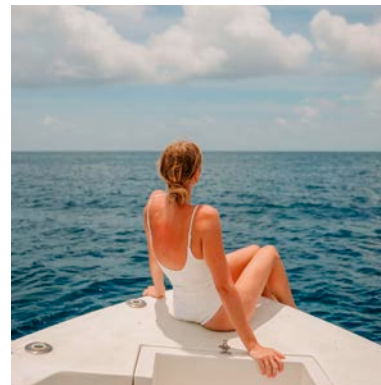
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Manta ray snorkelling in Hanifaru Bay
- Private sandbank dining experiences
- Luxury yacht excursions
- Overwater yoga & wellness sessions

GET IN TOUCH

- vakkarumaldives.com
- +960 660 7000
- reservations@vakkarumaldives.com
- [instagram.com/vakkarumaldives](https://www.instagram.com/vakkarumaldives)

DON'T MISS Snorkel with manta rays in the spectacular Hanifaru Bay between June and November



Villa Nautica

NORTH MALÉ ATOLL, MALDIVES

Villa Nautica carries the ease of the Maldives with the polish of a sunlit island escape. Set in North Malé Atoll, the private island is reached by a swift speedboat crossing from Velana International Airport. Within minutes of landing, travellers move from runway to reef, arriving to white sand, bright lagoon blues and a resort shaped by ocean-facing style.

The island is romantic without feeling remote, relaxed without ever becoming sleepy. Villas are arranged along the beach and over the water, with terraces made for slow mornings, sea-facing afternoons and private moments at sunset.

At the centre of the island is its 1,350 sq metre infinity pool. Framed by palms and open sky, it appears to spill towards the lagoon beyond, creating one of the resort's most cinematic places to spend the day. A swim before lunch, a long pause on a lounge, the sea turning silver in the late afternoon — this is where Villa Nautica's easy glamour comes into focus.

Dining adds another layer to the island's character. Bageecha and The Lagoon bring

generous international spreads to the day, while Ristorante al Tramonto sets Italian dining over the water. Hook serves seafood by the shore, Fukuya Teppanyaki adds theatre to the evening and Press & Pot offers the small luxury of handcrafted brews, teas and sweet treats between swims. For something more secluded, Seawall Specialities brings picnic-style dining to the island's edge, with wicker baskets of seasonal bites enjoyed against uninterrupted ocean views.

Beyond the table, the resort's North Malé Atoll setting opens easily onto the water. Guests can snorkel, dive, try watersports or simply follow the lagoon's changing colours through the day. Wellness finds its place at Araamu Spa, which is set within tropical greenery and made for post-ocean restoration.

Villa Nautica isn't a silent castaway fantasy. Its charm is brighter than that: a lagoon-side island with style, ease and just enough glamour, where the best moments might be a coffee at Press & Pot, a seafood dinner by the water or an afternoon by the pool as the whole island seems to turn gold.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Infinity pool
- Araamu Spa
- Wavy Navy Kids' Club
- Watersports centre

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Snorkelling
- Scuba diving
- Seawall Specialities
- Private dining

GET IN TOUCH

- villaresorts.com/villa-nautica
- +960 664 0011
- hello@villaresorts.com
- instagram.com/villanautica.maldives

DON'T MISS Order something cold, find the pool's edge and let the lagoon do the rest



Villa Park

SOUTH ARI ATOLL, MALDIVES

Villa Park is the Maldives on a grander, greener scale. Set in the South Ari Atoll, this large natural island's tropical abundance makes it feel almost cinematic. There are long beaches, pristine waters, garden paths, towering palms and great stretches of jungle-like greenery that give the resort a sense of depth beyond the usual postcard view.

This isn't a tiny island hideaway where the experience begins and ends with a villa. Villa Park has a living, breathing quality. Guests cycle beneath palms, wander through shaded pathways, move from beach to lagoon to spa and discover different pockets of the island as the day unfolds.

The surrounding South Ari Atoll waters are central to the Villa Park experience. This is one of the Maldives' most remarkable marine regions, known for whale shark encounters and rich underwater life. Excursions take guests into protected waters where the world's largest fish may appear beneath the boat, while diving and snorkelling reveal coral gardens, reef fish, rays and the electric-blue clarity that makes this part of the Indian Ocean so unforgettable.

On land, the resort balances movement with restoration. Araamu Spa sits within the greenery, offering a calm retreat after saltwater days. The Pot Tub ritual is especially atmospheric, with warm, flower-filled baths tucked beneath the palms. For younger travellers, Park Players Kids' Club brings a bright world of games, creativity, pool play and island exploration, making Villa Park especially well-suited to families and multi-generational stays. Accommodation is just as generous. The flagship Two-Bedroom Beach Pool Residence is made for travellers who want the ease of a private home by the sea: spacious living, direct beach access, a private pool and the freedom to move between indoors, outdoors and the shoreline with no ceremony at all.

Dining brings its own sense of place. Zero offers garden-led dining in a treetop setting. La Tropicana at Sunset Beach is all colour, coconuts and laid-back lounging, while Al Pontile serves Italian dishes over the water. On some evenings, the lagoon provides its own theatre: a pizza on the table, the water darkening below and a manta ray moving silently through the light.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Park Players Kids' Club
- Araamu Spa
- PADI dive centre
- Watersports centre

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Whale shark excursions
- Scuba diving
- Treetop-dining at Zero
- Snorkelling

GET IN TOUCH

- villaresorts.com/villa-park
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- hello@villaresorts.com
- instagram.com/villapark.maldives

DON'T MISS Enjoy pizza at Al Pontile, with manta rays moving through the lagoon below



La Petite Ferme

BAMBOUS VIRIEUX, MAURITIUS

Located in the peaceful countryside of Bambous Virieux on the east coast of Mauritius, La Petite Ferme offers travellers an opportunity to discover a slower, more authentic side of the island. Once almost entirely dedicated to sugarcane, the land is gradually being transformed into a thriving ecosystem through the principles of permaculture and regenerative agriculture.

Together Terganic and La Petite Ferme forms part of La Meule Ecovillage, a long-term family vision dedicated to restoring biodiversity while creating meaningful experiences for travellers seeking a genuine connection with Mauritius. Every tree planted, every local variety cultivated and every habitat restored contributes to a landscape that grows richer with every season.

Designed to blend into its surroundings, the farm stays embrace bioclimatic principles, natural ventilation and locally inspired architecture. During the cooler winter evenings, fireplaces are fuelled with wood collected from the pruning of shade trees, completing a simple cycle where every resource has a purpose and nothing is wasted.

Guests are invited to enjoy a genuine farm-to-table experience through the property's Table d'hôte, where seasonal ingredients, many grown on the farm or sourced from local producers, celebrate the flavours of Mauritius. Breakfasts feature fresh produce from the gardens, while every meal reflects a philosophy of simplicity and respect for the land.

Days unfold at nature's pace. Wake to birdsong, stroll through regenerating landscapes, observe ducks, butterflies and native wildlife, or simply cool down in the river beneath the shade of mature trees. Families rediscover the pleasure of children exploring outdoors, while couples find space to reconnect around the warmth of a fireplace or beneath a sky filled with stars.

More than a place to stay, La Petite Ferme reflects the belief that tourism can actively contribute to the regeneration of landscapes and communities. Every visit supports an evolving project where hospitality, nature and sustainability work together, inviting travellers to experience Mauritius not only as a destination, but as a living landscape shaped by care, patience and hope.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Farm-stay accommodation
- Farm-to-table Table d'Hôte
- Wood-burning fireplaces
- River plunge pool

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Permaculture farm discovery
- Courses & practical workshops
- Nature walks
- Stargazing

GET IN TOUCH

- lapetiteferme.mu
- +230 5963 3495 (WhatsApp)
- [instagram.com/lapetiteferme_mauritius](https://www.instagram.com/lapetiteferme_mauritius)

DON'T MISS Enjoy the Table d'hôte experience, where seasonal Mauritian dishes are prepared using local and home-grown ingredients



OBOË Gardenstè

GRAND BAIE, MAURITIUS

OBOË Gardenstè is the first container-based hotel in the Indian Ocean — an intimate eco-boutique retreat crafted from 31 upcycled shipping containers, transformed into contemporary, design-led spaces set within a lush Zen garden of tropical and endemic Mauritian plants.

The result feels nothing like its industrial origins. Containers have been reimagined as calm, contemporary rooms with walk-in showers and artful minimalism — the details reflect the property's philosophy of mindful, human-scale hospitality. Active and passive technologies for sustainability, including a growing garden and recycled water systems, run quietly in the background, allowing guests to tread lightly without sacrificing comfort.

More than a place to sleep, OBOË Gardenstè operates as an emerging culture hub in Mauritius. The Gardenstè hosts many curated events, games nights, special dinners and activities enabled by local collaborators, while the on-site cafe and mini bookshop champions creations from local makers. The space doubles as a work-friendly base

for business travellers, as much as for beach-lovers, honeymooners, Zen-seekers and cultural explorers.

The location rewards the curious. Just a short walk away, Pereybere Public Beach is prized by locals as one of the island's finest swimming spots. The lively restaurants, boutiques and catamaran departures of Grand Baie are also only five minutes away, yet the hotel remains tucked within a peaceful garden framed by birdsong and tropical greenery. OBOË is an ideal base from which to explore northern Mauritius, with the team on hand to guide guests towards the island's iconic highlights and lesser-known corners alike. Snorkelling, diving and windsurfing are all within easy reach along the lagoon, too.

Whether guests come for a slow morning at the breakfast table, an evening of art and conversation, or simply a base from which to discover Mauritius, OBOË Gardenstè offers something increasingly rare: a stay with a story. Visitors consistently praise the hotel's understated luxury and the small, warm, professional team whose hospitality feels personal rather than performed.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Modern eco-designed container rooms with garden views
- On-site cafe & bookshop
- Activities & events open to the local & international community
- Open-space kitchen & trust bar

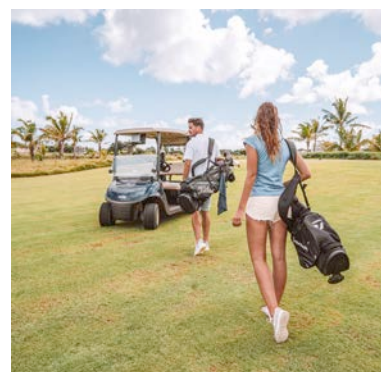
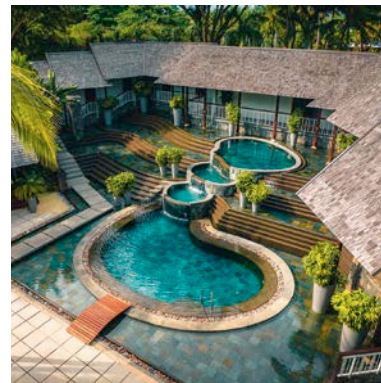
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Snorkelling & swimming at Pereybere Beach (7-minute walk)
- Full-day pool time & restaurant discounts from OBOË Dinner Club
- Full-body relaxing massage under the garden patio
- Day trips to Château de Labourdonnais, Cap Malheureux & Grand Baie

GET IN TOUCH

- [obo.mu](mailto:hello@oboegardenste.com)
- +230 5452 6141 / +230 268 3092
- hello@oboegardenste.com
- [instagram.com/oboegarden](https://www.instagram.com/oboegarden)

DON'T MISS Take an early-morning swim at Pereybere Public Beach, one of the island's best-loved local beaches, before the crowds arrive



Royal Palm Beachcomber Luxury

GRAND BAIE, MAURITIUS

Located on the northern coast of Mauritius in the lively bay area of Grand Baie, Royal Palm Beachcomber is one of the island's most established luxury resorts. With a limited number of suites and a strong focus on dedicated personal service, it's designed for guests who value privacy, comfort and exclusivity.

The resort offers 69 beautifully furnished suites, including the spectacular Royal Suite, with a private pool. The suites are spacious and designed in a simple yet refined style, featuring sea-facing terraces with direct views over the lagoon. Guests benefit from a dedicated team of artisans who provide personalised, attentive service.

Chef William Girard brings a blend of contemporary French cuisine with fresh, subtle local flavours, creating an exceptional gourmet experience. The chef has been awarded the prestigious title *Maître Cuisinier de France*, an honour recognising the finest talents in French gastronomy. The resort offers several restaurants serving French-inspired cuisine alongside local and Mediterranean dishes. Meals can be enjoyed

in elegant dining spaces or in more relaxed beachside settings.

The spa offers a range of treatments, including massages, skincare therapies and wellness programmes. Facilities are set within landscaped gardens, creating a calm and tranquil atmosphere. In partnership with luxury Swiss brand Valmont, the spa offers an extensive pampering menu.

Royal Palm Beachcomber offers a wide range of complimentary watersports in the turquoise lagoon, including water-skiing, kayaking, windsurfing, paddleboarding, snorkelling and sailing. Guests can also enjoy excellent sports facilities, including squash and tennis courts, a fully equipped fitness centre with cardio rooms and personal trainers, as well as access to the nearby Mont Choisy Le Golf 18-hole championship course.

Families are well catered for with a complimentary kids' club for ages three to 11, complete with its own supervised paddling pool. Guests can also take advantage of island excursions and the resort's location near Grand Baie, providing easy access to shops, restaurants and local attractions.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 69 luxury suites
- Royal Villa with private pool
- Three restaurants & weekly Royal Grill
- Valmont Spa
- Helipad

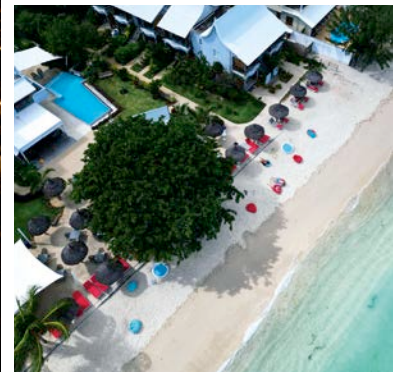
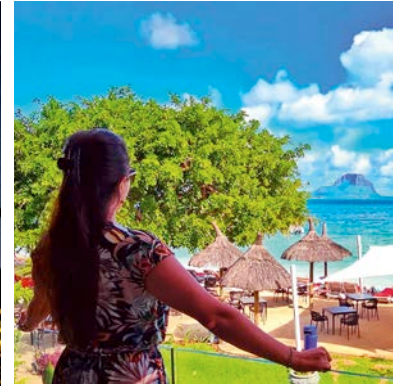
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Complimentary golf
- Complimentary land activities & watersports
- Complimentary kids' club activities
- Fitness centre workouts & classes
- Swimming & relaxation across 3 heated pools

GET IN TOUCH

- beachcombertours.uk
- 01483 445615
- holidays@beachcombertours.uk
- instagram.com/beachcombertoursuk

DON'T MISS Perfect your swing at nearby Mont Choisy Le Golf, an 18-hole championship course



La Mariposa

LA PRENEUSE, MAURITIUS

On Mauritius's sun-drenched west coast, where volcanic mountains meet the Indian Ocean, the village of La Preneuse unfolds at an unhurried pace. Dominating the horizon is Le Morne Brabant, the Unesco World Heritage-listed mountain, with its dramatic cliffs that stand as both a striking natural landmark and a powerful symbol of Mauritius's history, having once provided refuge for enslaved people seeking freedom.

Set directly on the beach, La Mariposa Boutique Residence embraces its surroundings. With just 33 rooms nestled within tropical gardens, the intimate property reflects the relaxed character of the west coast. Days unfold to the gentle rhythm of the lagoon, where the sounds of waves and the scent of flowering tropical plants create a tranquil setting.

The surrounding Black River district showcases the island's remarkable biodiversity. A short drive inland, Black River Gorges National Park protects Mauritius's largest remaining tract of native forest and provides habitat for rare endemic species, including the Mauritius kestrel, pink pigeon and echo parakeet. Hiking trails wind through

ebony forests, waterfalls and mountain ridges, revealing sweeping views across the island's volcanic landscape.

History is equally woven into the region. The nearby Martello Tower, built by the British in the 1830s to defend the western coastline, now operates as a museum illustrating Mauritius's colonial past and strategic importance in the Indian Ocean. The waters of nearby Tamarin Bay are known for pods of spinner and bottlenose dolphins as well as sperm whales, frequently spotted during the early morning.

Mauritius's rich cultural heritage is reflected in its cuisine, shaped by African, Indian, Chinese and European influences. Fresh seafood, octopus curry, *rougaille* (tomato-based stew), *dholl puri* (stuffed flatbread) and tropical fruits feature across local menus, while nearby markets offer seasonal produce, aromatic spices and handmade crafts that reflect the island's multicultural identity.

Positioned between mountains, lagoon and forest, La Mariposa provides an ideal base for exploring southwest Mauritius.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Concierge/reception desk to help organise trips
- Airport shuttles
- Excursions on land & at sea

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Non-motorised sea activities on request, such as standup paddleboarding and kayaking
- Boat tours
- Dolphin- & whale-watching
- In-room massages
- Catamaran trips

GET IN TOUCH

- lamariposa.mu
- +230 483 5048 / +230 5728 0506
- sales@lamariposa.mu
- [instagram.com/la_mariposa_mauritius](https://www.instagram.com/la_mariposa_mauritius)

DON'T MISS Set sail at dawn to try to see dolphins and whales in the waters of Tamarin Bay



Villa Harmonie – Îlot Fortier

PETITE RIVIÈRE NOIRE, MAURITIUS

There's a particular kind of stillness that only exists on an islet within an island — and it's this rare, double remoteness that gives Villa Harmonie its name. Nestled on a small private islet on the west coast of Mauritius, Villa Harmonie is a peaceful sanctuary. Facing the lagoon with uninterrupted views towards the Unesco-listed Le Morne Brabant, it feels wonderfully removed from modern life.

Villa Harmonie is run by a Mauritian family whose roots on the island stretch back seven generations. Built by a couple with backgrounds in interior design and travel, the villa is now run alongside their three children — a naturopath and two yoga teachers — who share a philosophy centred on wellbeing, simplicity and respect for both people and the environment.

With just five bedrooms, the villa remains intentionally intimate. Each room celebrates one of the cultures that shaped modern Mauritius — Creole, Indian, Chinese, French and British — reflecting the island's rich cultural mosaic. Guests can enjoy cuisine prepared by Amanda, the villa's cook, with vegetarian and gluten-free

choices available, or privatise the villa for up to 12 guests, with the option of arranging a private chef to prepare Mauritian and international dishes.

Life naturally unfolds outdoors. After a relaxed breakfast of fresh tropical fruits beneath the shade of the villa's tamarind tree, guests paddle across the lagoon by kayak or jump aboard the villa's boat — a traditional Mauritian *pirogue* — with Denis, the local gardener who's been part of the Villa Harmonie family for more than 20 years. His intimate knowledge of the lagoon transforms each trip, from snorkelling in crystal-clear waters to visiting Crystal Rock and the white sandy beaches of Île aux Bénitiers, just 15 minutes away.

For those wishing to explore further, many of Mauritius's finest natural attractions are nearby. Black River Gorges National Park, the island's largest protected forest, is home to endemic wildlife, rivers, waterfalls and Mauritius's highest peak. The surrounding area also offers scuba diving, the chance to swim with dolphins, standup paddleboarding, world-class kitesurfing, golf courses and some of the island's best restaurants.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Hire the whole villa (maximum 12 guests) or book individual rooms
- Swimming pool
- Lush tropical gardens
- Private lagoon access

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Kayaking
- Massages
- Yoga sessions
- Boat trips for snorkelling

GET IN TOUCH

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- [instagram.com/villa.harmonie](https://www.instagram.com/villa.harmonie)

DON'T MISS Explore the sheltered lagoon by kayak, swim with dolphins and unwind in a hammock beneath Mauritius's renowned sunsets



La Pirogue

FLIC EN FLAC, MAURITIUS

La Pirogue, the first hotel to open on Mauritius's west coast — in 1976 — is a charming resort that embodies warm Mauritian hospitality and island culture, blending luxury and authenticity. Set in a coconut grove along a half-mile of white-sand beach on the magical sunset coast, La Pirogue offers individual palm-thatched bungalows, exotic gardens and a stunning infinity pool blending into its tropical surroundings.

Accommodation at La Pirogue is full of traditional Mauritian charm, with vibrant colours, local artwork and fishing boat-inspired thatched roofs. Each room is hidden away amid the coconut grove.

La Pirogue is the perfect place to sample the best traditional Mauritian dishes, including fresh seafood and hearty curries. Wine-lovers will feel at home at Van der Stel Wine Bar, with more than 60 wines to sample by the glass. A sommelier is on hand to offer tasting notes and suggestions for pairing the wines with a cheeseboard or other light meals. La Pirogue guests also enjoy privileged access to the bars and restaurants of the neighbouring five-star Sugar Beach resort.

A stay at La Pirogue is not just a holiday, it's a luxury induction into the very best of Mauritian culture, from traditional cuisine to once-in-a-lifetime local experiences, such as fishing, diving and dolphin-watching. The hotel provides direct access to the crystal-blue ocean — the perfect place for trying watersports such as snorkelling, windsurfing and kayaking.

On land, the Come Alive Collection offers a series of experiences to radiate the magic of Mauritius. Try the Segha Zumba workout, born from an imaginative blend of Zumba and the fiery rhythm and moves of Mauritian sega dance. Listen to fascinating tales about the history and traditions of the island whilst trying a fresh fruit confit prepared according to a traditional recipe of salt, chilli and tamarind sauce; or start the day with breakfast served in a private traditional *pirogue* boat.

Glow by Sunlife is the hotel's new spa and wellness journey, offering an authentic and customised Mauritian experience based on the three pillars of wellbeing: elemental energy, nurturing energy and creative energy.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Half-mile of white-sand beach
- Traditional thatched bungalows
- Van der Stel Wine Bar with more than 60 premium wines available to try
- Access to the 5-star Sugar Beach hotel

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Complimentary unlimited green fees at Ile aux Cerfs Golf Club & Tamarina Golf Club
- Complimentary watersports
- Join the hotel's Sunset Ritual activity to witness a symphony of colours as the sun sets
- Learn the traditional Mauritian sega dance as part of the hotel's Segha Zumba activity

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Discover the Come Alive Experiences at La Pirogue featuring Segha Zumba, Dodo Wish, Marsan Confit and much more



Azura Boutique Retreats

BENGUERRA ISLAND, MOZAMBIQUE

Set within the pristine Bazaruto Archipelago, a protected Marine National Park just off the coast of Mozambique, Azura Boutique Retreats offers an immersive island escape where barefoot luxury meets one of the Indian Ocean's most remarkable natural environments. Located on Benguerra Island, the retreats provide access to untouched beaches, vibrant coral reefs, rich marine life and authentic Mozambican culture.

Unlike many of the Indian Ocean's more developed islands, Benguerra remains largely untouched, with sandy tracks instead of roads and traditional dhow sailing boats still traversing the turquoise waters. The island is surrounded by a protected marine reserve renowned for its biodiversity, making it one of Southern Africa's premier destinations for snorkelling, diving, fishing and marine wildlife encounters.

Azura Boutique Retreats comprises two distinct properties: Azura Benguerra Island and Azura Marlin Beach. Villas feature private pools, expansive outdoor living spaces, direct beach access and personalised butler-host service.

Dining forms a key part of the Azura experience. Menus celebrate fresh, locally sourced ingredients and seasonal produce, with seafood supplied daily by local fishermen. Signature dishes include Mozambican prawns, peri-peri chicken, lobster, crab, calamari and fragrant fish curries paired with carefully selected wines. Meals are served in ever-changing locations, so guests can expect the likes of beachside breakfasts, lantern-lit dinners beneath the stars and picnics on secluded islands.

Guided snorkelling excursions explore Two-Mile Reef, one of Mozambique's most celebrated marine environments. Dhow cruises offer sunset views, while island-hopping adventures reveal remote beaches. Whale-watching from July to October offers the chance to observe migrating humpback whales, while marine safaris seek out the last viable population of dugongs in the western Indian Ocean.

Complementing the natural attractions are open-air spa treatments and cultural island tours that provide insight into local communities and conservation initiatives supported by the Azura Rainbow Fund.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Private beachfront villas with plunge pools (Beach Villas at Azura Marlin Beach share a communal pool)
- Peri Peri Beach Club
- Spa & wellness facilities
- Personal butler-host service

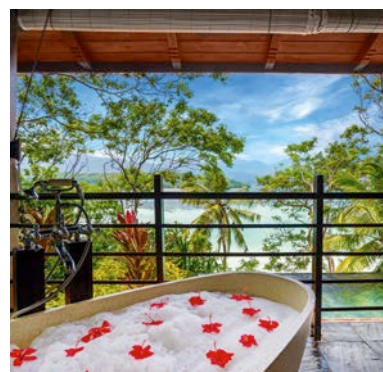
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Snorkelling & scuba diving at Two-Mile Reef
- Sunset dhow cruises
- Island-hopping excursions
- Whale-watching, dugong spotting & seahorse safaris

GET IN TOUCH

- azura-retreats.com
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- reservations@azura-retreats.com
- instagram.com/azuraretreats

DON'T MISS Speedboat to Benguerra's northern sandspit for a castaway picnic in turquoise seas, plus a sunset dhow cruise



Enchanted Island Resort

SEYCHELLES

The journey to Enchanted Island Resort from the main island of Mahé takes minutes, yet it feels like you've travelled to another world. Here, a private island sanctuary awaits, where turquoise waters, geologically distinctive granitic boulders and Creole charm combine to create one of the Seychelles' most enchanting escapes. Located in the heart of the Sainte Anne Marine National Park (the first marine protected area in the Indian Ocean), Enchanted Island Resort is surrounded by some of the best beaches and waters the archipelago has to offer.

Thoughtfully designed to blend seamlessly into its natural surroundings and showcase traditional Seychellois architecture, the resort feels like a hidden sanctuary untouched by time. Guests are invited to step back to the Seychelles of the 1930s, with antique furniture, vintage travel posters and historic maps (some dating back to the 1800s), alongside original artwork by local artists. The elegance of a bygone era is complemented by all the comforts of modern luxury.

The resort is a boutique property with only 13 accommodation options. Guests can enjoy spacious

villas, each with their own private decking perfect for lounging, gazebos, infinity-edged pools with sea views, direct beach or ocean access right at their doorstep and outdoor bathrooms with bathtubs embellished with mother of pearl. The resort also offers hilltop rooms in the island's tree-top canopy.

Enchanted Island Resort has two restaurants and two bars that deliver impeccable service and offer an extensive variety of expertly crafted recipes with refined Creole and international flavours.

Set on the crest of the island, among the vegetation, the Tresor Spa pavilion is ideally located to restore balance and wellbeing with a selection of holistic treatments.

Beyond the shoreline, the marine park comes to life. The coral reefs and expansive seagrass beds that surround the island create lovely conditions for swimming, snorkelling and eco-friendly, non-motorised watersports. Guests may even spot turtles, rays or dolphins gliding through the water.

Enchanted Island Resort will transition to Autograph Collection Hotels, Marriott Bonvoy's diverse portfolio of independent hotels, in early 2027.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 10 private pool villas & 3 hilltop rooms
- 2 restaurants & 2 bars
- Spa pavillion & gym

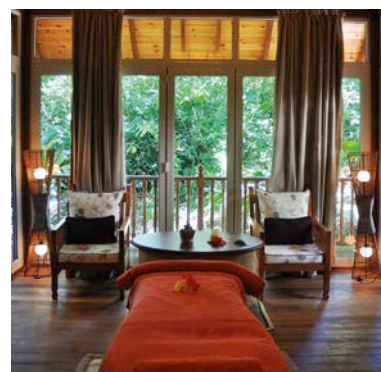
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Meeting the Aldabra giant tortoises at Moyenne Island National Park
- Strolling along the stunning sandbank that forms during low tide
- Kayaking & snorkelling in the waters that surround the island
- Taking in the culture & sights of Mahé on a guided tour
- Rejuvenating couples massages & treatments

GET IN TOUCH

- marriott.com/sezei/enchantedislandresort.com
- +248 4392727
- reservations@enchantedislandresort.com
- instagram.com/enchantedislandresort

DON'T MISS Sip on a cocktail at Sundowners Beach Bar, a great spot for catching spectacular sunsets and moonrises



Cerf Island Resort

CERF ISLAND, SEYCHELLES

Situated within the protected Sainte Anne Marine National Park, Cerf Island Resort offers an exclusive sanctuary of 24 private villas, turquoise waters and untouched Creole elegance. Located just a 10-minute boat ride from Mahé, the property bridges raw island exploration with four-star boutique luxury. Measuring just a mile long and entirely car-free, Cerf Island is an intimate natural haven for travellers seeking genuine peace, privacy and vibrant coral reefs.

The resort's spacious, air-conditioned villas are named after native flora and fauna. Built into lush hillsides using local wood and stone, they showcase traditional Seychellois architecture, which blends into the dense jungle canopy. Villas are spaced far apart, ensuring ultimate privacy. Inside select villas, signature semi-open-air bathrooms invite guests to soak in double tubs or rinse off under the stars. Outside, large private wooden decks with sunloungers serve as living spaces where the jungle meets the sea, completely undisturbed by cars.

For those celebrating lifelong milestones, the resort transforms into a theatre of bespoke

romance. Couples can exchange vows during an intimate beach wedding or curate a surprise sunset proposal atop the scenic hilltop helipad — the highest point on the island, boasting 360-degree ocean views. Celebrations continue with signature sunset cocktails at the helipad, followed by a private, candlelit beach dinner under the stars.

The daily experience offers a perfect balance of activity and relaxation. Guests enjoy complimentary access to kayaks, paddleboards and snorkelling gear, so they can explore an underwater sanctuary right off the beach. The resort sits close to Mahé, meaning guests can also easily embark on exciting day excursions to explore neighbouring islands. Alternatively, slower days can be spent lounging by two beachfront infinity pools or unwinding at Le Spa Latanier with its restorative 'back to nature' treatments.

Dining here is an equally unforgettable affair. The open-plan layout of the resort's two restaurants provides a stunning backdrop where freshly caught fish and traditional Creole spices are paired with panoramic marine park views.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- A 10-minute journey by boat from the main island
- Spacious villas set in nature
- Dining experience overlooking the marine park
- 2 infinity swimming pools
- Scenic helipad for a sunset proposal or evening cocktail

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Snorkelling
- Back-to-nature spa
- Paddleboarding
- Kayaking
- Romantic beach dinner

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Enjoy a sunset kayak and snorkel safari across the pristine coral reefs of the Sainte Anne Marine Park right from your doorstep



Boat Trips Club Zanzibar

ZANZIBAR, TANZANIA

Kendwa occupies a privileged position on the northern tip of Unguja's west coast, where the sun sinks directly into the Indian Ocean rather than disappearing behind a headland. Its location also makes it one of Zanzibar's best swimming beaches. Along much of the island's east coast, an extensive reef platform means the sea retreats more than half a mile from shore at low tide. Here, the intertidal zone is far narrower, meaning calm, swimmable water remains throughout the day. Offshore, Tumbatu Island sits low on the horizon.

Across the Indian Ocean and the Caribbean, Boat Trips Club holds a 4.8 rating from more than 5,000 verified reviews. In Zanzibar, it operates from both Kendwa and Stone Town, offering private and shared trips: snorkelling, sunset dhow cruises, sandbank excursions and deep-sea fishing.

From Kendwa, the day begins in the shallows. With no jetty, guests simply wade into the warm water before climbing aboard and setting course for Mnemba Atoll. This oval-shaped coral reef is one of East Africa's finest snorkelling sites. In water just four metres deep, Moorish idols, palette

surgeonfish and Bengal snappers weave between coral heads, while clownfish shelter among swaying anemones. Offshore, spinner and Indo-Pacific bottlenose dolphins are frequently encountered.

Another popular route heads to Tumbatu, Zanzibar's third-largest island. Five miles long and a mile wide, it's home to the atmospheric coral-stone ruins of a settlement inhabited between the 12th and 15th centuries.

Departing from Stone Town, boats also head for Changuu, better known as Prison Island. Despite its name, the prison was never used to hold people, instead becoming a quarantine station for Britain's East African territories. Today, the island is best known for its population of Aldabra giant tortoises. Nearby lies Nakupenda, a pristine sandbank where crews prepare grilled fish, octopus, rice and chapatis directly on the sand.

For anglers, there are many options. There are the deep waters of the Pemba Channel, home to yellowfin tuna, dorado and sailfish. Whichever route, most end the day gliding past Kendwa and neighbouring Nungwi as the sun sets.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Catamaran fleet
- Traditional dhows & local wooden boats
- Kendwa Beach base
- Stone Town waterfront base

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Mnemba reef snorkelling
- Prison Island & Nakupenda Sandbank excursions
- Sunset dhow cruises
- Pemba Channel deep-sea fishing

GET IN TOUCH

- boattripsclub.com/locations/zanzibar
- +1 888 832 4893
- info@boattripsclub.com
- instagram.com/boattripsclub

DON'T MISS Visit Tumbatu, a ruined 12th-century town on Zanzibar's third island, seen from Kendwa



The Overhang

KIGAMBONI, TANZANIA

Along much of the Indian Ocean coastline, the beach comes with company. Vendors move between sunloungers, music drifts from neighbouring resorts and days fill quickly with organised activities. At The Overhang, on Tanzania's southern coast, the experience is notably different.

Set across more than 100 acres of coastal wilderness in Kigamboni, south of Dar es Salaam, the property was never designed as a traditional beach resort. Instead, it offers something increasingly rare: space. Space to walk along the shoreline, spend hours by the ocean and experience a slower pace shaped by nature rather than schedules.

With just six villas and five beach tents spread across the property, many guests compare the experience to staying on a private estate rather than in a hotel. There are two private beaches and a coastal forest, creating an environment where uninterrupted time outdoors comes naturally.

Many travellers arrive at The Overhang at the end of a Tanzanian journey. After safaris, climbing Mount Kilimanjaro or travelling through the country on demanding itineraries,

the property offers an opportunity to slow down before returning home.

Food has become one of the defining parts of the guest experience. The property's small scale allows the kitchen team to focus on quality, flexibility, and personal service rather than volume. Fresh seafood, seasonal produce and coastal influences shape menus inspired by the region, while returning guests are often welcomed by name and with a familiarity usually associated with staying among friends.

Beyond the property, Kigamboni reveals a lesser-known side of Tanzania's coastline. Fishing communities continue traditions shaped by the sea, while nearby conservation initiatives help protect important marine turtle nesting habitats and wildlife. Guests can explore by kayak, paddleboard, bicycle or on foot, discovering a landscape often overlooked by travellers focused on safari circuits.

While some beach destinations are known for their lively atmosphere and constant activity, The Overhang offers a quieter alternative, with private beaches, uninterrupted ocean views and space to truly switch off.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 2 private beaches
- Oceanfront restaurant & bar
- Pickleball & padel
- More than 100 acres of private coastal nature

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Kayaking & paddleboarding
- Nature walks
- Cycling
- Turtle nesting (seasonal)

GET IN TOUCH

- theoverhang.co.tz
- instagram.com/theoverhangtz

DON'T MISS Enjoy private beaches, ocean sunrises and uninterrupted time on Tanzania's coastline



Sea Cliff Resort & Spa

ZANZIBAR, TANZANIA

Perched on a coral cliff on Zanzibar's northwest coast, Sea Cliff Resort & Spa promises uninterrupted sea views just a 20-minute drive from the historic streets of Stone Town. This balance of seclusion and accessibility places guests within easy reach of both relaxation and cultural discovery. The resort's design reflects Zanzibar's layered heritage, drawing on Arab and Swahili influences through a palette of cream and gold, intricate detailing and antique-inspired furnishings. Open spaces, ocean-facing terraces and natural textures create an atmosphere well suited to honeymoons, destination weddings and special occasions.

Sea Cliff Resort & Spa has established itself as one of Zanzibar's leading wedding destinations. Celebrations for up to 200 guests can be hosted across landscaped gardens, elegant indoor venues and the private boma overlooking the sea. Sunset ceremonies are a defining feature, with the Indian Ocean providing a naturally dramatic backdrop. The resort's layout also allows wedding parties and guests to stay together at the property.

Deluxe rooms feature freestanding bathtubs and private balconies, while Superior Sea View rooms offer expansive views of the Indian Ocean. Interconnecting garden-access rooms provide an ideal option for families and groups travelling together, combining privacy with easy access to the resort's grounds.

Dining reflects Zanzibar's identity as a historic spice island. Restaurants and bars are positioned throughout the property, each offering a distinct atmosphere, from relaxed poolside dining to sunset meals overlooking the ocean. A chef's garden supplies fresh herbs and seasonal produce, helping to shape menus and reinforcing a connection between cuisine, land and local flavour.

Sea Cliff is also home to Zanzibar's only ocean-side golf course, a nine-hole layout, where fairways trace the edge of the cliff. The Zuri Rituals Spa offers ayurvedic treatments delivered by a certified therapist from Kerala, alongside a sauna, steam room and dedicated couples' treatment space. Complimentary activities range from watersports and tennis to squash, pickleball and mini golf.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Complimentary shuttle bus service to Stone Town
- Ocean-side golf course
- Zuri Rituals Spa
- Dedicated kids' club

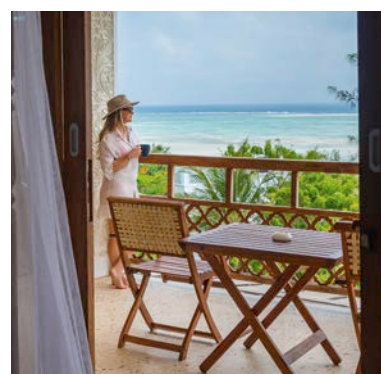
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Kayaking & catamaran sailing
- Windsurfing
- Tennis & squash
- Mini golf & pickleball
- Authentic ayurvedic treatments
- Full-body massage
- Couples' massage
- Sauna & steam therapy

GET IN TOUCH

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- instagram.com/seacliffzanzibar

DON'T MISS Ride on horseback into the Indian Ocean at sunset before sipping beachside cocktails overlooking the coast



Warere Beach

ZANZIBAR, TANZANIA

Set on a secluded stretch of coastline just beyond the lively village of Nungwi, Warere Beach offers a more tranquil perspective on one of Zanzibar's most celebrated destinations. Framed by turquoise waters and tropical gardens, the property captures the quieter rhythms of island life while remaining closely connected to the cultural and maritime heritage that defines the region.

Situated at the northern tip of the island, Nungwi has long been known for its deep-rooted seafaring traditions, and it remains one of the few places in Zanzibar where wooden dhows are still handcrafted using centuries-old techniques. Each morning, local fishing boats depart from nearby shores, continuing practices that have shaped the identity of the coastline for generations. This enduring connection to the ocean is woven into daily life, offering travellers an authentic glimpse into Zanzibar's living history.

The property features 23 ocean-view and oceanfront rooms, each designed to maximise the natural beauty of the surroundings. Oceanfront accommodation offers an added level of privacy,

complete with individual plunge pools overlooking the Indian Ocean. Palm-fringed gardens and open views create a sense of calm seclusion, while the proximity to Nungwi ensures access to a range of marine excursions and cultural experiences.

Cuisine at Warere Beach reflects Zanzibar's position as a historic crossroads of trade and culture. Swahili fusion dishes highlight fresh seafood, tropical produce and locally sourced spices, including cloves, cinnamon, cardamom and coconut — ingredients that underscore Zanzibar's longstanding reputation as the 'Spice Island'. Private dining experiences can be arranged on the oceanfront deck, where meals are served beneath the night sky against the sound of the waves.

Beyond the property, the surrounding area offers a wealth of experiences. Nearby coral reefs provide excellent snorkelling opportunities, while excursions to spice farms reveal the agricultural traditions behind Zanzibar's famed exports. Historic Stone Town, with its intricate architecture and layered cultural influences, offers further insight into the island's past.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Oceanfront swimming pool
- Spa & wellness area
- Bar & restaurant
- Private plunge pools (select rooms)

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Snorkelling & reef excursions
- Spice farm tours
- Stone Town cultural visits
- Dhow at sunset

GET IN TOUCH

- warere.com
- info@warere.com
- instagram.com/warerebeach

DON'T MISS Enjoy a private oceanfront dinner beneath the stars, surrounded by the sounds of the ocean



The Villa of Zanzibar

ZANZIBAR, TANZANIA

Overlooking Tumbatu Island on Zanzibar's northwest coast, The Villa of Zanzibar is an oceanfront residence set within 11,500sq metres of tropical gardens. The property offers the intimacy and freedom of a private home, combined with the service and comforts of a fully staffed hotel.

Designed to embrace its natural surroundings, the residence blends indoor and outdoor living through generous terraces, lush gardens and ocean-facing spaces. Hardwood and locally sourced Tanga stone lend warmth and character to the architecture, while four individually designed bedrooms accommodate up to eight guests. Two oceanfront bungalows, currently under development, will soon increase the property's capacity to 12 guests. There's also a 30-metre infinity pool stretching towards the Indian Ocean.

Food is central to the experience. The chef tailors each day's menus to guests' preferences, from relaxed lunches to elegant dinners beneath the stars. Much of the produce comes directly from the property's own kitchen garden and fruit trees, while fruit, vegetables, seafood, fish and

meat are sourced from local farmers, fisherfolk and producers across Zanzibar and mainland Tanzania. This close relationship with local suppliers keeps the cuisine firmly connected to the region while supporting shorter supply chains.

Community also plays an important role. The villa supports local schools in Kidoti, as well as the highest-achieving students in each graduating class. Care for the natural environment is also woven into the way the property operates. Rainwater is collected to irrigate the tropical gardens, organic waste is composted, and drinking water is filtered and bottled on site. These thoughtful initiatives reflect a simple philosophy: to offer a memorable guest experience while helping to protect the environment.

Beyond the villa, Zanzibar offers countless opportunities to explore its rich natural and cultural heritage. Visit the island's renowned spice farms, wander the historic streets of Stone Town or head out onto the Indian Ocean for boat trips, sandbank excursions and days spent discovering the surrounding coastline.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 4 individually designed bedrooms, with 2 oceanfront bungalows coming soon
- 30-metre infinity pool overlooking the Indian Ocean
- Fully staffed villa with private chef & dedicated manager-concierge
- Just 10 minutes from the beaches, restaurants & nightlife of Kendwa

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Boat trips, sandbank excursions & Indian Ocean experiences
- Visits to Zanzibar's renowned spice farms & historic Stone Town
- Swimming & exploring the shoreline as the tides transform the landscape

GET IN TOUCH

- thevillaofzanzibar.com
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- instagram.com/the_villa_of_zanzibar

DON'T MISS Watch the sun set over Tumbatu Island before enjoying a private dinner beneath the stars



Zanbluu Beach Hotel

ZANZIBAR, TANZANIA

On Zanzibar's northeast coast, where the Indian Ocean shifts between the famous shades of turquoise and cobalt, Zanbluu Beach Hotel offers something increasingly rare in modern travel: a boutique escape where luxury and environmental responsibility quietly coexist.

Perched above the shoreline just outside the peaceful village of Kiwengwa, the 19 room, independently owned hotel has become known not only for its oceanfront setting and calm atmosphere, but also for its forward-thinking approach to sustainability.

Natural materials, open-air spaces and locally inspired design allow the hotel to blend into its coastal surroundings, while daily operations increasingly focus on reducing the resort's long-term environmental impact.

In recent years, the property has introduced solar energy systems as part of a broader effort to reduce reliance on traditional power sources across Zanzibar. The hotel has also removed many disposable plastics from guest experiences, replacing single-use water bottles with reusable

glass alternatives that are refilled on site through a reverse osmosis filtration system.

Beyond the visible guest-facing changes, many of the hotel's most meaningful environmental efforts happen behind the scenes. Organic waste from the kitchens and gardens is transformed into compost. Recycling initiatives and mindful purchasing policies further support the hotel's ambition to operate more responsibly within the island ecosystem.

Yet sustainability here isn't presented as a trend or marketing exercise. Instead, it forms part of the hotel's wider philosophy of care — for the environment, for local culture and for the guest experience itself.

Visitors are encouraged to engage with Zanzibar thoughtfully, whether by supporting local communities, respecting the marine life during ocean excursions or simply by slowing down enough to reconnect with nature. From sunrise paddleboarding and dhow sailing to long afternoons beside the infinity pool, the experience at Zanbluu feels intentionally unhurried.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Infinity pool overlooking the Indian Ocean
- Infinity Sea Front Rooms with private plunge pools
- Responsible dining
- Relaxing massages by the ocean

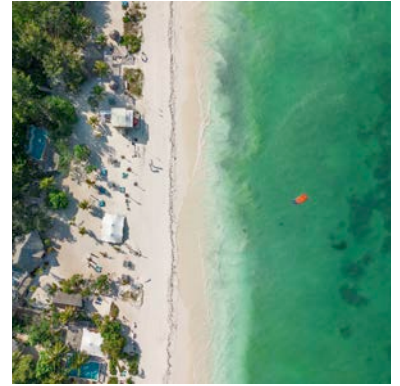
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Traditional Dhow sailing & sunset cruises
- Snorkelling & marine experiences
- Diving to discover Zanzibar beneath the surface
- Discover Zanzibar through adventure, culture & centuries of history

GET IN TOUCH

- zanbluu.com
- +255 776 018 295
- info@zanbluu.com
- [instagram.com/zanbluu](https://www.instagram.com/zanbluu)

DON'T MISS Enjoy a traditional Ingalawa sailing experience across Zanzibar's shallow turquoise reefs



Sharazād Boutique Hotels

ZANZIBAR, TANZANIA

Fringed by the warm waters of the Indian Ocean, Zanzibar has long been a meeting point of cultures. African, Arab, Persian, Indian and European influences have blended over centuries to shape one of East Africa's most distinctive destinations. Along the island's southeastern coast, traditional wooden dhows cross the lagoon, women cultivate seaweed at low tide and the retreating ocean reveals vast sandbanks and coral-rich shallows.

Set on this remarkable stretch of coast, Sharazād Boutique Hotel offers travellers an intimate connection with Zanzibar's landscapes, traditions and people. Family-owned and independently managed, it began as a private residence and has evolved over the past decade without losing the warmth and authenticity of its origins.

Wellness is woven naturally into the experience. Sunrise yoga, holistic treatments and quiet spaces beneath the palms invite guests to slow down, recharge and reset. The surrounding lagoon also offers kitesurfing, reef snorkelling, scuba diving and sailing, with traditional dhow journeys revealing the coastline from a different perspective.

Food on the island tells another story. Fresh seafood is supplied by nearby fisherfolk, fruit and vegetables are sourced from local farms, and cloves, cinnamon and cardamom recall Zanzibar's historic spice trade. Menus combine Swahili flavours with Mediterranean influences, with seasonal produce and vegetarian dishes at their heart.

In the Unesco-listed heart of Stone Town, Sharazād Wonders Boutique Hotel is located within a sensitively restored coral-stone building. Beyond its shaded courtyard lie winding lanes, carved wooden doors, lively markets and architecture shaped by centuries of Indian Ocean trade.

Responsible hospitality remains central to the Sharazād philosophy. Solar energy, desalinated water, locally sourced products and long-standing community partnerships help protect the island's environment and cultural heritage. This approach has won the group various accolades, including; Tripadvisor Travellers' Choice Best of the Best 2026; Best Luxury Boutique Hotel in Zanzibar at the Luxury Lifestyle Awards 2026; and recognition at the Haute Grandeur Global Hotel Awards 2026.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Beachfront boutique hotel on Zanzibar's southeast coast
- Boutique hotel in Zanzibar's historic Stone Town
- Holistic wellness, yoga & ocean-inspired spa experiences
- Sustainable hospitality rooted in local communities
- Artisan concept store

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Traditional dhow sailing
- Stone Town cultural & heritage walks
- Yoga, wellness & holistic experiences
- Kitesurfing & scuba diving

GET IN TOUCH

- [sharazadzanzibar.com](https://www.sharazadzanzibar.com)
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- salesandmarketing@sharazadboutiquehotel.com
- [instagram.com/sharazadboutiquehotels](https://www.instagram.com/sharazadboutiquehotels)

DON'T MISS Set out at low tide and float into the sunlit shallows, surrounded by thriving, vibrant reefs



Eco Beach Wilderness Retreat

BROOME, AUSTRALIA

Set on a remote stretch of Kimberley coastline, 80 miles south of Broome, Eco Beach Wilderness Retreat sits between the turquoise waters of the Indian Ocean and the vast expanse of Yawuru Country. Surrounded by pindan cliffs, white sand and native bushland, it offers a rare sense of seclusion in one of Western Australia's most striking landscapes. Known to its Traditional Owners as Yardoogarra, it's here that Eco Beach Wilderness Retreat has been welcoming guests for more than three decades.

The property offers 48 rooms spread across the dunes above the beach and the ethos is barefoot rather than formal. Safari-style glamping tents sit among the scrub, their canvas walls opening to the night air. Eco Villas offer garden, ocean-view or complete oceanfront outlooks. The Beach House sits directly above the sand with its own kitchen, deck and beach access. An infinity pool overlooks the beach, with views across the ocean.

Jack's Bar & Restaurant, named after the mangrove creek behind the property, sits above the dunes on an open-air deck facing west

across the ocean. The kitchen showcases local Kimberley produce and ocean-to-plate seafood, while sunsets shift from copper to violet in the space of 20 minutes. Between June and September, the waters offshore become a migration route for humpback whales, and fortunate guests may spot them from the deck.

Stays shape themselves around the coast. Travellers can bookend their days with sunrise and sunset beach yoga, kayaking to a cave illuminated by a natural blowhole skylight, joining a guided fishing session on the creek or taking a scenic helicopter flight along the coastline. There's also the option to book in to the Dragonfly Day Spa for treatments such as the Mud & Bubbles experience, combining a mangrove mud treatment on the beach with sparkling wine and a rinse in the ocean.

After dark, with little artificial light for miles around, guests can fall asleep beneath a sky crowded with stars. Shoes come off. Screens lose their purpose. The 80 miles between Broome and the front gate isn't simply part of the journey — it's part of the experience.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Jack's Bar & Restaurant
- Oceanfront infinity pool
- Dragonfly Day Spa
- Solar & battery-powered retreat

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Mud & Bubbles experience
- Scenic helicopter flights
- Kayak cave adventure
- Daily yoga, private sessions & sunset beach yoga

GET IN TOUCH

- ecobeach.com
- +61 8 9193 8015
- reservations@ecobeach.com
- instagram.com/ecobeachresort

DON'T MISS Visit between June and September when humpback whales migrate offshore



Mango Tree Lodge

CHRISTMAS ISLAND, AUSTRALIA

Cloaked in ancient rainforest, fringed by limestone cliffs and surrounded by some of the most pristine marine environments on Earth, Christmas Island is one of the planet's natural treasures.

Nestled between lush tropical jungle and the sparkling Indian Ocean, Mango Tree Lodge provides an ideal base from which to explore this extraordinary destination. Located on the peaceful edge of Settlement, the lodge combines spacious accommodation with tropical gardens and easy access to the island's most remarkable attractions.

Christmas Island is renowned for its wildlife spectacles, none more famous than the annual red crab migration. Each year, tens of millions of red crabs emerge from the rainforest and march towards the ocean, transforming roads, beaches and forest floors into a living river of crimson. It's widely regarded as one of the greatest wildlife migrations on Earth.

Yet the island's wonders extend far beyond its iconic crabs. More than 60% of Christmas Island is protected within a national park, safeguarding rare endemic species found nowhere else in the world.

Many of the unique island bird species can be seen nesting just metres from the lodge. This includes the elegant Christmas Island frigatebird and the elusive Christmas Island flying fox. Travellers can also discover hidden waterfalls and freshwater terraces tucked in the jungle.

Beneath the waves lies another world entirely. Christmas Island sits at the meeting point of major ocean currents, creating exceptional diving and snorkelling conditions. Whale sharks visit the island's waters seasonally, while vibrant coral reefs, dramatic underwater drop-offs and hundreds of fish species make the surrounding ocean a paradise for divers, underwater photographers and nature-lovers alike.

The island's multicultural heritage adds another dimension to the experience. Chinese, Malay and European influences combine to create a unique local culture expressed through colourful festivals, welcoming communities and a vibrant food scene. Local restaurants serve everything from Malaysian curries and Chinese specialities to freshly caught fish and tropical fruits grown in the island's fertile soils.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Tropical garden with spa
- Outdoor barbecue & cabana
- Ocean & jungle views
- Complimentary coffee, wi-fi, kitchen & laundry facilities

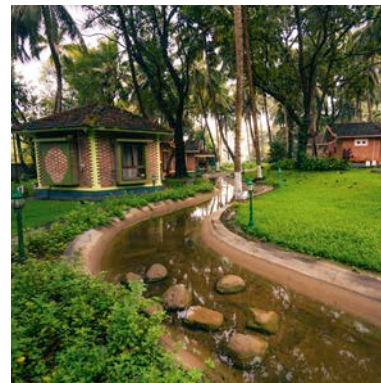
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Witness the world-famous red crab migration
- Birdwatching, jungle walks, cave & waterfall attractions
- Diving & snorkelling with whale sharks and abundant marine life
- Explore the island's temples, museums & multicultural heritage

GET IN TOUCH

- mangotreelodge.com.au
- +61 488 694 431
- reception@mangotreelodge.com.au

DON'T MISS Watch millions of red crabs march from rainforest to sea in one of the world's greatest wildlife spectacles



Kairali – The Ayurvedic Healing Village

KERALA, INDIA

Set in the tranquil Palakkad district of Kerala, Kairali – The Ayurvedic Healing Village offers an immersive introduction to India's ancient ayurvedic traditions. Spread across 65 acres of landscaped grounds filled with medicinal herbs, the retreat is designed as a space where guests can step away from the pace of modern life, focusing instead on restoration, balance and long-term wellbeing. Pathways weave through herb gardens and shaded greenery, reinforcing a strong connection between the natural surroundings and the healing process. The setting feels deliberately unhurried, encouraging a slower rhythm.

Positioned at the foothills of the Western Ghats, the retreat is surrounded by coconut groves, spice plantations and gentle streams. The region, often referred to as Kerala's gateway, blends Tamil and Malayali influences, with nearby villages offering glimpses into local traditions, from temple rituals to Chenda Melam percussion performances that form part of the area's cultural fabric.

Accommodation is made up of 30 standalone villas, designed according to the principles of

Vastu Shastra. Interiors feature traditional materials such as red oxide floors alongside more contemporary comforts, while layouts are tailored to align with birth stars, reflecting the retreat's holistic approach. Sustainability is central to the retreat, which maintains a strict no single-use plastic policy and incorporates solar-powered lighting across parts of the property.

At the centre of the experience is the on-site ayurvedic hospital, where certified practitioners develop personalised treatment programmes rooted in classical texts. Panchakarma detox therapies and stress-management treatments and longer-term wellness plans are supported by the use of organic herbs and oils, many grown within the retreat's own grounds. This is complemented by vegetarian cuisine prepared using local ingredients.

Daily routines are structured yet flexible, with morning yoga, meditation and sound-healing sessions forming part of the stay. Guests can also explore the herbal gardens or spend time in quieter spaces including the library and pool, each designed to support a slower pace of living.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Vastu-inspired villas
- Traditional Dhroni treatment rooms
- Yoga & meditation pavilion
- Swimming pool, library & gym

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Organic farm visits
- Cooking classes
- Herbal garden tours

GET IN TOUCH

- ktahv.com
- +91 9555156156
- info@ktahv.com
- [instagram.com/kairaliayurvedichealingvillage](https://www.instagram.com/kairaliayurvedichealingvillage)

DON'T MISS Spend time at the retreat's animal sanctuary, where interactions offer a grounding counterpoint to the wellness programme



Mandrem Beach Resort

NORTH GOA, INDIA

Located on the northern coast of Goa, Mandrem Beach Resort, a Member of Radisson Individuals Retreats, offers a relaxed base between the Mandrem River and the Arabian Sea. Surrounded by coconut palms, village lanes and stretches of sandy coastline, the resort reflects a side of Goa that moves at a gentler pace, where local traditions and natural landscapes remain central to daily life.

The resort occupies a truly distinctive setting, bordered by both the river and the sea, offering guests the opportunity to experience two contrasting sides of the destination. Guests can enjoy direct access to the shores of Mandrem Beach, while the area is characterised by fishing villages, Portuguese-influenced architecture, local markets and independent cafes. The property is also conveniently located for travellers arriving via Manohar International Airport, which can be reached in around 30 minutes by road.

Accommodation includes contemporary rooms and suites inspired by the coastal surroundings, with some offering views towards the river or ocean. For those seeking additional privacy,

selected suites feature private plunge pools set within landscaped tropical gardens. Throughout the property, the focus remains on comfort, open spaces and a connection to the environment.

Dining at the resort centres around Sunset Cove, where guests can enjoy Goan specialities alongside Asian and European dishes. The relaxed atmosphere extends to the beachfront bar and outdoor spaces, where views across the Arabian Sea provide a backdrop for evening drinks and sunsets. An outdoor swimming pool surrounded by tropical greenery offers a quieter alternative to the beach, while breakfast is served until noon, reflecting the laid-back rhythm of the destination.

Visitors can explore many of North Goa's cultural and outdoor attractions. Seasonal olive ridley turtle nesting sites can be found along the coastline, while Mandrem Beach offers opportunities for surfing and other water-based activities. Nearby Arambol is known for its sunset drum circles, while local artisan markets, pottery workshops and heritage walks through traditional Goan villages provide insight into the region's heritage.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Signature suites with plunge pools
- Just 30 minutes from Manohar International Airport
- Beachfront bar with Arabian Sea views
- Sunset Cove all-day dining featuring Goan, Asian & European cuisine
- Outdoor swimming pool set

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Olive ridley turtle nesting
- Surfing at Mandrem Beach
- Arambol drum circles
- Pottery at Mati Earth Studio
- Mud bath wellness experiences
- Local artisan & flea markets
- Portuguese village trail walks

GET IN TOUCH

- [mandrembeachresortgoa.com](https://www.mandrembeachresortgoa.com)
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- reservations@mbhgoa.com
- [instagram.com/mandrembeachresort](https://www.instagram.com/mandrembeachresort)

DON'T MISS Watch local toddy tappers harvest fresh coconut sap at sunrise on Mandrem Beach



Worldwide Adventures India

KERALA, INDIA

For travellers seeking a more considered way to experience India, Worldwide Adventures India has spent more than 25 years curating journeys through Kerala, a state known for its backwaters, wellness traditions and unhurried pace of life. Rather than rushing between landmarks, its itineraries focus on meaningful experiences that reveal the character of this distinctive corner of southern India.

Known as 'God's Own Country', Kerala offers a different perspective on a nation often associated with energy and movement. Along the Malabar Coast, life unfolds at a gentler rhythm: traditional houseboats drift through the backwaters, fisherfolk cast their nets at dawn, and village life continues much as it has for generations.

The backwaters remain one of Kerala's defining attractions. This vast network of lakes, canals and lagoons stretches for hundreds of miles, supporting local communities while offering visitors a unique way to explore the landscape. A cruise through these waterways provides a glimpse into daily life, from rice farming and fishing to the birdlife.

Kerala is also widely known as the home of ayurveda, the ancient system of holistic wellbeing. In destinations such as Kumarakom, guests can enjoy personalised treatments, traditional therapies and nourishing cuisine. Further inland, the hills of Munnar reveal another side. Tea estates carpet the slopes of the Western Ghats, where visitors can learn about cultivation and production before sampling the flavours that have made the region famous.

The state's cultural heritage is equally rich. In Fort Kochi, colonial influences sit alongside centuries-old traditions. Historic landmarks, including the Paradesi Synagogue, reflect Kerala's long-standing connections with traders and communities from around the world. Visitors can also experience Kathakali dance performances and Kalaripayattu demonstrations, both integral parts of Kerala's cultural identity. Sustainability and community tourism play an increasingly important role. Family-run homestays, conservation-focused resorts and locally led experiences help ensure that tourism benefits residents while protecting the landscapes that make Kerala so distinctive.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- A luxury boutique DMC
- Experts in exotic, immersive & authentic journeys, across Kerala
- Tailored, private itineraries with dedicated 24/7 on-ground support
- Heritage & boutique stays in restored mansions
- Passionate & knowledgeable guides

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Backwater cruises & houseboat stays
- Ayurvedic treatments & wellness
- Farm-to-table culinary experiences & spice walks
- Cultural performances & craft

GET IN TOUCH

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- manoj@worldwideadventuresindia.com
- [instagram.com/worldwide_adventures_asia](https://www.instagram.com/worldwide_adventures_asia)

DON'T MISS Drift through Kerala's backwaters on a luxurious traditional houseboat at golden hour



The Kin Hotel

MUMBAI, INDIA

Set within the quiet, tree-lined streets of Dadar West — one of Mumbai's oldest residential neighbourhoods — The Kin Hotel offers an intimate base from which to explore the city. Housed inside a building originally owned by their grandfather, siblings Imrun Sethi and Guneet Singh have transformed the property into a boutique hotel that reflects both the character of the neighbourhood and their own creative sensibilities. Rather than separating guests from the city, the hotel encourages immersion in it.

The building retains many of its original architectural features, including restored terrazzo flooring, now complemented by bespoke mid-century furniture, warm natural materials and a palette that's inspired by Mumbai's distinctive coastal light.

Across 15 individually designed rooms, no two spaces are alike. Vintage finds collected over years of travel sit alongside objects sourced closer to home. These range from antique rotary telephones discovered in Delhi markets to playful ceramic curiosities that give each room its own personality.

That philosophy extends beyond the guest rooms. The lobby functions as a 24-hour concept store where furniture, lighting, ceramics and decor found throughout the hotel are available to buy, blurring the line between hospitality and design retail. It reflects the founders' belief that memorable stays are built through thoughtful details rather than excess.

Food is equally personal. Imrun Sethi trained at Marco Pierre White's Michelin-starred The Criterion in London before establishing Terttulia, a celebrated modern European restaurant with locations across Mumbai, Pune and Goa. That culinary background informs the hotel's approach to dining, where carefully considered ingredients and hospitality take precedence over formality.

The Kin's location also places travellers within easy reach of some of Mumbai's defining landmarks, from the revered Siddhivinayak Temple to the sweeping Bandra-Worli Sea Link. For visitors seeking a slower, more local perspective on Mumbai, it offers an experience shaped as much by its surroundings as by the people who created it.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 24-hour design store
- In-house wellness treatments
- Curated neighbourhood tours
- Shoppable interiors

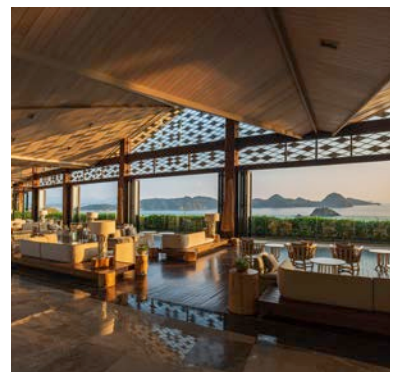
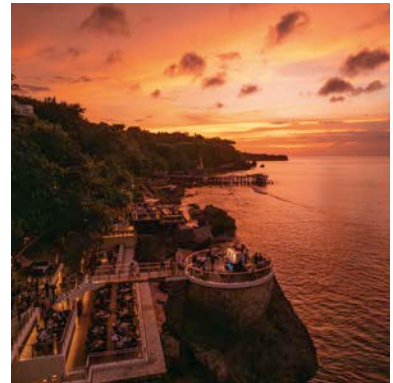
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Browse the Dadar Flower Market
- Explore Dharavi
- Visit the Siddhivinayak Temple
- Discover Colaba's Heritage District

GET IN TOUCH

- thekinhotel.com
- +91 88502 91487
- stay@thekinhotel.com
- instagram.com/thekinhotel

DON'T MISS Visit the Gateway of India before boarding a ferry to the Unesco-listed Elephanta Caves in Mumbai Harbour



AYANA Bali & AYANA Komodo Waecicu Beach

BALI & FLORES, INDONESIA

Rising above Jimbaran Bay, AYANA Bali brings together four distinctive hotels, acclaimed dining, wellness and cultural experiences across 220 acres of cliffside coastline, creating one integrated destination. Further east, AYANA Komodo Waecicu Beach extends the journey to the Unesco World Heritage-listed Komodo National Park, where remote islands, remarkable wildlife and thriving marine ecosystems reveal another side of Indonesia's archipelago.

At AYANA Bali, each day unfolds naturally between the resort's many experiences. Mornings may begin overlooking Jimbaran Bay before afternoons are spent beside the ocean, while 31 restaurants and bars showcase flavours from across Indonesia and around the world. As evening falls, guests gather at Rock Bar, where waves crash against the cliffs as the sun sets. Throughout the resort, dining, wellness and culture are woven together, encouraging guests to experience Bali at an unhurried pace.

Beyond its coastal setting, AYANA Bali offers opportunities to connect with the island's

heritage. At the heart of the estate is SAKA Museum, recognised by Prix Versailles as one of the world's most beautiful museums. Through carefully curated exhibitions, it explores Balinese philosophy, ritual traditions, craftsmanship and the island's relationship with time, offering a deeper understanding of Bali beyond its beaches.

Wellness is equally rooted in place at AYANA Spa, home to one of the world's largest seawater thalassotherapy pools, where naturally filtered seawater offers a restorative experience.

The journey continues at AYANA Komodo Waecicu Beach, the gateway to one of Indonesia's most extraordinary natural landscapes. From its private jetty, excursions into Komodo National Park offer encounters with the legendary Komodo dragon, as well as manta rays. Selected voyages aboard *AYANA Lako di'a* also provide the rare opportunity to swim alongside whale sharks and juvenile sharks. Guided by AYANA's resident marine biologists, these experiences are enriched by insights into the region's marine ecosystems and ongoing conservation efforts.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 993 rooms, 14 pools & 31 dining venues across an integrated destination
- AYANA Spa, which is home to one of the world's largest seawater thalassotherapy pools
- SAKA Museum
- AYANA Komodo's private jetty, which offers seamless access to AYANA Cruises & Komodo National Park

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Sunset cocktails at Rock Bar
- Sail through Komodo National Park with AYANA Cruises
- Snorkelling, wildlife encounters & island trekking in Flores

GET IN TOUCH

- [ayana.com](https://www.ayana.com)
- +62 361 702222
- reservation@ayana.com
- [instagram.com/ayanaresort](https://www.instagram.com/ayanaresort)

DON'T MISS Take a boat trip to Komodo National Park to see Komodo dragons, snorkel vibrant coral reefs and spot manta rays



Komaneka at Keramas Beach

BALI, INDONESIA

Komaneka began as a fine art gallery by a local couple in the once quiet Monkey Forest Road in Ubud. As an answer to Ubud's rich history of traditional art, the gallery specialised in up-and-coming Indonesian modern artists. Rooms were added behind the gallery as an artists' and collectors' residence. Before long, they decided to expand for guests looking to explore Bali's cultural heritage. Today, Komaneka has grown into a collection of properties — Komaneka at Keramas Beach is one of five Komaneka properties — each preserving the spirit of creativity and culture that first inspired the brand.

Keramas is widely known among surfers for its powerful reef breaks, yet it remains less crowded than Bali's southern beaches, preserving a sense of authenticity. Nearby villages continue to practise traditional crafts, including intricate wood carving and ceremonial offerings, which are reflected in the resort's curated cultural experiences. Guests can participate in Balinese dance lessons or learn the art of daily offerings, gaining insight into the island's spiritual rhythms.

Accommodation is designed with privacy and immersion in mind. Each villa features expansive living spaces and a private pool, with uninterrupted ocean or rice field views. The architecture blends contemporary comfort with traditional Balinese elements, creating an atmosphere that feels deeply connected to the landscape. Select villas offer direct beach access, allowing guests to move seamlessly between their private sanctuary and the shoreline.

Dining at Timur Kitchen highlights the region's rich culinary heritage while incorporating international influences. Freshly sourced seafood and local produce take centre stage, with dishes inspired by traditional Indonesian flavours such as sambal, turmeric and coconut. The open-air setting enhances the experience, with uninterrupted sea views and cooling ocean breezes.

Beyond relaxation, the resort offers a variety of experiences tailored to different interests. Wellness-seekers can unwind at Segara Wangi Spa, while active travellers may explore jogging tracks and nearby cultural sites. The surrounding Gianyar region is known for its vibrant temple festivals.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Private pool villas
- Beachfront swimming pool
- Segara Wangi Spa
- Timur Kitchen restaurant

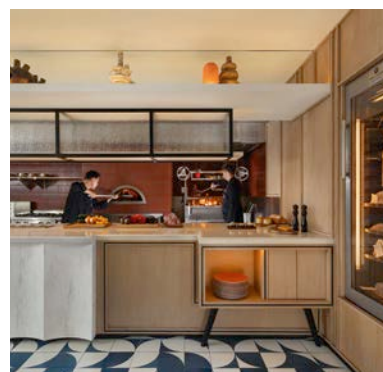
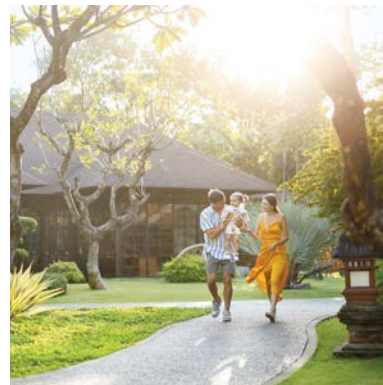
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Balinese cultural workshops
- Yoga classes
- Culinary experiences
- Sightseeing excursions

GET IN TOUCH

- komaneka.com
- +62 361 4794455
- reservation@komaneka.com
- instagram.com/komanekaresorts

DON'T MISS Catch the sunrise over Mount Agung followed by beachfront dining at Timur Kitchen



Padma Resort Legian

BALI, INDONESIA

Set along the vibrant shores of Legian Beach, Padma Resort Legian is a destination where every stay is thoughtfully designed to bring people together. Surrounded by 24 acres of tropical gardens, the resort offers a peaceful retreat while remaining just moments from the shopping, dining and entertainment of Seminyak.

Padma Resort Legian features 437 contemporary rooms and suites, catering to couples, families and groups alike. Spacious interiors, modern comforts, and views across lush gardens or lagoon-style pools create an inviting atmosphere, while Family Rooms with bunk beds and two bathrooms provide added convenience for those travelling with children.

Families are at the heart of the Padma Resort Legian experience. The Family Pool offers water slides, splash areas and shallow pools where younger guests can play freely. Nearby, the Wolly Kids Club & Games Centre hosts a variety of supervised daily activities, allowing children to learn, create, and make new friends. The recent addition of monkey bars and a mini-wall climbing area inside the Kids Club provides even more opportunities for play.

Beyond the Kids Club, the North Garden encourages guests of all ages to connect with nature through hands-on outdoor experiences. Children and parents can harvest fresh produce from the Kitchen Garden, collect eggs at the Mini Farm, explore the Mushroom Hut, enjoy fun fishing, practise archery or create traditional Balinese flower garlands. The resort's popular themed Foam Parties bring families together for memorable afternoons filled with laughter.

Dining is equally diverse, with experiences designed to suit every occasion. Mediterranean-inspired dishes prepared over a wood-fired grill await at SKAI Bar & Grill, while DONBIU Restaurant presents themed buffet dinners celebrating flavours from around the world. At TENKAI Japanese Nikkei Restaurant, guests can enjoy sushi and interactive teppanyaki experiences, which make every meal entertaining and delicious.

Blending spacious accommodation, engaging family experiences, exceptional dining and versatile event facilities, Padma Resort Legian offers more than just a holiday destination.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 5 main swimming pools
- Wolly Kids Club & Game Centre
- Fitness centre & spa
- Kitchen garden & mini farm

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Archery
- Kids' gel blaster
- Padma art & culture resort tour
- Balinese cooking class

GET IN TOUCH

- padmaresortlegian.com
- +62 361 752 111 / +62 811 3821 9512
- reservation.legian@padmahotels.com
- instagram.com/padmalegian

DON'T MISS Harvest fresh produce, collect eggs and explore the Mini Farm at Padma Resort Legian for a memorable family nature experience



Adaar Kuchchaveli

TRINCOMALEE, SRI LANKA

There's a particular quality to silence on Sri Lanka's east coast — not the absence of sound, but the presence of something calmer. At Adaar Kuchchaveli, that silence is one of the first things guests notice, and often the last thing they find themselves reluctant to leave behind.

Opened in July 2024 along a quiet stretch of Sri Lanka's east coast, Adaar Kuchchaveli is a boutique beachfront hotel with just 14 rooms. Clear skies and calm seas are the norm on this piece of shoreline, letting guests enjoy a long, sandy beach.

The property is contemporary in style, with spacious rooms opening onto a lush garden alive with birdsong. An infinity pool sits at the threshold between garden and sea, and in this space, guests tend to lose track of time. The beach beyond is shallow, typically calm and largely untouched.

The restaurant at Adaar — Sancta Lucia — serves Sri Lankan, Italian and international cuisine, with fresh seafood taking centre stage. Daily catches supplied by local fishermen feature prominently on the menu, while the poolside bar offers tropical juices, cocktails and refreshments throughout

the day. Adaar's curated excursion programme connects guests to the coast's natural and cultural heritage. Diving and snorkelling trips explore the coral reefs of Pigeon Island National Park, while boat excursions depart directly from the beach at the hotel. Guests can also visit the ancient Velgam Vehera Buddhist temple and Kanniya Hot Springs, or take day trips in Adaar's environmentally friendly electric tuk-tuk to attractions including Koneswaram Temple, Fort Frederick, Trincomalee Harbour and the Commonwealth War Cemetery.

Beyond the property, the team actively promotes sustainable practices within the local community, including beach clean-ups. The coast isn't simply a backdrop to the guest experience, but an environment the hotel is committed to protecting.

The property is managed by the Paiva family from Kandy, known for Paivas T-Rooms and Kandy Paivas Meet & Eat, established in the 1950s. Their hospitality heritage is reflected in the warm and attentive service that characterises the guest experience. It's a place that feels quietly discovered rather than simply booked.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Beachfront boutique hotel with 14 rooms
- All-day dining restaurant serving local & international cuisine
- Quiet, secluded stretch of beach
- Lush tropical garden setting

GET IN TOUCH

- adaarsrilanka.com
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- reservations@adaarsrilanka.com
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DON'T MISS Enjoy a candlelit dinner on the beach accompanied by the sound of the waves



AYUDA

NEGOMBO, SRI LANKA

On Sri Lanka's western shore, the fishing village of Pamunugama moves at a gentler pace than central Negombo. Catholic steeples rise above coconut palms, traditional *oruva* canoes head out at first light and the Indian Ocean shapes the rhythms of daily life. Ayuda sits within this coastal landscape, around 20 minutes from Bandaranaike International Airport and within easy reach of Colombo. Yet the boutique hotel's location on a pristine, secluded beach makes the popular city's busier resort strip feel like a distant memory.

Whether you're looking for a full ayurvedic cleanse, adventures in a pocket of Sri Lanka that still feels little visited or simply a reset by the ocean, Ayuda offers the perfect base. Wellbeing, grounded in centuries-old ayurvedic philosophy, is integrated throughout the experience via structured programmes and individual sessions designed by qualified practitioners. Depending on the chosen programme, days may include consultations, bespoke herbal treatments, massages, steam therapy, yoga, meditation and qigong. Personalised meals and gentle movement

practices are tailored to each guest's needs, while time to swim, read or stroll along the shore completes the restorative experience.

Food provides another layer to the sense of place. The kitchen sits just 300 metres from the Negombo fishing fleet and only a few steps from the sand. Breakfast comes from the garden, lunch from the morning's catch and dinner, if desired, can be served directly on the beach as the horizon turns shades of pink. Menus celebrate seasonal Sri Lankan produce and coastal ingredients, with vegetarian and pescatarian options available.

Beyond the hotel, Negombo Lagoon offers opportunities for kayaking and birdwatching, while cycling routes pass through fishing villages. Farm visits introduce local cultivation, and the traditional practice of toddy tapping offers a glimpse into one of Sri Lanka's enduring rural traditions.

After a day of treatments or adventure, Ayuda's intimate tropical setting invites guests to slow down. Oceanfront rooms, an outdoor pool, rooftop terraces, a meditation room and peaceful spaces for dining and reflection create an atmosphere of calm.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Oceanfront boutique hotel on a secluded beach near Negombo
- Ayurvedic wellness centre with personalised programmes & treatments
- Outdoor swimming pool, rooftop terraces & meditation room
- Garden-to-table dining

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Personalised ayurvedic consultations, yoga, meditation & qigong
- Kayaking and birdwatching
- Guided cycling through local fishing villages & coastal communities
- Farm visits & traditional toddy-tapping experiences

GET IN TOUCH

- ayudahealing.com
- +94 112 225 457
- info@ayudahealing.com
- instagram.com/ayudasanctuary

DON'T MISS Restore mind and body with bespoke ayurvedic treatments, yoga and beachfront dining at sunset



Halcyon Mawella

TANGALLE, SRI LANKA

Set on Sri Lanka's southern shoreline, Halcyon Mawella offers a quieter alternative to the region's busier seaside enclaves, while remaining deeply connected to the character of the surrounding fishing villages and tropical landscape.

The setting is central to the property's appeal. Mawella Bay is known for its gentler surf and swimmable shoreline, a relative rarity along parts of Sri Lanka's southern coast where stronger waves often dominate. This gives the hotel an easy, restorative rhythm: mornings shaped by sea air and light, afternoons drifting between the beach and open, breezy interiors, and evenings that settle into the colours of sunset over the bay. With just 10 bedrooms and a secluded three-bedroom villa, the atmosphere remains intimate and personal.

Dining is one of Halcyon Mawella's strongest expressions of identity. At Illuk, the hotel's seafood restaurant and wine bar, the menu draws from Sri Lanka's coastal bounty while responding closely to seasonality and locality. Fresh seafood takes centre stage, complemented by herbs, fruits and vegetables grown in the property's

quarter-acre organic garden, creating a kitchen-to-garden connection that feels both practical and distinctive. The wine bar adds another layer to the experience, offering a more polished counterpoint to the relaxed beach setting. The property's drinks programme also reflects a thoughtful, low-waste philosophy, incorporating garden botanicals where possible and composting surplus ingredients. The result is dining that feels rooted in place rather than simply presented beside the sea.

The property's outlook extends beyond hospitality. Through the Prajava Gama Foundation, Halcyon Mawella supports nearby communities with training, tourism initiatives and small-scale manufacturing opportunities. Handmade soaps, jams and baked goods produced through these partnerships offer guests a more meaningful connection to local enterprise than standard souvenir shopping. Halcyon Mawella also contributes to biodiversity research, coastal clean-up efforts and conservation work in the surrounding area, while also supporting the local Catch-Neuter-Vaccinate-Release dog programme.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Seafood restaurant & wine bar
- Organic garden
- Swimming pool
- Three-bedroom private villa

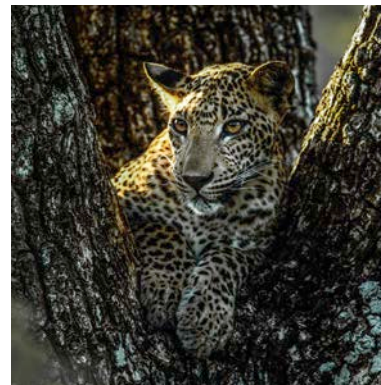
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Ocean swimming
- Seafood dining & wine experiences
- Community-led local shopping
- Beach & conservation experiences

GET IN TOUCH

- halcyonmawella.com
- +94 070 456 5087
- reception@halcyonmawella.com
- instagram.com/halcyon_mawella

DON'T MISS Pick up handmade soaps, jams or baked goods created in collaboration with the Prajava Gama Foundation



Hilton Yala Resort

YALA, SRI LANKA

At the southeastern edge of Sri Lanka — where wilderness stretches towards the Indian Ocean and landscapes remain largely untouched — Yala offers one of South Asia's most immersive natural experiences. Defined by its remarkable biodiversity and dramatic terrain, the region invites travellers into an environment where wildlife moves freely and nature dictates the rhythm of each day.

Yala National Park is among the island's most celebrated reserves, home to 44 species of mammals and more than 215 bird species. It's particularly renowned for having one of the highest leopard densities in the world, alongside elephants, sloth bears and crocodiles. The park unfolds as a striking mosaic of habitats, where monsoon forests meet freshwater lagoons, coastal dunes and open grasslands, creating an ever-changing stage for wildlife encounters.

Positioned on the edge of this untamed landscape, Hilton Yala Resort offers a contemporary safari experience just minutes from the park's entrance. It's the Hilton's first and only operating wildlife resort and is designed to blend

into its surroundings, allowing guests to remain closely connected to nature. Accommodation ranges from spacious guest rooms to suites and private pool villas, each offering a quiet retreat.

Dining at the resort reflects the bold, layered flavours of Sri Lanka, with locally inspired cuisine highlighting regional ingredients and culinary traditions. Experiences extend beyond safari drives, encouraging guests to explore the surrounding area. The ancient Sithulpawwa Rock Temple, believed to date back more than 2,000 years, provides insight into Sri Lanka's spiritual heritage, while nearby coastal villages offer glimpses into fishing traditions and local craftsmanship. For bird enthusiasts, Yala National Park presents a quieter yet equally captivating landscape, known for its migratory bird populations and wetland ecosystems.

Yala is best experienced through moments of quiet observation — the soft light of dawn, the distant call of wildlife and the anticipation that comes with knowing something extraordinary may be just beyond view.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Infinity pool
- Multiple dining venues
- Private pool villas
- Beachfront access

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Wildlife safaris
- Birdwatching excursions
- Cultural site visits
- Beachside dining experiences
- eForea Spa
- Junior Ranger Program
- Tracks & Signs
- Diving at Great Bases
- Deep-sea Fishing

GET IN TOUCH

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DON'T MISS Go on a safari at dawn to spot leopards, and don't miss the lantern-lit beachside dinner under the stars



Koddu Kalpitiya

KALPITIYA, SRI LANKA

Koddu Kalpitiya is a boutique retreat comprising six individual villas set across four acres of waterfront along the Kalpitiya Lagoon. Each villa features spacious accommodation with white and cream interiors, extra-large double beds, light wood furnishings, a semi-open bathroom and a private terrace overlooking the lagoon.

Koddu's name carries rich historical significance. During the early 1900s, Mannar Bay was renowned for its pearl industry, attracting traders from across Asia and the Arab world. The land on which the resort now stands was known locally as the 'Pearl Garden', and was where pearl auctions were held. The huts used to store the pearls were known as 'koddu', and the resort name is a tribute to this heritage.

The property's position affords guests sweeping views across the lagoon from its central facilities, which include an infinity swimming pool with sun terrace, a large open-air dining room, a spacious lounge and a bar designed to capture the cooling lagoon breezes.

Dining focuses on local ingredients and seasonal produce. The restaurant presents Sri Lankan

cuisine alongside a selection of international dishes and fine-dining creations. Fresh seafood features prominently, complemented by herbs and vegetables grown in the hotel's garden. Meals are accompanied by a thoughtfully curated wine list, fresh juices and locally inspired flavours.

While Kalpitiya is best known for kitesurfing, nature and adventure are equally central to the Koddu experience. Guests can explore the marine life of Bar Reef, embark on dolphin- and whale-watching excursions and discover the rich birdlife that inhabits the surrounding mangroves and protected islands.

The surrounding landscape also provides access to some of Sri Lanka's most rewarding wildlife experiences. Local boat excursions include journeys along the Kala Oya river, which borders Wilpattu National Park. One of the country's oldest and largest protected areas, Wilpattu is accessible from Koddu via a lagoon boat transfer followed by a safari. Wildlife sightings may include elephants, leopards, sloth bears, crocodiles and peacocks throughout the year.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Lagoon-front boutique hotel with six private villas
- Semi-open bathrooms & lagoon-facing terraces
- Infinity pool & sun terrace
- Open-air restaurant & lounge

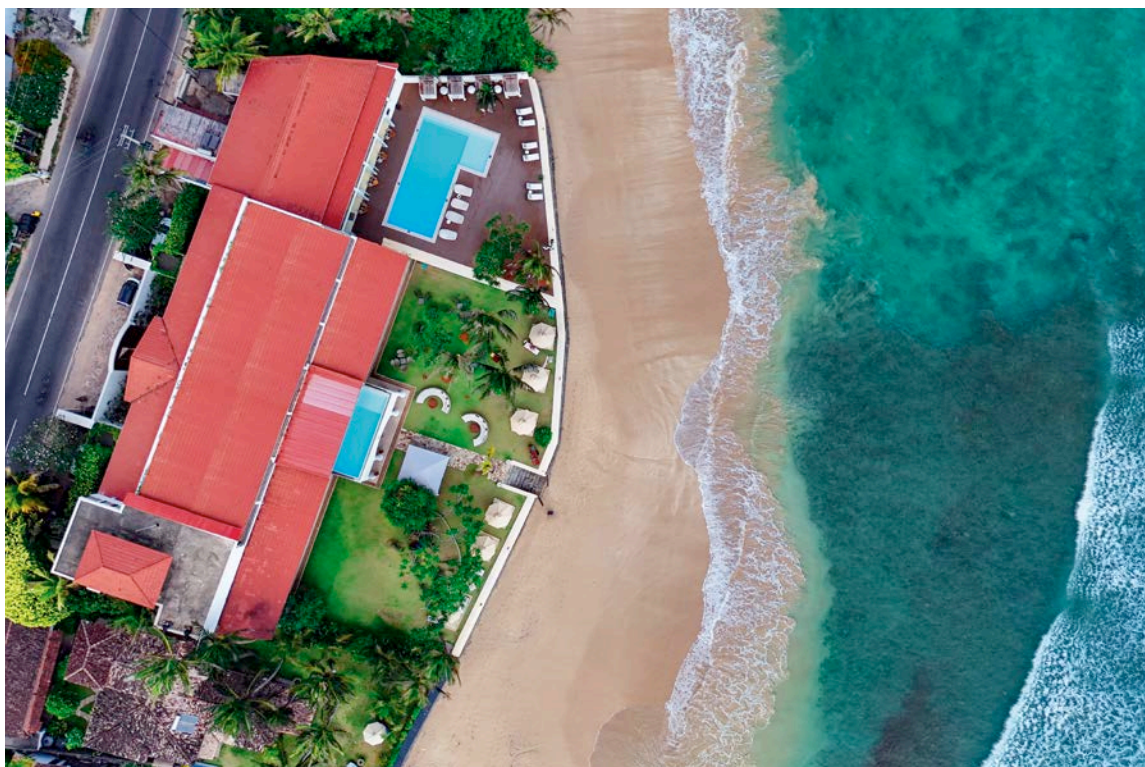
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Dolphin- & whale-watching
- Wilpattu safari excursions
- Kitesurfing
- Yoga lessons

GET IN TOUCH

- [koddukalpitiya.com](https://www.koddukalpitiya.com)
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- info@koddukalpitiya.com
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DON'T MISS Take a boat trip through the mangroves to a 450-year-old church



Mosvold Villa

AHANGAMA, SRI LANKA

Facing Kabalana Beach along Sri Lanka's southern coastline, Mosvold Villa brings together the laid-back rhythm of Ahangama with an intimate approach to coastal hospitality. Known for its surf culture, fishing communities and slower pace of life, the area has evolved into one of the south coast's most characterful seaside towns, where cafes, restaurants, bars, art spaces and local life sit alongside long stretches of open beach.

The hotel overlooks the broad shoreline of Kabalana Bay, known for its consistent surf breaks, seasonal swimming conditions and uninterrupted sunsets across the Indian Ocean. Early mornings often begin with surfers paddling out beyond the reef, while evenings drift towards beach walks, seafood grills and lantern-lit dinners by the ocean.

Mosvold Villa features 16 ocean-facing rooms and suites, creating a sense of privacy throughout the property. Accommodation includes 10 deluxe double rooms, four deluxe twin rooms, a spacious two-bedroom suite and the signature Founder's Suite, complete with a private infinity pool overlooking the Indian Ocean.

Dining focuses on Sri Lankan coastal cuisine alongside modern global dishes. Fresh seafood arrives daily from nearby fishing harbours, while traditional southern curries, tropical fruits and locally grown spices remain central to the menus. Alongside a la carte dining, guests can take part in Sri Lankan cooking classes exploring clay-pot cooking, spice blending and regional recipes.

Beyond the beach, Ahangama offers easy access to several of the south coast's most rewarding experiences. Whale-watching excursions depart seasonally from nearby Mirissa, while turtle hatcheries along the coast support efforts to protect endangered sea turtles. Galle Fort, located less than 30 minutes away, combines colonial architecture, independent boutiques and centuries of maritime history within its Unesco-listed walls.

Within the property itself, days unfold between the swimming pool, oceanfront restaurant, bar and spa, where therapists offer treatments inspired by both Eastern and Western wellness traditions. The atmosphere remains shaped by the natural rhythm of life along Sri Lanka's southern coast.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Beachfront boutique hotel with 16 sea-facing rooms & suites
- Oceanfront restaurant & bar
- Swimming pool & private infinity pool suite
- Spa with international therapists

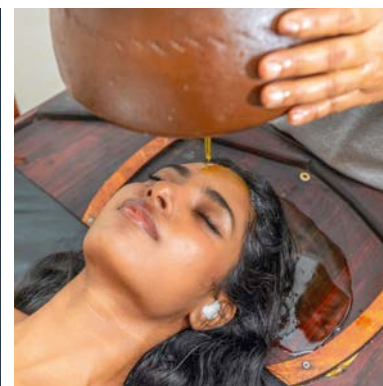
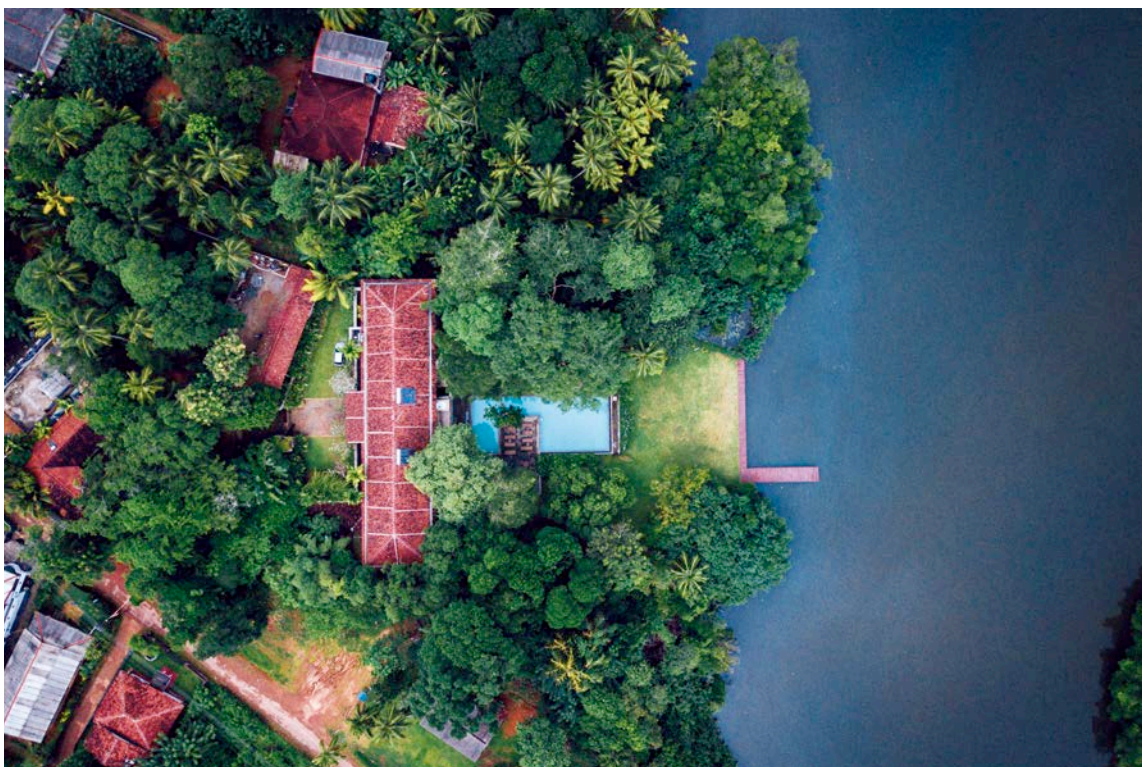
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Surfing at Kabalana Beach
- Whale-watching excursions in Mirissa
- Sri Lankan cooking classes
- Galle Fort & city tours

GET IN TOUCH

- mosvoldhotels.com
- +94 77 335 8800
- info@mosvold.lk
- instagram.com/mosvold.villa

DON'T MISS Watch the sun set over the Indian Ocean while enjoying fresh seafood by the beach



Roman Hotels

SOUTHWEST COAST, SRI LANKA

Dotted along Sri Lanka's celebrated southwest coast, Roman Hotels brings together three distinct boutique stays shaped by wellness, water and a strong sense of place.

Within the mangrove-fringed stillness of Balapitiya lies Roman Lake Ayurveda Resort, set beside the waters of the Madu Ganga and surrounded by one of Sri Lanka's most important wetland ecosystems. Recognised as a Ramsar-listed wetland, Madu Ganga is home to dozens of small islands, rich birdlife and extensive mangrove forests. Here, wellness takes centre stage. The resort has just 10 spacious suites and offers doctor-led consultations, daily treatments, yoga, meditation and tailored ayurvedic cuisine. Despite its secluded atmosphere, the beaches of the southwest coast remain just a short drive away.

Further north, in Thalpitiya near Wadduwa, Roman Life Ayurveda Resort offers a similarly holistic approach while remaining within easy reach of Colombo. Designed around simplicity and wellbeing, the property combines ayurvedic therapies with contemporary comfort. The

surrounding area provides opportunities to explore local culture, including visits to the nearby Kalutara Bodhiya, one of Sri Lanka's most revered Buddhist sites. Guests often spend mornings in wellness programmes before walking to the beach.

At Roman Beach, the focus shifts from wellness to the vibrant energy of Hikkaduwa. This six-room boutique property sits close to one of Sri Lanka's best-known beach towns, where coral reefs, surf breaks and turtle conservation projects have long attracted travellers. Glass-bottom boat excursions reveal marine life beneath the surface, while nearby attractions include traditional batik workshops, moonstone mines and kayaking.

Cuisine connects all three properties. Menus draw on ingredients sourced from local producers as well as herbs and spices grown within the Roman Hotels family. Fresh seafood features prominently, alongside southern Sri Lankan flavours shaped by cinnamon, tamarind and generations of coastal cooking traditions. The emphasis remains firmly on seasonal ingredients and a farm-to-table approach that reflects the character of the region.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Ayurveda spa with doctor-led consultations
- Yoga & meditation spaces
- Restaurant serving ayurvedic & coastal cuisine
- Lakefront & beachfront boutique accommodation

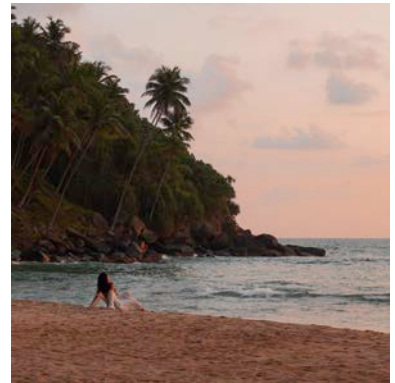
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Madu Ganga boat safaris & wetland exploration
- Ayurveda treatments, Panchakarma & rejuvenation programmes
- Hikkaduwa reef, turtle, surf & glass-bottom boat experiences

GET IN TOUCH

- romanhotels.lk
- +94 77 797 0999
- reservations@romanhotels.lk
- instagram.com/romanlake_ayurveda
- instagram.com/romanliferesort
- instagram.com/romanbeach

DON'T MISS Discover Sri Lanka's wild south west through ayurveda, mangroves, reefs and coastal cuisine



Sama Retreats

KOSGODA, SRI LANKA

Located within a quiet cove framed by a forested headland and an unspoilt stretch of beach, Sama Retreats occupies 10 acres of restored coastal wilderness in Kosgoda on Sri Lanka's southern coast. Named after the Sanskrit word for peace, the property has evolved from a fishing village into a luxury wellness retreat where conservation, design and hospitality are closely intertwined.

The landscape is central to the experience. Over the past decade, the land has been carefully rewilded, with native vegetation restored to create a richly layered coastal habitat. Today, dragonflies drift above freshwater pools and paradise flycatchers move through the canopy.

Scattered throughout the grounds are five cottages with 12 guest rooms, adapted from original village homes using reclaimed materials and natural finishes. Set within pockets of forest, their architecture reflects Sri Lanka's coastal vernacular, pairing natural materials with modern comforts. Wellness forms a defining part of Sama's identity, though the approach is intentionally unhurried. Rooted in Sri Lanka's ayurvedic traditions, each

wellness journey begins with a consultation led by the resident ayurveda physician, shaping personalised treatments, therapies and nutritional guidance. Yoga, meditation and sound healing unfold against a backdrop of forest and ocean, while visiting practitioners host intimate retreats.

Dining is also influenced by place and seasonality. Guided by ayurvedic principles and the six tastes (*rasa haya*), personalised meals are prepared using ingredients from the estate's food forest alongside produce from nearby farmers and locally sourced seafood.

Across the property, resort spaces are designed to encourage immersion in the natural environment. A freshwater pool sits beneath tropical foliage, while an infinity pool overlooks the Indian Ocean. Open-air pavilions host yoga sessions and wellness treatments, and pathways weave through gardens and woodland to the beachfront beyond.

As daylight fades, guests gather for dinner in the open-sided dining pavilion or beneath the forest canopy, where the sounds of the surrounding landscape mingle with the flicker of fireflies.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- 5 standalone cottages with 12 individually designed guest rooms
- Open-air wellness spa, yoga shala & ayurvedic treatment spaces
- Freshwater pool & an ocean-facing infinity pool
- Secluded beachfront with turtles nesting on the shoreline

KEY ACTIVITIES

- Personalised wellness programmes guided by the ayurveda physician
- Daily yoga, meditation & mindfulness sessions in open-air pavilions
- Farm-to-table culinary journey inspired by ayurvedic principles

GET IN TOUCH

- samaretreats.com
- +94 70 550 6888
- info@samaretreats.com
- [instagram.com/sama.retreats](https://www.instagram.com/sama.retreats)

DON'T MISS Enjoy yoga in an open-air pavilion as the sun sets over the Indian Ocean, followed by personalised ayurvedic therapies



Coastal Escape Natai

PHANG NGA, THAILAND

It's increasingly rare to find a tropical beach that still feels undiscovered. Yet just beyond Phuket's northern edge, Natai remains remarkably untouched: a broad sweep of powder-soft sand where morning walks are accompanied only by the sound of the Andaman Sea and entire afternoons can pass without another soul in sight.

Coastal Escape Natai is a place that invites a more gentle rhythm. Days here are guided by the tides rather than the clock. Mornings begin with a carefully crafted breakfast in bed or beside the pool, as fishing boats drift across the horizon. The peaceful lanes behind the villas are ideal for an early morning cycle or jog, while evenings are marked by spectacular sunsets followed by laid-back dinners by the sea.

The retreat features four modern beachfront villas, each offering travellers five en suite bedrooms, each with its own unique character, generous indoor and outdoor living spaces and a private pool with a dedicated pool bar. Villas can be reserved individually, or taken together to create an exclusive estate accommodating up to 48 guests.

For guests, what lingers longest is the warmth of Thai hospitality. The spirit of *nam jai*, a generosity of heart that sits at the core of Thai culture, is reflected in the attentive service of Coastal Escape's dedicated team. With warm smiles and thoughtful care, staff are always on hand to tailor each stay to individual preferences, from private dining experiences featuring local seafood to traditional Thai massages using natural aromatic oils in the privacy of the villa spa rooms. Every detail is considered, allowing travellers to relax and enjoy the ease of coastal living.

Natai also offers glimpses of southern Thailand beyond the beach. A temple sits almost unnoticed along the shoreline, while nearby Samet Nangshe delivers one of the country's most spectacular sunrise panoramas across the limestone karsts of Phang Nga Bay. Characterful local cafes, long-tail boat journeys through hidden lagoons, ethical elephant sanctuaries and traditional cooking experiences all reveal another side of Thailand's rich cultural heritage. These are the kinds of authentic moments that are increasingly hard to find among the region's better-known island destinations.

Need to know

KEY FEATURES

- Four beachfront villas, each with a private pool
- All-day Thai & Western dining
- Private chef, poolside bartender and barbecue dining on request
- Personal concierge and dedicated villa team
- Private spa room and in-villa cinema

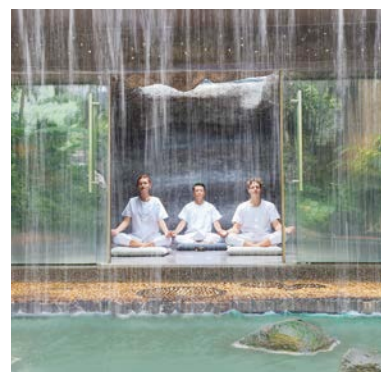
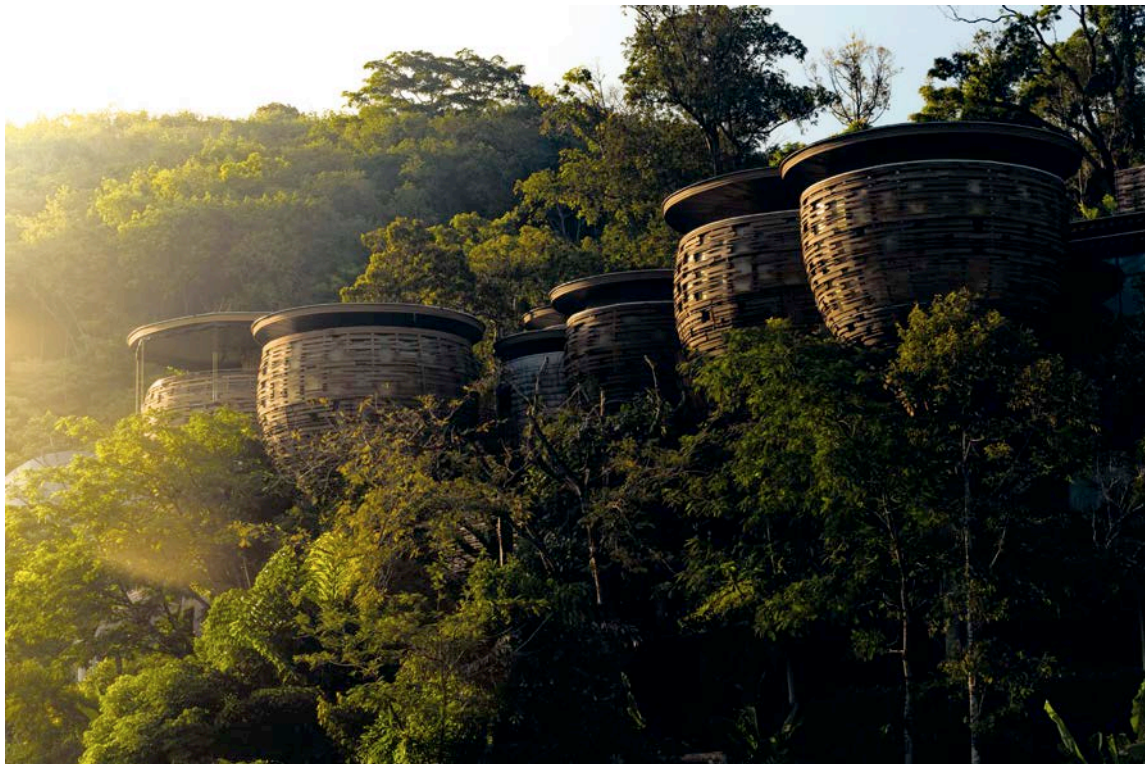
KEY ACTIVITIES

- Thai spa treatments and rituals
- Kayaking, paddleboarding, and beachside activities
- Southern Thai cooking classes and Phuket cultural tours
- Nature, wildlife, sunrise excursions
- Coastal walks, temples, village life

GET IN TOUCH

- coastalescape.com/natai
- +66 82 160 0682
- contact@coastalescape.com
- instagram.com/coastalescape.natai

DON'T MISS Reserve all four villas as an exclusive coastal retreat: a private stretch of Natai Beach with tailored dining and spa experiences



Keemala

PHUKET, THAILAND

Nestled amid the lush hills of Kamala on the west coast of Phuket, Keemala is a sanctuary that invites guests to immerse themselves in the island's enchanting beauty. This unique resort offers a harmonious blend of nature, culture and luxury. Designed to reflect the rich traditions of the region, Keemala features stunning accommodation options that represent different aspects of the island's heritage and provide a captivating backdrop for relaxation.

The hillside location offers a peaceful, private environment while being just a short drive from the vibrancy of Phuket's nightlife and shopping. Patong is only a 15-minute trip away, while Central Phuket Floresta shopping mall can be reached in around 30 minutes. The historic charm of Old Town Phuket and the gateway of Phuket International Airport are both about a 45-minute drive away.

Keemala is deeply committed to sustainable practices, ensuring that the natural environment is preserved for future generations. The resort used eco-friendly materials in its construction and decor, minimising its impact on the surrounding

ecosystem. Water conservation techniques are employed throughout the property, including rainwater harvesting and energy-efficient systems that reduce the overall carbon footprint.

The local area is steeped in culture, with Kamala Beach just a stone's throw away. Renowned for its tranquil atmosphere, Kamala Beach provides a serene escape from the bustling crowds of nearby Patong. Guests can explore vibrant local markets, where the aromas of fresh seafood, tropical fruit and traditional Thai street food beckon.

Keemala's culinary offerings are as diverse as the island around it. The on-site restaurant serves an array of Thai, Indian and international dishes, all crafted from locally sourced ingredients, emphasising organic and seasonal produce.

Keemala also offers a wealth of experiences designed to rejuvenate the mind and body. The spa features treatments that incorporate local herbs and traditions. Guests can try holistic therapies, yoga sessions and meditation classes. The resort's infinity pools offer stunning views and are a perfect spot for guests to unwind.

Need to know

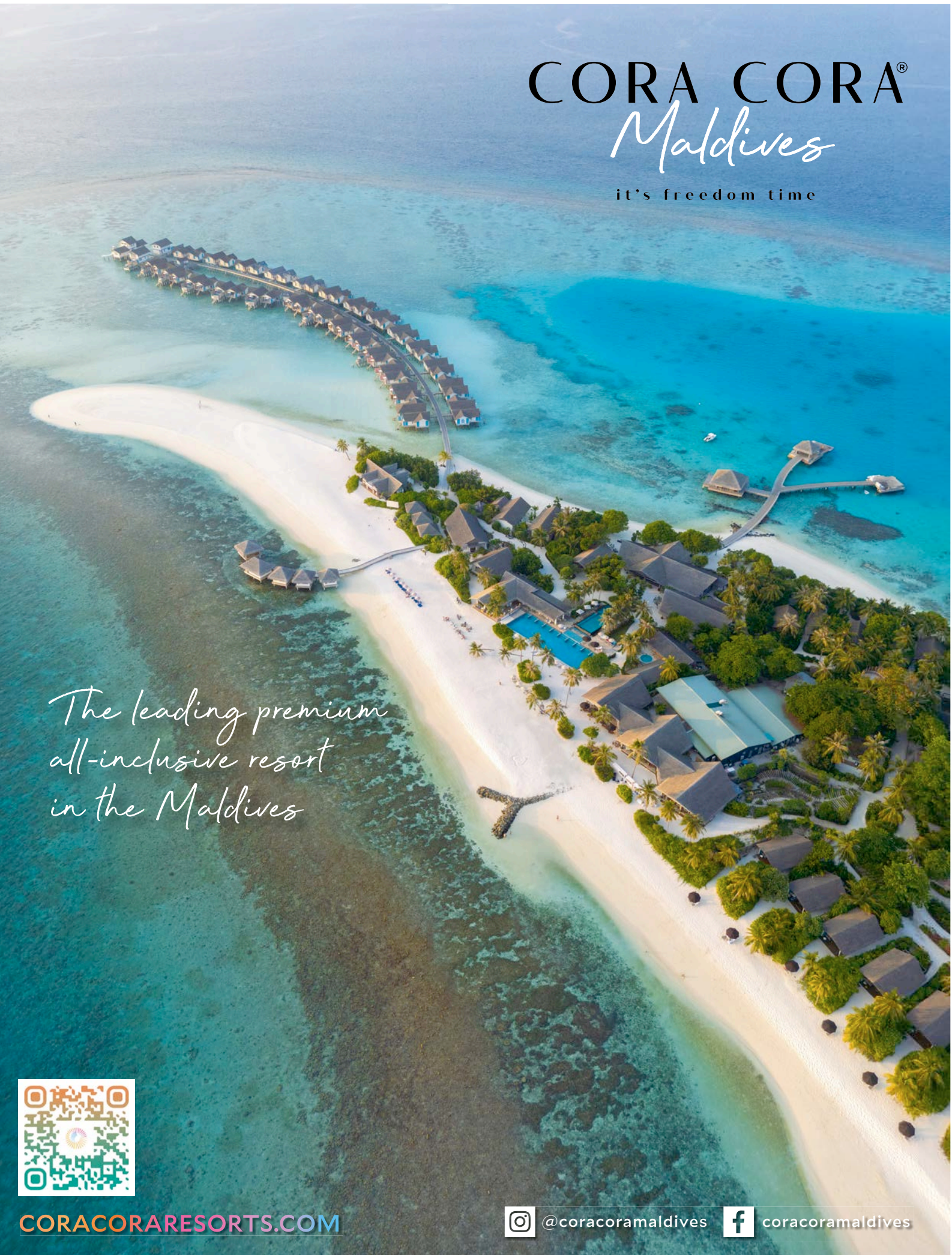
KEY FEATURES

- Award-winning Mala Spa
- Unique accommodation options (Clay Pool Cottage, Tent Pool Villa, Tree Pool House, Bird's Nest Pool Villa)
- Farm-to-table dining

GET IN TOUCH

- [keemala.com](https://www.keemala.com)
- +66 76 358 777
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- [instagram.com/keemalaphuket](https://www.instagram.com/keemalaphuket)

DON'T MISS Savour Keemala's fine dining, where wholesome creations and impeccable service harmonise with the beauty of the Phuket rainforest

An aerial photograph of the Cora Cora Maldives resort. The image shows a long, curved line of overwater villas extending from a sandy beach into the turquoise ocean. The beach is lined with palm trees and resort buildings. A large swimming pool is visible on the beach. The water is clear, showing the coral reef and sandy bottom. The sky is a soft blue.

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Purposeful stays inspired by nature

At Villa Park, every day is an adventure waiting to unfold. Inspired by nature, this vibrant island is a playground for families, where exploration and excitement go hand in hand. From thrilling marine encounters to endless activities for all ages, every stay is purposeful, filled with moments to cherish and stories to share.

